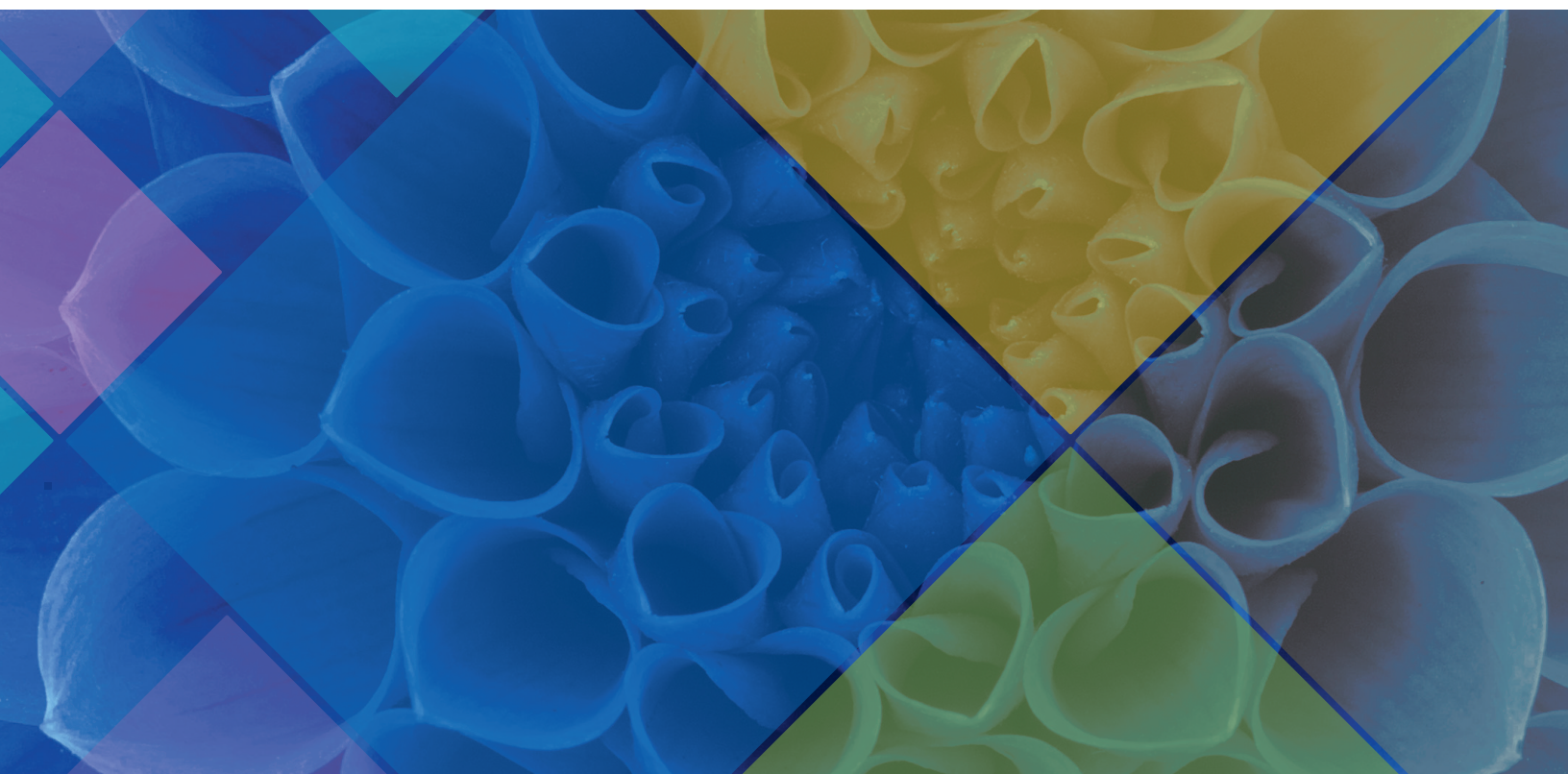




MBTI®

Certification Program

PARTICIPANT'S RESOURCE GUIDE



Myers & Briggs
Foundation



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Becoming an MBTI® Certified Practitioner

Welcome to the interesting and challenging study of the *Myers-Briggs Type Indicator*® (MBTI®) assessment! You are joining tens of thousands of people worldwide who have chosen to become MBTI® Certified Practitioners.

Program Prerequisites

The following prework must be completed before you attend the certification program

1. Take the MBTI® Global Step II™ assessment with MBTI®Complete Interactive Learning Session.

This assessment will produce the MBTI reports you will use during the program to clarify your type and to learn about type theory. You will be able to download a three-page best-fit type description as part of MBTI®Complete. A number of other reports will be generated for and given to you during the program.

Directions for completing the assessment are outlined in the MBTI® Certification Program Instructions that were emailed to you after you registered for the program, along with the date by which you must complete the assessment. If you do not complete the assessment by the specified deadline, you will not have your personal results to work with during the program.

Ethical principles of psychological testing call for professionals to take an assessment and receive results before they administer that assessment to clients. By completing this assessment, you will increase your familiarity with it and, as a result, better understand your clients' experience when they take it.

2. Read the first three sections in this *Participant's Resource Guide*:

- Introduction, pp. v–ix
- Getting Started, p. 1
- Learning Module 1, pp. 3–20

Completing this reading assignment will help prepare you to successfully complete the short multiple-choice exam at the end of Day 1.

These are prerequisites for attending the program. If you have not yet completed the Step II assessment, please STOP and do so now.

Program Goals

This program is designed to accomplish two primary goals:

- Qualify you to purchase, administer, and interpret the MBTI Step I and Step II assessments and reports
- Give you the knowledge, tools, and resources you need to begin using the assessments ethically, appropriately, and confidently in your professional setting

Certification Requirements

There are three general requirements for becoming an MBTI® Certified Practitioner.

- Attendance and participation in all sessions of a licensed MBTI® Certification Program
- Successful completion of the evaluation components of the program
- Practice in providing MBTI feedback and interpretation

MBTI® Certification Program

By attending this program, you will learn about the basic concepts and definitions of type theory while focusing on the most common applications of the MBTI assessment.

Evaluation Components

Each of the five learning modules concludes with a short (10–15 questions) multiple-choice exam, testing the learning in that module. You are required to answer 80 percent (overall) of the questions correctly to become certified.

An open-book post-program retake exam option is available for any participant who does not meet this requirement during the program.

MBTI® Interpretation Practice

The certification program provides opportunities for you to participate in activities and practice presenting the MBTI assessment and interpreting results in a variety of situations with teams and with individuals.

You will meet The Myers-Briggs Company's specific interpretation requirement by participating in a practice feedback activity on Day 2 of the program. Your facilitator will describe the roles and the activity in detail and identify resources on Day 1.

Program Materials

You will receive the following materials for use during and after the MBTI® Certification Program.

MBTI® Certification Program Participant's Resource Guide (PRG) provides information to help you prepare for and be successful in the certification program:

- Summarizes the basic knowledge you will need to become an MBTI® Certified Practitioner

- Is used as a resource during the MBTI® Certification Program
- Will serve as a reference as you begin using the MBTI assessment following successful completion of the program

The five modules in the PRG list readings, present information, provide review questions, and conclude with an action plan. Several appendices provide an overview of technical information about the assessment, a sample report, and other materials.

MBTI® Manual provides in-depth information about the MBTI Step I and Step II assessments, including administration and interpretation guidelines, an explanation of technical components, and research findings. The manual is provided as a downloadable PDF. Ensure that you have downloaded it on a device that you can bring to the program.

Introduction to Myers-Briggs® Type booklet (commonly referred to as ITT in this guide) gives basic type information used during the program and is the recommended resource for MBTI practitioners to provide to clients after they take the Step I assessment.

Exploring Your Myers-Briggs® Type Workbook reinforces clients' understanding of type preferences and helps practitioners guide them through a structured process for identifying best-fit type. It also allows clients to take organized notes as they explore their understanding of type and build an action plan to begin applying what they have learned.

MBTI® Step I™ Feedback Cards guide the practitioner through the Myers-Briggs feedback process and feature numerous talking points, illustrations, and prompts to make interpretation of Step I results easy and effective. Simply use the cards in their order of appearance to ensure a comprehensive, step-by-step exploration of the four preference pairs and help clients get to best-fit type.

MBTI® Certification Program Practitioner Tools contains tools for you to use with clients as you begin to work with the assessments and reports after the certification program. Included are slides and instructions for conducting two group activities, plus the *Giving Feedback to Individuals on the MBTI® Global Step I™ Assessment* and *Giving Feedback to Individuals on the MBTI® Global Step II™ Assessment* videos, which show complete interpretation sessions for Step I and Step II reports, respectively. Following the workshop, these videos will help you prepare for your initial interpretations.

Understanding and Working with Personality Type provides a ready-to-deploy workshop facilitation kit including everything a practitioner needs to deliver a high-quality introductory MBTI training for all audiences.

MBTI® Step II™ User's Guide provides information and guidance for using the Step II assessment with individuals and groups. The user's guide is provided as a downloadable PDF. Ensure that you have downloaded it on a device that you can bring to the program.

Understanding Your MBTI® Step II™ Results booklet gives clients a deeper understanding of their Step II results by explaining the various types of information provided in the MBTI® Step II™ Interpretive Report.

MBTI® Step II™ Feedback Cards guide the practitioner through a comprehensive step-by-step exploration of the 20 Step II facets. The cards offer numerous talking points, illustrations, and

practitioner prompts to make interpretation of Step II results simple and effective. Use all 28 cards or choose a smaller selection tailored to the needs of your client. The cards are easy to integrate into an existing feedback process or to pair with the *Understanding Your MBTI® Step II® Results* booklet for seamless facilitation.

MATERIALS TO BRING WITH YOU TO THE PROGRAM

DAYS 1–3

- *Participant's Resource Guide* (downloadable PDF*)
- *Introduction to Myers-Briggs® Type*
- *Exploring Your Myers-Briggs® Type Workbook*
- *MBTI® Manual* (downloadable PDF*)
- *MBTI® Step I® Feedback Cards*

DAY 4

- *Participant's Resource Guide* (downloadable PDF*)
- *MBTI Manual* (downloadable PDF*)
- *MBTI® Step II® User's Guide* (downloadable PDF*)
- *Understanding Your MBTI® Step II® Results*
- *MBTI® Step II® Feedback Cards*

*Access to the PDFs will be emailed to you two weeks prior to the program. Please download on a device that you can bring to class.

Program Content

The certification program is divided into five learning modules. This PRG presents information about and readings for each module.

Note: You will need to read Learning Module 1 before you attend the program.

Learning Module 1 (Day 1) focuses on introducing the MBTI assessment and type to teams and work groups using MBTI Step I results. It covers the following topics:

- Using the MBTI assessment in group or team sessions
- Defining the preference pairs and preferences
- Clarifying the meaning of MBTI results
- Verifying type
- Experiencing activities to use with teams

Learning Module 2 (Day 2, morning) focuses on explaining your professional responsibilities as an MBTI® Certified Practitioner. It covers the following topics:

- Understanding differences between type assessments and most other personality assessments
- Knowing how the MBTI items were written and why

INTRODUCTION: Becoming an MBTI® Certified Practitioner

- Answering frequently asked questions about technical aspects of the MBTI assessment—reliability and validity
- Using the MBTI assessment appropriately and ethically

Learning Module 3 (Day 2, afternoon) focuses on using the MBTI Step I assessment with individual clients. It covers the following topics:

- Reviewing administration guidelines
- Practicing creating the desired client mind-set and administering the assessment
- Reviewing interpretation guidelines
- Practicing interpreting results with colleagues in the program

Learning Module 4 (Day 3) focuses on using the MBTI assessment for individual and leadership development. It covers the following topics:

- Creating and exploring a team type table
- Learning about type dynamics—how the four preferences form a dynamic personality pattern
- Exploring type and stress
- Understanding type development—the tasks of different stages of life
- Practicing using type dynamics and development explanations for individual development
- Exploring leadership styles related to type and experiencing activities to use with leaders.

Learning Module 5 (Day 4) focuses on the MBTI Step II assessment and your MBTI® Step II™ Interpretive Report. It covers the following topics:

- Grounding the Step II assessment—where did it come from, when would we use it?
- Learning the definitions and meanings of the 20 Step II facets
- Understanding technical aspects of the Step II assessment
- Practicing interpreting results to individual clients
- Using the Step II Interpretive Report with teams
- Exploring case studies of Step II results

Required Assessment Reminder

You must complete the MBTI® Global Step II™ assessment and MBTI® Complete Interactive Learning Session before you attend the MBTI® Certification Program.

The Step II assessment will produce the MBTI® Step II™ Interpretive Report you will receive and use on Day 4 of the program. The Step II assessment also includes the Step I assessment items. You will receive your Step I report on Day 1 and use it during the first three days of the program.

Directions for completing the assessment are outlined in the MBTI® Certification Program Instructions that were emailed to you after you registered for the program, along with the date by which you must complete the assessment.

If you do not complete the assessment by the specified deadline, you will not have your personal results to work with during the program.

Ethical principles of psychological testing call for professionals to take an assessment and receive results before they administer that assessment to clients. By completing this assessment, you will increase your familiarity with it and, as a result, better understand your clients' experience when they take it.

Program Materials

MBTI® Certification Program Participant's Resource Guide (downloadable PDF*)

MBTI® Manual for the Global Step I™ and Step II™ Assessments (downloadable PDF*)

Introduction to Myers-Briggs® Type (ITT) booklet

Exploring Your Myers-Briggs® Type Workbook

MBTI® Step I™ Feedback Cards

MBTI® Certification Program Practitioner Tools (distributed at program)

Understanding and Working with Personality Type workshop facilitation kit (distributed at program)

MBTI® Step II™ User's Guide (downloadable PDF*)

Understanding Your MBTI® Step II™ Results booklet

MBTI® Step II™ Feedback Cards

*Access to the PDFs will be emailed to you two weeks prior to the program. Please download on a device that you can bring to class.

LEARNING MODULE 1

DAY 1: Using the MBTI® Assessment with Teams and Work Groups

LEARNING MODULE 1

TO PREPARE FOR DAY 1

Read in this *Participant's Resource Guide*:

- Introduction
- Learning Module 1

Check your understanding by responding to the review questions in this module, pp. 11–12.

TO DEEPEN YOUR UNDERSTANDING

To learn more about Learning Module 1 topics after the certification program, read the following:

- *Introduction to Myers-Briggs® Type* booklet, pp. 4–6 and 42–45, and the two-page description of your best-fit type (see the discussion of best-fit type in the section “Using the MBTI® Assessment and Type with Teams and Work Groups” on pp. 13–18 in this guide)
- *MBTI® Manual*, chapter 3, “The Theory Behind the MBTI® Assessment,” pp. 26–32, “Origins and Key Features of Type Theory,” and pp. 32–39, “The Fundamentals of Type”
- *MBTI® Manual*, chapter 9, “Validity of the Step II® Assessment,” pp. 216–232, “Organizations”

Agenda Day 1

Welcome, orientation to the program, and introductions

Understanding and Working with Personality Type
(a workshop for introducing Myers-Briggs® type concepts to your clients)

Setup for interpretation trios activity on Day 2

Type activities for teams and groups

Resources and homework

Learning Module 1 exam

Background on the MBTI® Assessment

Isabel B. Myers and Katharine C. Briggs developed the *Myers-Briggs Type Indicator®* (MBTI®) assessment to make Carl G. Jung's theory of psychological type understandable and useful in people's lives. Myers and Briggs shared a vision. They wanted to support people's lives by providing them with a constructive appreciation of individual differences.

In order to work effectively with MBTI results, you will need to understand basic features of Jung's typology:

- Assumptions of Jung's approach
- Definitions of the preference pairs and the preferences
- Behaviors related to the type preferences

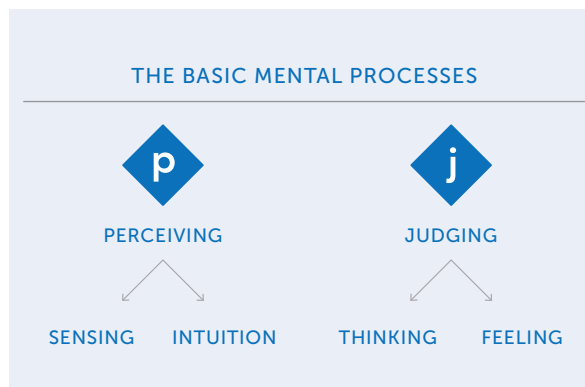
Jung, a Swiss psychiatrist, presented his theory of type in *Psychological Types* (1921; English translation published in 1923). In the 1920s and 1930s, Briggs and Myers studied Jung's ideas, applied them to family and friends, and developed their understanding of psychological type. In the early 1940s, Myers began writing items, testing them using a small criterion group whose types she was confident of, and developing increasingly robust forms of the MBTI assessment.

Jung's Psychological Type Theory

Psychological type is one feature of Jung's broad understanding of psychological functioning. Jung observed that normal, healthy people had opposite ways of dealing with the world and processing and evaluating what happened around them. Based on both his observations and extensive clinical experience, he concluded that people tended to use their minds in opposite ways in several areas.

THE MENTAL PROCESSES

Jung observed that individuals tended to have opposite ways of perceiving (taking in information) and judging (coming to conclusions or making judgments about what they have perceived). He called the two opposite ways of perceiving *Sensation* (Sensing in MBTI usage) and *Intuition*. The opposite ways of judging he termed *Thinking* and *Feeling*. Sensing, Intuition, Thinking, and Feeling are referred to as the *mental processes*.



Jung stated that people use all four of these mental processes in daily life but tend to be naturally drawn to just one of the opposite ways of perceiving and one of the opposite ways of judging. These two preferred mental processes are central to Jung's theory of psychological types.

OPPOSITE ORIENTATIONS

Jung had earlier observed that individuals tended to focus their attention and energy on and to be more energized by one of two opposite orientations:

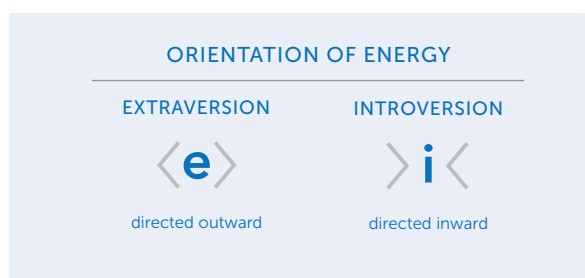
Extraversion

Orientation toward the outer world of people and activities

or

Introversion

Orientation toward the inner world of thought and reflection



DEVELOPMENT OF THE TYPES

These three opposite ways of using one's mind (Extraversion or Introversion, Sensing or Intuition, and Thinking or Feeling) are the essence of Jung's type theory and subsequently of the MBTI

assessment. Jung, Myers, and Briggs all believed that each individual has an innate disposition to develop a preference for one or the other side of each pair of opposites, to use their preferences more comfortably and more often than their opposites, and to develop personality characteristics that result from exercising their preferences. Further, they stated that interactions among these personality preferences form distinct personality types.

THE ROLE OF ENVIRONMENT

It can be inferred from Jung's writings that he saw the environment as influencing personality development. Family, cultural norms, education, training, and other environmental factors may support, suppress, or modify the ways people use and express their innate preferences. Both nature and nurture play a role in individual development. The MBTI assessment is designed to assist respondents in identifying the nature part of personality—their innate dispositions.

Development of the MBTI® Assessment

The MBTI assessment is designed to help respondents identify their natural type preferences. Myers wrote assessment items and developed scales to sort opposite ways of perceiving (Sensing or Intuition), judging (Thinking or Feeling), and acquiring and using energy (Extraversion or Introversion). Myers and Briggs added a fourth pair of opposites, which they called *Judging* and *Perceiving*, identified as orientations toward the outside world. These four pairs of opposites are referred to as the *preference pairs*.

Myers began developing MBTI items in the early 1940s, and she tested, researched, and revised the assessment over the next two decades. Educational Testing Service (ETS) released the first published form of the MBTI assessment (Form F) in 1962, along with a manual. For more than a decade, the assessment was available for research purposes only to professionals authorized to administer and interpret psychological tests, such as licensed psychologists.

Myers continued her MBTI research and development activities. In 1975, CPP, Inc. (now The Myers-Briggs Company) became the publisher of the MBTI assessment. CPP released MBTI Form G and made it available for practical application to those with appropriate training (such as this certification training). CPP released the first Step II assessment, Form K, in the 1980s.

In the mid-1990s, CPP collected data from a national representative sample of adults in the United States as the basis for developing MBTI Step I Form M (published in 1998). A revised Step II assessment, Form Q, was published in 2001. Then, starting in the early 2010s, CPP began collecting data from a global sample as the basis for developing the MBTI® Global Step I™ and Step II™ assessments. (**Note:** The development of the Step II assessment will be covered on Day 4 of this program.) The Global Step I assessment consists of 92 items and produces MBTI Step I results; the Global Step II assessment consists of 143 items and produces MBTI Step II results, as well as Step I results.

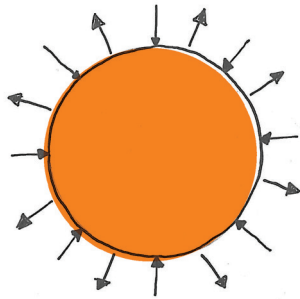
Definitions of the Preference Pairs and Their Components

To understand the preference pairs, we need to understand the two opposite preferences that compose each one. These preferences lead to observable characteristics of and differences between people who prefer one or the other of the opposites in a pair. Note that MBTI scoring uses letters to identify these preferences.

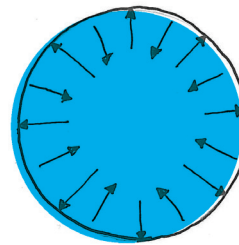


THE E–I PAIR

Opposite ways people direct and receive energy



A focus on the
external world of people and action



A focus on the
internal world of thoughts and feelings

EXTRAVERSION

People who prefer Extraversion like to focus on the outside world. They direct their energy and attention outward and are energized by interacting with people and taking action.

Characteristics associated with people who prefer Extraversion:

- Drawn to the outside world
- Prefer to communicate by talking
- Work out ideas by talking them through
- Learn best through doing or discussing
- Have broad interests
- Tend to be sociable and expressive
- Readily take initiative in work and relationships

INTROVERSION

People who prefer Introversion like to focus on their own inner world. They direct their energy and attention inward and are energized by reflecting on their own and others' ideas, memories, and experiences.

Characteristics associated with people who prefer Introversion:

- Drawn to their inner world
- Prefer to communicate in writing
- Work out ideas by reflecting on them
- Learn best by reflection, mental "practice"
- Focus in depth on a few interests
- Tend to be private and contained
- Take initiative selectively—when the situation or issue is very important to them

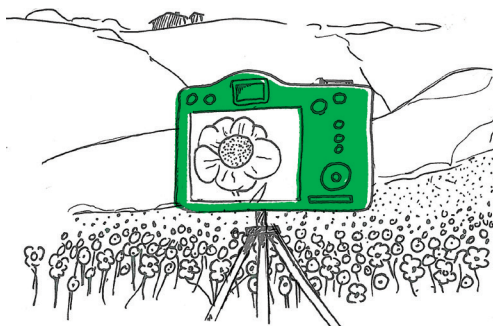
Source: Myers, Isabel B. *Introduction to Myers-Briggs® Type* (7th ed.). Sunnyvale, CA: The Myers-Briggs Company, 2015.

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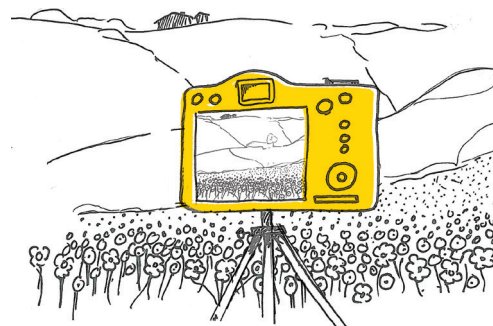
n

THE S–N PAIR

Opposite ways people take in information



Taking in and presenting information
in a sequential, step-by-step way



Taking in and presenting information
in a snapshot or big-picture way

SENSING

People who prefer Sensing like to take in information that is real and tangible—what they perceive using the five senses. They pay close attention to what is going on around them and are especially attuned to practical realities.

Characteristics associated with people who prefer Sensing:

- Oriented to present realities
- Factual and concrete
- Focus on what is real and actual
- Observe and remember specifics
- Build carefully and thoroughly toward conclusions
- Understand ideas and theories through practical applications
- Trust experience

INTUITION

People who prefer Intuition like to take in information by seeing the big picture, focusing on the relationships and connections between facts. They look for patterns and are especially attuned to seeing new possibilities.

Characteristics associated with people who prefer Intuition:

- Oriented to future possibilities
- Imaginative and verbally creative
- Focus on the patterns and meanings in data
- Remember specifics when they relate to a pattern
- Move quickly to conclusions, follow hunches
- Want to clarify ideas and theories before putting them into practice
- Trust inspiration

Source: Myers, Isabel B. *Introduction to Myers-Briggs® Type* (7th ed.). Sunnyvale, CA: The Myers-Briggs Company, 2015.



THE T–F PAIR

Opposite ways people decide and come to conclusions



Making decisions by stepping back from the situation, taking an objective view



Making decisions by stepping into the situation, taking an empathetic view

THINKING

People who prefer Thinking like to decide things by looking at the logical consequences of their choice or action. They want to mentally remove themselves from the situation so they can examine the pros and cons objectively. They enjoy analyzing what's wrong with something so they can solve the problem. Their goal is to find a standard or principle that will apply in all similar situations.

Characteristics associated with people who prefer Thinking:

- Analytical
- Use cause-and-effect reasoning
- Solve problems with logic
- Strive for an objective standard of truth
- Reasonable
- Can be "tough-minded"
- Fair—want everyone treated equally

FEELING

People who prefer to use Feeling like to decide things by considering what's important to them and to others involved. They mentally insert themselves into the situation to identify with everyone so they can make decisions that honor people. They enjoy appreciating and supporting others, and look for qualities to praise. Their goal is to create harmony and treat each person as a unique individual.

Characteristics associated with people who prefer Feeling:

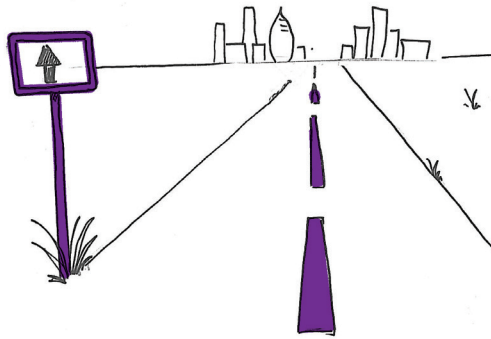
- Empathetic
- Guided by personal and social values
- Assess impacts of decisions on people
- Strive for understanding, harmony, and positive interactions
- Compassionate
- May appear "tenderhearted"
- Fair—want everyone treated as an individual

Source: Myers, Isabel B. *Introduction to Myers-Briggs® Type* (7th ed.). Sunnyvale, CA: The Myers-Briggs Company, 2015.

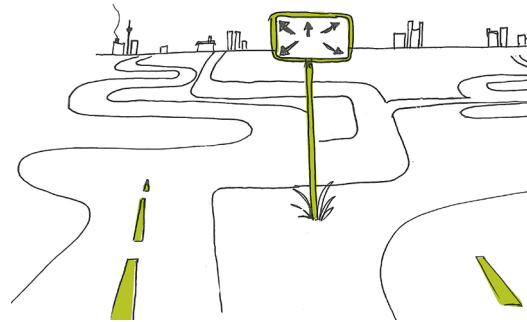


THE J–P PAIR

Opposite ways people approach the outside world



A planned approach to meeting the deadline in a scheduled way



An adaptable approach to meeting deadlines in a flexible way

JUDGING

People who prefer Judging like to live in a planned, orderly way. They tend to make decisions based on the currently available information, come to closure, and move on. Their lives tend to be structured and organized, and they like to have things settled. Sticking to a plan and schedule is very important to them, and they enjoy getting things done.

Characteristics associated with people who prefer Judging:

- Scheduled
- Organize their lives
- Systematic
- Methodical
- Make short- and long-term plans
- Like to have things decided
- Try to avoid last-minute stress

PERCEIVING

People who prefer Perceiving like to live in a flexible, spontaneous way, and want to experience and understand life rather than control it. Detailed plans and final decisions feel confining to them; they prefer to stay open to new information and last-minute options. They enjoy being resourceful in adapting to the opportunities and demands of the moment.

Characteristics associated with people who prefer Perceiving:

- Spontaneous
- Flexible
- Casual
- Open-ended
- Adapt, change course
- Like things loose and open to change
- Find last-minute pressures energizing

Source: Myers, Isabel B. *Introduction to Myers-Briggs® Type* (7th ed.). Sunnyvale, CA: The Myers-Briggs Company, 2015.

Four-Letter Type (Whole Type)

There are 16 possible combinations that result when one preference from each of the four pairs of opposites (E–I, S–N, T–F, and J–P) combine. These combinations are called *personality types*, or whole types, and are designated by the four letters representing their four component preferences. Each whole type is greater than the sum of its parts; the preferences interact dynamically to create a hierarchy of preference within the processes (S, N, T, and F), from most to least preferred. The specific ways in which the preferences in each type interact were identified by Jung and expanded on by Myers and Briggs. The dynamic nature of personality type is the essence of Jung-Myers type theory and the MBTI framework. It accounts for the “Aha!” experience many people have when they first read their type description in *Introduction to Myers-Briggs® Type*, which reflects the dynamic interaction within their type.

Some Cautions

The MBTI assessment's approach to personality is different from that of most other personality assessments in that it asks respondents to choose between opposite alternatives that are both legitimate, healthy, and useful. This approach can inadvertently lead to inappropriate ways of talking about and using type, so it is important that you, as a practitioner, choose your words carefully.

- People may believe that having a preference means they never use the opposite preference (for example, “You’re an Intuitive type, so you never notice details”; “I’m an Introvert, so don’t expect me to socialize”). This is inaccurate, as everyone uses both preferences in each pair at least some of the time, although not with equal skill or confidence and not concurrently.
- It is best to avoid categorical labels and use instead language such as “I prefer Intuition over Sensing” or “My best-fit type is ISTJ.” The latter has the advantage of conveying that the preferences do not exist in isolation; each is integral to the whole type.
- The terms *extraversion* and *introversion*, *extravert* and *introvert*, have long been part of common language. Current usage and stereotypical views of what it means to “be an extravert” or “be an introvert” are hard to overcome. Try to keep to Jung’s description of extraversion and introversion as opposite ways of being energized and using energy: “Extraverts (people who prefer Extraversion) are energized by interacting with the outside world and like to spend as much time as they can there. Introverts (people who prefer Introversion) are energized by interacting with their inner world, reflecting and mulling things over, and want to spend as much time as they can there.”
- Explain that people tend to have a preference for one or the other kind of energy but can use either one when they need to. Use this same “preference but ability to use the opposite” approach when discussing the other three preference pairs. You will likely come up with examples from your own way of functioning—for example, when and how you engage your Thinking if you by nature prefer Feeling.

This way of talking about type preferences is true to the Jung-Myers theory of personality type and affirmed by research. Adhering to it helps avoid stereotyping.

REVIEW: BASIC TYPE DEFINITIONS

POINTS TO REMEMBER

- Meaning of the term *preference* as used in the MBTI assessment
- Definitions of the four preference pairs and the opposites they encompass
 - Extraversion–Introversion
 - Thinking–Feeling
 - Sensing–Intuition
 - Judging–Perceiving
- Common characteristics associated with each preference

TEST YOUR LEARNING by responding to the following statements and questions.
Check your answers using the key below.

1. Type theory is concerned with differences in personality that result from:

- a. Mental health or illness
 - b. Environmental influences
 - c. Natural preferences
 - d. Skills learned through education
-

2. Type theory describes people who prefer Extraversion as:

- a. Expressive and compassionate
 - b. Active and practical
 - c. Enthusiastic and imaginative
 - d. Focused on the outer world
-

3. Type theory describes people who prefer Introversion as:

- a. Focused on the inner world
 - b. Quiet and shy
 - c. Reflective and imaginative
 - d. Private, contained, and logical
-

4. Type theory describes people who prefer Sensing as:

- a. Sensitive and sympathetic
 - b. Practical and concrete
 - c. Systematic and reasonable
 - d. Realistic, experiential, and logical
-

5. Type theory describes people who prefer Intuition as:

- a. Future oriented and conceptual
 - b. Empathetic and compassionate
 - c. Spontaneous and open ended
 - d. Reflective and thoughtful
-

6. Type theory describes people who prefer Thinking as making decisions by:

- a. Using all the mental processes
 - b. Using logical analysis
 - c. Considering facts and details
 - d. Making creative connections between facts
-

CONTINUED

REVIEW: BASIC TYPE DEFINITIONS CONTINUED

7. Type theory describes people who prefer Feeling as making decisions by:

- a. Using emotions
- b. Questioning and critiquing
- c. Considering personal and social values
- d. Using creative insights

8. Type theory describes people who prefer Judging as:

- a. Systematic and scheduled
- b. Realistic and practical
- c. Logical and reasonable
- d. Flexible and adaptable

9. Type theory describes people who prefer Perceiving as:

- a. Creative and original
- b. Empathetic and original
- c. Flexible and open ended
- d. Conceptual and theoretical

10. Which of the following is one of the four mental processes?

- a. Sensing
- b. Extraversion
- c. Judging
- d. Introversion

Review answers: 1 c, 2 d, 3 a, 4 b, 5 a, 6 b, 7 c, 8 a, 9 c, 10 a

Using the MBTI® Assessment and Type with Teams and Work Groups

The MBTI practitioner's goal when introducing type to a team is to use a process and explanations that will allow people to arrive at a "best-fit" type that they are willing to share with the other members of their team and use to enhance team effectiveness. Best-fit type is the type individuals choose after they have

- Taken the MBTI assessment
- Had an interactive explanation of the MBTI preferences
- Self-assessed their type
- Received their reported type
- Read the detailed two-page description of their reported type in the ITT booklet
- Explored the fit of the ITT description, read descriptions of similar types as necessary, and identified the type that seems most like them

This process of establishing the best-fit type of each team member lays the foundation for the team to use type to improve communication, deal with conflict, enhance decision making, and, in general, function more effectively.

The ethical guidelines for using the MBTI instrument (addressed more fully in Module 2) state that completing the assessment is voluntary and that results are confidential and belong to the respondent. Practitioners need to consistently implement these guidelines. Outlined below is a series of effective steps you can take to ensure that you position and present the assessment and type ethically. Activities on Day 1 of the MBTI® Certification Program will provide further guidance on how to introduce type to a team.

Before the Team Session

You have been asked to introduce type to a team. You agree. What needs to happen prior to the actual session?

1. Identify who has overall responsibility for the session and agree on the objectives and content with that person.

It is beneficial to involve the person throughout the design and delivery process and to establish early on that individual's expectations for what would constitute a successful session. It is essential to find out why a team session has been requested, what resources and time are available for it, and what the desired outcomes are. You can streamline your preparation by also finding out the following:

- Are the participants expected to work as a team, or are they more a work group?
If they are a team, what are the common goals or objectives they are working toward?
If they are a work group, what are they collectively working on?
- What experience do they have of team development events?
- How would they describe the team's current atmosphere and perceived strengths and challenges?
- How long have they worked together? Are there any new team members?
- Has the team undergone significant change recently?

You can gather this information from the team leader or the whole team. If the team is experiencing conflict or communication challenges, it is especially important to provide a means—phone, email, face-to-face meeting, or other—for team members to communicate their purposes and concerns to you individually. To ensure that the MBTI assessment will be used appropriately and that the learning in the session will achieve the agreed-on objectives, engage the team's supervisor or manager in a discussion prior to the session.

2. Decide, in consultation with the team or the team leader, which MBTI administration option you will use and how the team members will receive their results.

The MBTI assessment administration options are covered in Module 3.

When team members are to complete the MBTI items online prior to the session, you will need to communicate administration guidelines to them either face-to-face or electronically. **It is especially important to explain the mind-set** the team members are to bring to responding to the items. Be sure to cover the following points in your communication.

- State the objectives for the team session and inform team members that one of the tools you will use to achieve these objectives is the MBTI assessment.
- State that taking the MBTI assessment is voluntary and tell team members to contact you by [date] if they have any questions or concerns about completing the assessment.
- Explain that during the session you will provide type definitions and examples. Team members will decide which type is the best fit for them based on these explanations and their MBTI results.

- State that MBTI results belong to the person completing the assessment. Tell team members that you will ask them to talk about themselves in terms of type; however, they own their results and it is up to them to decide what they will share with others about their type. If you would like team members to share their best-fit type in a session, it is important to inform them of this in advance, explain what will happen to the information, such as where their data will be stored and for how long, and ask for their cooperation. Make sure you give them an opportunity to ask questions and share any concerns, or to decline the opportunity to share their type.
- Provide instructions for completing the MBTI assessment. Tell team members that there is no time limit, but that people typically take 20 to 30 minutes to complete the assessment (plus an additional 30 to 40 minutes to complete the Interactive Learning Session and verify their type when using MBTI®Complete). Give them the date by which they will need to have completed the assessment so that you can prepare an individual report for each team member and hand it out during the team session.
- Explain the ideal mind-set for taking the assessment, as follows:
"Please respond to the forced-choice items outside of the various roles you play at work and in your personal life. The items are intended to help you identify what you prefer when you can choose without external influence."
- Include your name and contact information (email address, phone number). While someone from the contracting team or group may send the email to the team members, you are the MBTI® Certified Practitioner and participants need to know how to contact you directly to express their concerns or ask questions.

3. Purchase the required support materials.

Include *Introduction to Myers-Briggs® Type* or one of the other booklets in the *Introduction to Myers-Briggs® Type* series for each team member, so that you can distribute them at the outset of the session.

PROCESS FOR TEAM BUILDING WITH THE MBTI® ASSESSMENT

The process outlined below assumes that the team members will complete the MBTI assessment online prior to the team session and will receive a Step I type report during the session.

Distribute *Introduction to Myers-Briggs® Type* or one of the other booklets in the *Introduction to Myers-Briggs® Type* series (one copy for each team member) and use the booklet during your presentation. It will lead you through the process of introducing type concepts and ensure that participants receive the information they need to verify and understand their preferences.

STEP 1. State the purpose for and objectives of the session.

Include specific issues identified by the team leader and members in interviews.

Present the MBTI assessment as a tool for achieving the identified purpose and objectives.

STEP 2. Provide background on/context for the MBTI assessment.

The MBTI assessment is based on a theory developed by Carl G. Jung and described in his book *Psychological Types*.

PROCESS FOR TEAM BUILDING WITH THE MBTI® ASSESSMENT CONTINUED

The theory was adapted and enhanced by Isabel B. Myers and Katharine C. Briggs; we refer to this as the *Jung-Myers theory*.

Development of the MBTI Step I assessment began in the early 1940s. The Step II assessment was released in the 1980s. Both assessments have been revised and updated several times.

The most recent forms of the Step I and Step II assessments were published in 2018, based on data from a global sample of adults representing a total of 20 countries and 19 languages.

The MBTI Step I and Step II assessments are backed by extensive research over many decades.

The MBTI assessment is the most widely used personality inventory in the world.

Note: If you are using the Step I self-scorable assessment, this is the time to give administration instructions, including the points on ideal mind-set, and have team members respond to the items.

STEP 3. Define the term *preference* as used by the MBTI assessment.

Use the “handedness” activity (ITT, p. 4).

Distinguish natural preferences from developed skills.

STEP 4. Define the four pairs of preferences and the two opposites in each pair. Give examples of behaviors related to the preferences that are relevant to the team.

Be sure to give equal time to both preferences in each pair—watch your biases. For one-on-one feedback, the *MBTI® Step I® Feedback Cards* will help you get this right.

Direct team members’ attention to definitions and characteristics of the preferences (ITT, pp. 5–6).

Ask team members to self-assess on each pair of opposites: “Which do you think is your natural preference?” Refer back to the handedness activity if they are having difficulty distinguishing natural preferences from developed skills.

STEP 5. Return assessment results and verify type.

Self-assessed type: Direct team members to identify their “first hypothesis,” the four letters they chose as you were defining the preferences (ITT, p. 7).

Reported type: Return results, saying, “Here is a report on how you responded to the items on the MBTI assessment. This is your ‘second hypothesis’” (ITT, p. 7).

Note: If you are using the Step I self-scorable assessment, this is the time to have participants open the booklet and score their responses to identify their reported type.

CONTINUED

PROCESS FOR TEAM BUILDING WITH THE MBTI® ASSESSMENT CONTINUED

Best-fit type: Lead team members through the type verification process, such as the one outlined in ITT (p. 8).

- If their two hypotheses are the same, have them read their type description in ITT (pp. 10–41) and apply it to themselves: “What fits? What doesn't fit? Is this your best-fit type?”
- If their two hypotheses differ, have them read two type descriptions, identifying which seems to fit best for them. For example, if they are confident that they have preferences for Sensing, Thinking, and Judging but are unsure about Extraversion and Introversion, ask them to read the ESTJ and ISTJ descriptions. If they are unsure about two preferences, it can be useful to ask them to first read the short descriptions (ITT, p. 9) for all four of the types that might fit. For example, if they are confident that they have preferences for Thinking and Judging but are unclear on E–I and S–N, they should read the short descriptions for ESTJ, ENTJ, ISTJ, and INTJ. This generally allows people to reduce their possible options. Then ask the team members to read one or two of the longer type descriptions (ITT, pp. 10–41).
- It can be helpful for team members to explore the various sources of pressure on their use of the preferences, such as family, job role, and organizational culture. Exploring where they use each preference, where use of the preferences may be rewarded or influenced by external pressures, and what learned behaviors may exist can be key in helping them identify their natural preferences. It is worth reminding team members that they do not need to decide on their best-fit type immediately and that gaining clarity is a process that can take some time. Often individuals will notice their use of the preferences in the days and weeks following their introduction to the MBTI framework and become more confident of their preferences.

Ask team members to sign in on a type table (if they are willing to do so) that you have posted on a flipchart or wall. Tell them to write their name in the cell of the table that they have decided is their best-fit type.

STEP 6. Discuss the team's type distribution, likely strengths, and blind spots.

Lead team members in a discussion of type distributions and preference combinations (ITT, pp. 44–45).

Explore with them how they can use type differences to improve teamwork (ITT, pp. 44–45).

STEP 7. Use resources to lead team members in applying type information to their team and the objectives identified in step 1 or agreed on by the team prior to the session.

Common team activities and applications of type

- Focus on the communication styles of the 16 types
- Discuss how type can be used to understand and/or resolve conflicts
- Identify how the various types on the team contribute to the team's work and how each would like to be acknowledged
- Explore how type concepts can help the organization deal with change

PROCESS FOR TEAM BUILDING WITH THE MBTI® ASSESSMENT CONTINUED

Resources for activities and applications

- “Living Type Table” activity in your *Practitioner Tools*
- Activities for understanding MBTI preferences in the *Understanding and Working with Personality Type* workshop facilitation kit
- Applications material in the ITT booklet
- MBTI facilitation kits available from The Myers-Briggs Company for workshops focusing on particular applications, including the following:
 - Leader development
 - Communication
 - Influencing
 - Decision making
 - Emotional intelligence
 - Change management

SUMMARY OF KEY TERMS RELATED TO THE MBTI® FEEDBACK PROCESS

Self-assessed type: This is the type people choose as they listen to and/or read descriptions of the preference pairs and the two opposites that compose each one. It is a self-estimate or hypothesis based on MBTI definitions and people’s knowledge of themselves.

Reported type: This is the type that is produced by scoring an individual’s responses to the MBTI items.

Best-fit type: This is the type people choose after they have

- Taken the MBTI assessment
- Had an interactive explanation of the MBTI preferences
- Self-assessed their type
- Received their reported type
- Read the detailed two-page description of their reported type in the ITT booklet
- Explored the fit of the ITT description, read descriptions of similar types as necessary, and identified the type that seems most like them

Our goal in introducing type—the reason we follow administration guidelines and sequential steps—is to give respondents the best opportunity to accurately identify their best-fit type.

Thoughts About When the MBTI® Assessment Is/Is Not Appropriate for Use with a Team

An important part of being an MBTI® Certified Practitioner is recognizing when the use of the MBTI assessment is appropriate and likely to be helpful and when it is not.

APPROPRIATE USES

- When team members agree that they want and need to become more effective in their processes and interactions
- When leadership supports the team-building process and use of the MBTI assessment as a tool
- When team members identify issues related to type differences, such as communication, decision making, interpersonal misunderstanding, and conflict
- When you, the professional, “hear type” in the conflict or issues presented by team members as goals for their team building
- When team members want to move to a deeper level of understanding and trust

PROBABLY INAPPROPRIATE USES

- When there is no trust within a team, often indicated by team members telling you that they don't want to take the MBTI assessment or share their results with other team members
- When the problems team members are experiencing are the result of a lack of technical skills and expertise or the wrong mix of abilities on the team
- When the leader or the person to whom the team reports wants to use the assessment but the team members do not, or vice versa
- When the team is in total breakdown—for example, members not speaking to each other

LEARNING MODULE 1 ACTION PLAN

In the table below, use a pencil to assess where you are right now.

During the certification program, you will be directed to review and revise your self-assessment and action plan each evening. Your final task in the program will be to identify steps to prepare yourself to use the MBTI assessment in your work setting.

✓ Put a check mark in the box that identifies your current self-assessment.

- Got It:** ✓ Have enough information to do this competently now
Need More: ✓ Generally understand, but need more information and/or practice
Don't Have It: ✓ Not at all confident of my current knowledge or ability to use it
Summary: ✓ Satisfied, confident, ready to go with this item
 ✗ Want to include this in my action plan steps as I go forward

Things I need to know	Got It	Need More	Don't Have It	Summary for Action Plan
THE BASICS				
Background				
Meaning of preference				
THE PREFERENCE PAIRS				
Definition of E–I preference pair				
Definition of Extraversion				
Definition of Introversion				
Appropriate examples of E–I				
Definition of S–N preference pair				
Definition of Sensing				
Definition of Intuition				
Appropriate examples of S–N				
Definition of T–F preference pair				
Definition of Thinking				
Definition of Feeling				
Appropriate examples of T–F				
Definition of J–P preference pair				
Definition of Judging				
Definition of Perceiving				
Appropriate examples of J–P				

CONTINUED

LEARNING MODULE 1 ACTION PLAN CONTINUED

- Got It:** ✓ Have enough information to do this competently now
Need More: ✓ Generally understand, but need more information and/or practice
Don't Have It: ✓ Not at all confident of my current knowledge or ability to use it
Summary: ✓ Satisfied, confident, ready to go with this item
 ✗ Want to include this in my action plan steps as I go forward

Things I need to know	Got It	Need More	Don't Have It	Summary for Action Plan
VERIFYING TYPE				
Self-assessment, 1st hypothesis				
Reported type, 2nd hypothesis				
Best-fit type verification process				
Priorities for Learning Module 1	Ideas: Steps to take, materials to read, etc.			
1.				
2.				
3.				
4.				
5.				

LEARNING MODULE 2

DAY 2: Meeting Professional Responsibilities for Using the MBTI® Assessment

LEARNING MODULE 2

TO PREPARE FOR DAY 2, MORNING

Read in this *Participant's Resource Guide*:

- Learning Module 2

Check your understanding by responding to the review questions in this module, pp. 32–33.

For definitions of the technical terms used in this chapter, refer to "Appendix A: MBTI® Technical Overview" in this guide, pp. 97–110.

TO DEEPEN YOUR UNDERSTANDING

To learn more about Learning Module 2 topics after the certification program, read the following:

- *Introduction to Myers-Briggs® Type* booklet, p. 52
- *MBTI® Manual Global Supplement Series* (www.themyersbriggs.com/mbti-manual-supplements)
- The Myers-Briggs Company at www.themyersbriggs.com: Resources: case studies, reports on MBTI research, etc.
- Mary & Isabel's Library Online (MILO®) catalog at the Myers & Briggs Foundation website: <https://www.myersbriggs.org/research-and-library/isabel-briggs-myers-library/>.
- *MBTI® Manual*, chapter 6 (entire chapter), "Administering and Interpreting the MBTI® Step I® and Step II® Assessments," pp. 97–129

TO DEEPEN YOUR KNOWLEDGE

MBTI® Manual

- Chapter 1, "Introduction to MBTI® Step I® and Step II® Type," pp. 9–11, "Differences Between the MBTI® Instruments and Other Instruments"
- Chapter 2, "A Closer Look at the Global Step II® Assessment," p. 14, "The Multifaceted Nature of the MBTI® Preference Pairs," and pp. 15–17, "Comparison of the Global Step I® and Step II® Assessments"

Agenda Day 2, Morning

Professional responsibilities for using the MBTI® assessments

Type vs. trait: MBTI instruments compared to most other personality instruments

Construction of the MBTI® Step I® assessment

Reliability

Validity

Contracting and ethics

Learning Module 2 exam

- Chapter 7 (entire chapter), "Construction of the MBTI® Global Assessments," pp. 133–159
- Chapter 8 (entire chapter), "Reliability of the MBTI® Global Step I™ and Step II™ Assessments," pp. 161–182
- Chapter 9 (entire chapter), "Validity of the MBTI® Step I™ Assessment," pp. 183–291
- Chapter 10 (entire chapter), "Validity of the MBTI® Step II™ Assessment," pp. 293–338

See also the Myers & Briggs Foundation website at <https://www.myersbriggs.org>.

Professional Responsibilities for Using the MBTI® Assessments

The MBTI assessments are restricted psychological instruments. Professionals using them need to follow standards that apply specifically to the MBTI assessments in addition to those established by professional associations such as the American Psychological Association (APA) and the American Educational Research Association (AERA), among others.

Professionals using psychological assessments need to ask—and get information about—the following questions:

- How was this assessment developed? Based on theory? Research?
- What samples were used to develop the assessment and set up the scoring and interpretation processes?
- Is this assessment reliable? What samples have been used to test reliability?
- Is this assessment valid? What kinds of data support its validity?
- Is it useful for my purposes? Is this the correct tool for achieving my objectives?

MBTI practitioners do not need to be psychological testing experts. They do need to know

- What the client's questions relate to
- Where to find the information or data that will answer the client's questions
- How to respond effectively to skeptical clients and decision makers

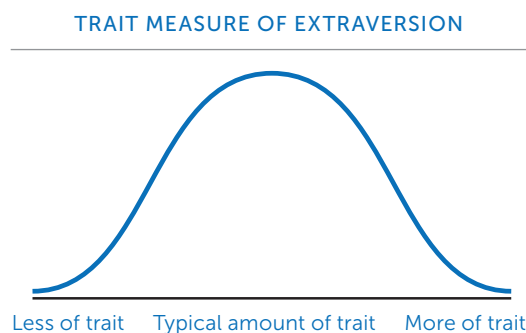
This module is designed to provide you with the information and practice you will need to meet these professional responsibilities.

Type Sorting vs. Trait Measuring: MBTI® Instruments Compared to Most Other Personality Instruments

The MBTI assessment is different from most other personality instruments. It is designed to sort people into categories, while most other assessments are designed to measure how much of a characteristic a person has. This difference underlies construction decisions and other psychometric processes such as checking reliability and validity.

Trait-Measuring Assessments

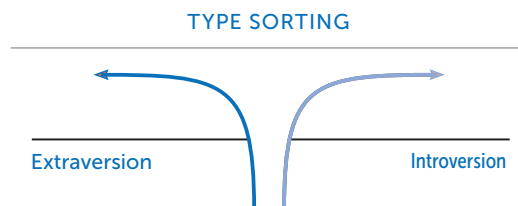
Most personality assessments measure relatively stable behavioral habits, or *traits*, that everyone has to some degree. Trait-measuring instruments ask a number of questions about behaviors believed to be related to a characteristic and then score a respondent's results to report how much or how little of a particular characteristic the respondent has.



For example, with a trait instrument that measures extraversion, an individual's result would be interpreted as an indication of how much Extraversion the individual displays and therefore how extraverted that individual is: About average? A lot? Very little? Scores to the right of a distribution are above average, outside the typical or normal range. Scores to the left are below average, outside the normal range.

Type-Sorting Assessments

MBTI items are not designed to measure how much or how little of a characteristic people have or display. Instead, their purpose is to sort individuals into categories that identify their natural preferences in four areas. It's an either-or issue, so too much or too little is irrelevant. In this way, type is similar to other categorical sorting, such as sorting according to whether you follow a vegetarian or non-vegetarian diet, or the sports team you support, or the political party you voted for in the last election, or the eye color you have.



PROBABILITY INDEXES

The numbers, or scores, a respondent sees on MBTI reports when the Step I items are computer scored are called *probability indexes* because they indicate how probable or likely it is that the preferences reported are accurate for the respondent. Four probability indexes are reported for each respondent—one for each preference pair. Probability indexes fall into three different scoring categories:

- **Very likely:** The respondent very consistently chose one pole over the other when responding to items related to the preference pair in question. There is a reasonably high probability that the respondent will agree that the reported type is accurate.
- **Likely:** The respondent consistently chose one pole over the other when responding to items related to the preference pair in question. There is reasonable probability that the respondent will agree that the reported type is accurate.
- **Somewhat likely:** The respondent did not consistently choose items associated with one pole over the other. While it is more likely that the reported type is correct than incorrect, we can be less certain that the respondent will agree with the reported type.

Construction of the MBTI® Step I™ Assessment

This section responds to the first two “professional questions” listed on page 22: How was the assessment developed? What samples were used?

In the early 1940s, Isabel Myers began to work on a psychological assessment that would make the Jung-Myers personality theory accessible to a wide audience. She continually tested and revised her work over the next decades, which resulted in the publication of Form F (1962) of the *Myers-Briggs Type Indicator*® (MBTI) assessment. Subsequent updated forms of the MBTI assessment were published in the following decades.

The current standard form of the MBTI Step I assessment is the MBTI® Global Step I™ assessment, which was developed by The Myers-Briggs Company (formerly CPP, Inc.) and published in 2018. Item selection and scoring were based on data from a global sample of more than 16,000 adults around the world and numerous other samples. The process used in compiling the global sample is described in the *MBTI® Manual*, chapter 7. The chapter includes data on the composition of the sample and estimates of type distributions for adult men and women in the global sample. The Global Step II assessment was also based on this sample. Its development is addressed in Module 5.

Data on the specific country/language samples that are included in the global sample can be found in the MBTI® Manual Global Supplements, available as free downloads from www.themyersbriggs.com/mbti-manual-supplements.

MBTI® CONSTRUCTION FAQS

Listed below are some of the questions most frequently asked about the construction of the MBTI Step I assessment.

- Where did the MBTI items come from?
- How did the developers decide which items to include? How do we know the items are working?
- Why did I have to choose? I do both.
- The questions seem trivial. How can they tell me anything important about myself?
- Why does the MBTI assessment have phrase and word-pair items?
- Why aren't the options logical opposites?
- How did you score my results?
- How were the type descriptions written?

Use the information below to help you formulate answers to client questions about the construction of the MBTI assessment.

Where did the MBTI® items come from?

Isabel Myers developed the original items based on observations of people's behavior from the perspective of the Jung-Myers theory of psychological type. This item development required an in-depth understanding of the characteristics of the types, which Myers and Briggs attained through 20 years of studying Jung's theory and applying it to people they knew.

The items in the MBTI® Global Step I™ assessment are primarily either Myers' original items or updated versions of them.

How did the developers decide which items to include? How do we know the items are working?

For the Global Step I assessment, Myers-Briggs Company researchers used responses from participants in a global sample of more than 16,000 adults to decide which items were doing the best job of sorting people into their type preferences.

Data were analyzed from three statistical perspectives: classical test theory, item response theory (IRT), and latent class analysis (LCA).

For more information on scoring of the MBTI assessments, see *MBTI® Manual*, chapter 7, pp. 138–156.

Why did I have to choose? I do both.

Myers and Briggs' goal was to operationalize the Jung-Myers theory of personality. Built on Jung's theory, this states that both of the opposites in each preference pair are accessible to and used by everyone and are potentially positive attributes, but that people have a natural preference for one over the other.

CONTINUED

MBTI® CONSTRUCTION FAQs *CONTINUED*

The forced-choice nature of the MBTI items fits this theory: "Here are two options. Both of them are positive; everyone uses both. Now you must choose which one most appeals to you."

That being said, it is not necessary to have dichotomous items to measure dichotomous preferences. Forced-choice items are retained today in part because they are quick to answer, which is true especially when all items are of the same format.

The questions seem trivial. How can they tell me anything important about myself?

Myers' explanation was that the type preferences are like the wind, while the questions are "straws in the wind"—they indicate which way the wind is blowing. We can't directly see Sensing, but we can see the effects of using Sensing perception.

Historically, research has shown that the items that use simple, everyday behaviors as indicators of underlying preferences have worked best to allow a wide range of people to identify their preferences.

Why does the MBTI® assessment have both phrase and word-pair items?

Early forms of the MBTI assessment consisted entirely of phrase items. Myers discovered that different people brought different mind-sets to responding to the phrase items. Some focused on key words and answered according to their general sense of what fit for them, while others referred back to the last time they had been in the situation presented by the item.

Phrase items may be influenced by current work or family responsibilities:

- When you go somewhere for the day, would you rather
- a. plan what you will do and when,
 - or
 - b. just go?

Myers decided to try using word-pair items as a way to lessen the situational influence and require respondents to focus on key words. While the word-pair items can seem simple, finding the right words to pair has created some of the more effective items on the MBTI assessment.

Why aren't the options logical opposites?

Many of the items—especially the word-pair items—have response options that are not logically opposite each other, and some respondents will point that out. Remember, MBTI opposites need to be equally attractive and acceptable (for example, scheduled vs. unplanned), while "logical" opposites might have negative connotations (for example, sensitive vs. insensitive). The word pairs are "psychological opposites"—designed to appeal to people with opposite preferences.

How did you score my results?

Computer scoring of the Global Step I assessment is based on latent class analysis (LCA) equations created from the responses of the participants in the global sample used to create the global form. Responses are weighted according to how well each item sorts between preferences: Items that discriminate more sharply are given more weight than those that discriminate less sharply.

MBTI® CONSTRUCTION FAQS CONTINUED

LCA produces not only a preference classification but also a probability that the preference will be the same when the assessment is retaken.

Note: The self-scorable version of the Step I assessment is not computer scored, so a simplified scoring procedure is used to best match the computer-scored results. The advantage of the self-scorable version is that it makes scoring of the items possible when online scoring, which is more precise, is unavailable.

For more information, see Module 3 in this guide, pp. 37–54, or the *MBTI® Manual*, chapter 6, pp. 100–101, “Selection of Available Step I” and Step II” Forms” and “Administration Guidelines.”

How were the type descriptions written?

The MBTI interpretation process directs professionals to help clients verify their type by having them read type descriptions in the *Introduction to Myers-Briggs® Type* booklet. Myers decided that the best way to help people identify their best-fit type was to write descriptions of the personalities of normal, effective adult individuals whose behaviors are influenced by their type preferences. Thus,

- The ISTJ description portrays an effective adult individual who has ISTJ preferences
- The ENFP description portrays an effective adult individual who has ENFP preferences

SUMMARY

Many client questions relate to the construction issues discussed above. Being able to respond to these questions briefly, clearly, accurately, and nontechnically increases both the credibility of the MBTI assessment and your professional credibility with the client.

Reliability and Validity

This section provides the information you need to respond to the third and fourth questions professionals should ask, listed on page 22: Is the MBTI assessment reliable? Is it valid? In the MBTI® Certification Program, we ask you to learn the definition of each of these psychometric terms and how to access data to respond to client questions about them.

Many respondent and client decision-maker questions relate to reliability and validity. For example,

- I took the MBTI assessment in graduate school. If I take it again now, am I likely to come out the same type?
- Can the MBTI assessment be used with university students? With retired people?
- Does type relate to my career choice? To my relationship choices?
- Will the MBTI assessment really help me understand leadership style?
- Will the MBTI assessment improve communication in the team? Decision making?

Infrequently, practitioners interact with a client who knows about principles of testing and really wants to know: Is the MBTI assessment reliable? What’s the evidence? Is it valid? How do you know?

The information below defines the terms *reliability* and *validity*, explains how these terms relate to the MBTI assessment and explains how you can access reliability and validity data for those clients who want to see them.

Reliability

The meaning of reliability in tests (instruments) is similar to its meaning in everyday language:

- Are the instrument's results consistent?
- How much error is there in this measuring device?

When we use an instrument to measure something—the scale we use to weigh ourselves, our car's speedometer, a tape measure—the measurement we get always has some error in it. As a result, we expect that the instrument's results will not be perfectly consistent; but we need to know that there is enough consistency to be able to use them with confidence.

For the MBTI Step I instrument, reliability asks whether its results are consistent and repeatable enough for professionals to use it with confidence. Reliability checks reported in the *MBTI® Manual* (chapter 8) report the results of test-retest and internal consistency research to assess the reliability of the Step I and Step II instruments.

CONCLUSION (WHAT THE RELIABILITY DATA INDICATE)

MBTI Step I reliability checks show good to excellent internal consistency reliability—checked by gender, age, ethnicity, and employment status. Each preference scale has alphas of at least .80 in the global sample.

Tables 8.6 (pp. 167–168), 8.7 (p. 169), and 8.8 (p. 170) in the *MBTI® Manual* show that the internal consistency reliabilities of the Global Step II facet scales are comparable to those of the subscales of other mainstream personality assessments.

Test-retest data for the MBTI Step I assessment are worthy of some explanation.

- Test-retest studies typically focus on one continuous scale and use a correlation to determine the strength of the relationship between scores at time 1 and at time 2 a few weeks later. When analyzed in this way, the continuous MBTI preference scores in the global sample are each very stable over time, with at least a .81 correlation.
- Another way to measure test-retest agreement is to examine the percentage of respondents who reported the same preference result at time 1 and time 2. On these measures, the MBTI preferences are again very stable over time, with each preference showing 77% agreement or more in the global sample and 82% agreement or more in the US sample.
- Whole-type test-retest agreement rates tend to be in the 50%–60% range. Whole-type (multiscale) agreement means that the exact same four-letter type is reported at time 1 and time 2. Critics seize on this result to imply that the MBTI assessment is inaccurate. However,

- The rate of chance agreement on all preference pairs on retest is 6.25% (1 in 16), not 50%, as critics sometimes suggest (they often confuse the dichotomous nature of the preferences with what whole-type agreement actually calculates—which uses all four preference scales). The whole-type test-retest agreement rate for the MBTI Step I assessment is 8 to 10 times better than chance.
- Other assessments rarely if ever publish *multiscale* test-retest agreement rates, where more than one measure is taken into account and all must match to be considered correct.
- The most common result on retest is reporting the same four preferences (i.e., the same four-letter type). The second most common result is matching three out of four preferences. Table 8.12 in the *MBTI® Manual* (p. 172) shows that 84% of individuals in the combined sample changed no preferences or only one preference at retest. A trivial number of individuals—less than 1% in the US—report the opposite type on retest.
- When people report a different preference on retest, it tends to be on a preference pair on which they scored “somewhat likely” on the first completion (i.e., close to the cutoff point). Thus, based on scores at time 1, it is somewhat predictable who will change and on which preference(s) at time 2.

Validity

Validity asks the following of tests:

- Are the results true?
- Can we use the results for the purposes the test developer says we can?

The MBTI assessment gives people information about their Myers-Briggs® personality type. So, the validity question for the MBTI assessment is:

- Do we have evidence that MBTI results sort people into the types described by Jung and Myers?

Thousands of validity studies have been conducted on the MBTI assessment, with many addressing these questions:

- Do people agree with their type description? (See *MBTI® Manual*, chapter 9, table 9.43, “MBTI® Global Sample Letter Agreement Rates Between Reported and Best-Fit Type,” p. 277.)
- Do people choose careers as type theory would predict? (See *MBTI® Manual*, chapter 9, “Occupational Selection and Careers,” pp. 201–216, and chapter 5, table 5.2. “Type Table of Training and Development Specialists in the US Sample,” p. 86.)
- Do people behave as type theory would predict? Do MBTI results relate to people’s results on other psychological assessments as type theory would predict? (See *MBTI® Manual*, chapter 9, “Type Differences Observed on Scales from Other Assessments,” pp. 187–197.)

The *MBTI® Manual* offers a good deal of validity data. To survey the studies it includes, see the lists of tables and figures provided in the front of the manual. Specific topics (for example, “leadership development”) are listed in the manual’s validity chapters and in the index.

ADDITIONAL CURRENT VALIDITY INFORMATION

- Contact The Myers-Briggs Company or your local distributor for research updates relevant to your region.
- Visit The Myers-Briggs Company website, www.themyersbriggs.com, which offers numerous case studies of MBTI use by different companies for different purposes. It also offers research papers, videos, interviews, and other information. These can be found in the "Resources" section.
- Visit the Mary & Isabel's Library Online (MILO®) catalog at the Myers & Briggs Foundation website, <https://www.myersbriggs.org/research-and-library/isabel-briggs-myers-library/>. This catalog produces a list of studies, conference presentations, articles, and other resources on the topic. The database currently includes more than 11,000 research studies on the MBTI assessment.

Contracting to Use the MBTI® Assessment

The following are essential questions to address when contracting to use the MBTI assessment with a team or an individual:

- What does the client want to achieve? Is the MBTI assessment appropriate for this purpose? This relates to the fifth question professionals should ask (see p. 22). The MBTI assessment has a wide range of appropriate applications in promoting individual and team development. However, it should not be used to limit people such as in selection.
- What is the time frame for the interpretation and application session? Be sure sufficient time is allowed.
- Who will attend the MBTI session? Be sure to address any hierarchy/authority issues.
- How will you administer the MBTI assessment? How will you ensure that clients have the right mind-set and administration instructions? Which report will you provide?
- What supporting materials will you use?
- How will you handle it if someone does not show up for the session? Everyone completing the MBTI assessment needs to have an interactive interpretation session, either face-to-face or by phone with a certified practitioner or online through MBTI®Complete.
- How and for how long will respondents' results be stored? Who will have access to the results? How will you ensure confidentiality?

Experience demonstrates that dealing with these issues up front, during the contracting/agreement stage, averts many potential problems.

Ethical Principles and Appropriate Uses of the MBTI® Assessment

Ethical Principles for Practitioners

Professional organizations publish ethical guidelines and requirements for using psychological assessments. Visit the websites of The Myers-Briggs Company (www.themyersbriggs.com), and the

LEARNING MODULE 2: Meeting Professional Responsibilities for Using the MBTI® Assessment

Myers & Briggs Foundation (<https://www.myersbriggs.org>) to find reference material on the ethical principles that apply to use of the MBTI assessment.

The following are the most important ethical principles for MBTI practitioners.

- Respondents must be informed of the purpose for taking the MBTI assessment, and they must take it voluntarily.
- The MBTI assessment is intended to support individual self-understanding and growth and to enhance understanding of differences in others.
- MBTI results should not be used to select or limit anyone on the basis of type.
- Results of the MBTI assessment belong to the individual respondent. Results are confidential, and only individual respondents can decide who their results are shared with.
- All respondents who complete the MBTI assessment should be provided an interactive overview of type theory and an explanation of the preferences before they receive their results.
- Type descriptions and definitions need to be given without bias or stereotyping, with the preferences and types presented as normal differences.
- MBTI results must be verified by respondents after they have learned about the preferences, received their results, and read type descriptions in one of the booklets in the *Introduction to Myers-Briggs® Type* series.
- Respondents may agree or disagree with their reported type, and they are the final judge of which type fits for them.
- Practitioners will respect data protection laws, copyright laws, and any other laws of their country in using MBTI materials.
- Practitioners will use correct references to the MBTI assessment and type materials.

Ethics of Administration

Yes

Use for self-understanding
Voluntary
Results confidential
Interactive interpretation required
Respondent is final judge

No

Use for selection
Compulsory
Results shared without permission
No interpretation provided
MBTI practitioner "knows best"

Application of Ethical Principles to Work Settings

Most practitioners readily see the wisdom of the ethical principles and the values underlying them. At the same time, they are appropriately concerned about applying them, especially in organizational settings. Refer to chapter 6 in the *MBTI® Manual* for information on administration and interpretation and to the validity chapters (9 and 10) for discussion of use for a multitude of applications and in various settings.

REVIEW: PROFESSIONAL RESPONSIBILITIES

POINTS TO REMEMBER

- Differences between the MBTI assessment and most other personality instruments, which are typically trait oriented (i.e., they measure amounts or degrees of a characteristic), and the impacts on interpretation of MBTI results
- MBTI construction issues, such as the following:
 - Where did the MBTI items come from?
 - Why do the items force a choice between two options?
 - Why are the options not always logical opposites?
 - Why were word-pair items added?
 - How were the type descriptions in the *Introduction to Myers-Briggs® Type* booklet written?
- Definition of reliability as applied to tests (assessments)
- Definition of validity as applied to tests (assessments)

TEST YOUR LEARNING by responding to the following statements and questions. Check your answers using the key below.

1. Which of the following is *not* a reason why it is important to understand the differences between type and trait?
 - a. To be sure that you are using the correct language for each with participants
 - b. To be sure that your clients understand the difference between preference and behavior
 - c. To be able to demonstrate that type sorting is a better way of understanding personality than trait measurement
 - d. To interpret MBTI results as a probability of correct sorting rather than a measurable amount of a preference
2. Which of the following is true of results on the MBTI assessment?
 - a. Most results fall in the "somewhat likely" category
 - b. They indicate how often people use each preference
 - c. They report how consistently a respondent chose one side of a preference pair over the other
 - d. They measure how well people have learned to use their type
3. The items on the MBTI assessment force respondents to choose between two good alternatives because the assessment is based on:
 - a. A theory that presents pairs of socially acceptable opposites
 - b. A theory that identifies positives and negatives
 - c. A theory that identifies traits
 - d. Analysis of research data
4. An assessment that is reliable will demonstrate which of the following in reliability research?
 - a. Respondents receive similar results when they retake the assessment
 - b. Respondents receive different results depending on their age
 - c. Results will correlate with results on other psychological assessments
 - d. Results will be a fairly good predictor of job satisfaction

REVIEW: PROFESSIONAL RESPONSIBILITIES CONTINUED

5. In a test-retest study on the MBTI assessment, when a respondent reports a different type upon taking the assessment a second time it is most likely to be:
 - a. Because the respondent lacks any self-awareness
 - b. On a preference pair on which the respondent scored "somewhat likely" on the first completion
 - c. On a preference pair on which the respondent scored "very likely" on the first completion
 - d. Because the respondent completed the assessment in a different format (e.g., self-scorable vs. online)
6. What is the most common result when a respondent completes the MBTI assessment for a second time (test-retest reliability)?
 - a. The respondent reports the same type as the first time
 - b. The respondent reports the opposite type from the first time
 - c. The respondent changes the preference on which he or she scored somewhat likely
 - d. The respondent receives the exact same probability index on all four preferences
7. Which of the following is a validity question?
 - a. Do MBTI results correlate with the results of a test of leadership styles?
 - b. I see you took the MBTI assessment three years ago and again this year. Are your later results the same as the earlier ones?
 - c. I see you're in a new job. Have your preferences changed over time?
 - d. Do people of different ages get consistent results?
8. When the MBTI assessment is compared to other personality assessments:
 - a. The MBTI assessment looks at components of personality that are drastically different from those looked at by other instruments, so the MBTI assessment's validity cannot be measured in this way
 - b. MBTI scales correlate with the scales of other assessments that measure similar concepts, showing clear evidence for the MBTI assessment's validity
 - c. The MBTI assessment does not correlate in any useful way with other assessments, discrediting its validity
 - d. MBTI scales correlate with the scales of other assessments in a manner that contradicts other models of personality, discrediting the MBTI assessment's validity
9. To use the MBTI assessment ethically:
 - a. You cannot share clients' type results with their boss, but it is acceptable to share them with clients' teammates
 - b. You can share clients' type results with their teammates only during a team-building session to solve team problems
 - c. You can share clients' type results with a mutual friend, as long as that friend understands type in depth
 - d. You can share a client's type results only with the client's permission
10. When the MBTI assessment is used for team building, team members:
 - a. Must receive a one-on-one interpretation of their results
 - b. Must participate in an interactive process to understand their results
 - c. Must share their results with the team
 - d. Must share their results with their manager

Review answers: 1 c, 2 c, 3 a, 4 a, 5 b, 6 a, 7 a, 8 b, 9 d, 10 b

LEARNING MODULE 2 ACTION PLAN

In the table below, use a pencil to assess where you are right now.

During the certification program, you will be directed to review and revise your self-assessment and action plan each evening. Your final task in the program will be to identify steps to prepare yourself to use the MBTI assessment in your work setting.

✓ Put a check mark in the box that identifies your current self-assessment.

- Got It: ✓ Have enough information to do this competently now
- Need More: ✓ Generally understand, but need more information and/or practice
- Don't Have It: ✓ Not at all confident of my current knowledge or ability to use it
- Summary: ✓ Satisfied, confident, ready to go with this item
✗ Want to include this in my action plan steps as I go forward

Things I need to know	Got It	Need More	Don't Have It	Summary for Action Plan
PROFESSIONAL RESPONSIBILITIES				
TYPE SORTING VS. TRAIT MEASURING				
CONSTRUCTION OF THE MBTI STEP I ASSESSMENT				
Source of items				
How items were selected				
Why items are forced-choice				
Why questions seem trivial				
Psychological opposites				
Scoring				
RELIABILITY AND VALIDITY				
Definition of reliability				
What reliability data indicate				
Definition of validity				
What validity studies address				
CONTRACTING				
ETHICAL PRINCIPLES				

LEARNING MODULE 2 ACTION PLAN <i>CONTINUED</i>	
Priorities for Learning Module 2	Ideas: Steps to take, materials to read, etc.
1.	
2.	
3.	
4.	
5.	

LEARNING MODULE 3

DAY 2: Using the MBTI® Assessment with Individuals

LEARNING MODULE 3

TO PREPARE FOR DAY 2, AFTERNOON

Read in this *Participant's Resource Guide*:

- Learning Module 3

Check your understanding by responding to the review questions in this module, pp. 43 and 51.

Prepare for the required interpretation practice using any or all of the following resources:

- "Outline for Presenting Type to Individuals" in this module, pp. 49–50
- *Introduction to Myers-Briggs® Type (ITT)* booklet
- *MBTI® Step I® Feedback Cards*
- *Exploring Your Myers-Briggs® Type Workbook*
- *Understanding and Working with Personality Type* workshop facilitation kit
- *Giving Feedback to Individuals on the MBTI® Global Step I® Assessment* video

TO DEEPEN YOUR UNDERSTANDING

To learn more about Learning Module 3 topics after the certification program, read the following.

MBTI® Manual

- Chapter 4, "The 16 Types and the 20 Facets," pp. 46–66, "The 16 Step I® Types"
- Chapter 5 (entire chapter), "Type Tables and Groupings of MBTI® Preferences," pp. 83–95
- Chapter 6, "Administering and Interpreting the MBTI® Step I® and Step II® Assessments," pp. 98–101, "Administering the Assessments"; pp. 101–103, "The Process of Interpreting and Verifying Step I® and Step II® Results"; pp. 103–109, "Interpreting and Verifying Step I® Results"

Note: Learning Module 1 presented the basics of Myers-Briggs personality type theory, definitions of the MBTI preferences and preference pairs, and information about using the MBTI assessment with teams or work groups. That information is also essential for using the MBTI assessment and type with individual clients.

Learning Module 3 will not repeat that information but will instead focus on guidelines and specific issues in administering and interpreting the MBTI assessment.

Agenda Day 2, Afternoon

Administration guidelines

Administration and scoring practice

Interpretation guidelines and guidance

The meaning of MBTI results

Interpretation practice

Learning Module 3 exam

Administering the MBTI® Assessment

The primary requirement in setting up your MBTI administration process and instructions is to present and position the MBTI assessment so that your clients can respond to it with the right mind-set. They should be able to respond to the items as their natural self without regard to pressures of work or other factors.

General Administration Guidelines

- Taking the MBTI assessment is voluntary.
- There is no time limit for completing it. However, clients should not agonize over their responses, as their first thoughtful response is likely to be the most appropriate for them. Give them a general time frame (see below) so that they can schedule enough time to complete the assessment in one sitting.
 - MBTI®Complete online (Step I or Step II items + Interactive Learning Session): 60–90 minutes
 - Step I online: 15–25 minutes
 - Step II online: 25–30 minutes
 - Step I (Form M) self-scorable: 15–20 minutes + 15–20 minutes for scoring

Note: These time frames assume that respondents are completing the MBTI assessment in their native/first language.

- Do not define or explain words or phrases. Tell clients to respond to the items according to their own understanding or leave an item unanswered if they cannot provide a response. Keep in mind that the maximum number of items that may be omitted is four.
- There are no right or wrong answers, no better or worse results.
- MBTI results belong to the person taking the assessment and are confidential. They will not be given to anyone else by the administrator without the client's permission.

Note: You may—carefully—read the items to clients who are unable to read them because of physical disability or reading problems. It is important to present the item options in a neutral manner. Online administration is recommended for those who are partially sighted or blind, as it allows the use of a screen reader.

Establishing the Desired Mind-Set and Encouraging Accurate Responding to the MBTI® Assessment

The practitioner's goal during administration is to give clients the best opportunity to receive results that are accurate and useful for them. For this to work, clients need to:

- Understand the purpose for using the MBTI assessment
- Be interested in taking the assessment and receiving feedback on their results, and believe that this will be a positive—or at least neutral—experience
- Know that completing the assessment is voluntary, that they may choose not to take it
- Trust that the results will be confidential and will not be used to limit them
- Understand that they are to respond to the items as their natural self, not focusing on how they are in particular situations (e.g., at work or in a role they are expected to fulfill)
- Know that they will have an opportunity during a feedback session to assess whether their results fit them by reading one or more type descriptions; they can then choose which description fits them best
- Be reassured that the feedback session is an opportunity to explore their preferences; they do not have to decide on a best-fit type during the session. For some people, this is a process that requires reflection over a period of time. When clients are unsure of their best-fit type, you can suggest that they choose a “hypothesized type” until they become clearer about which type fits them best.

Especially in organizational settings, practitioners need to address the issue of mind-set directly and clarify the desirability of having clients respond to items as their natural, nonwork self. One useful way to address this is to say,

“Respond to the items as you are outside of the various roles you play, whether work related or in your personal life. Think about what you prefer when you are not under pressure to do things a particular way.”

OPTIONS FOR ADMINISTERING THE MBTI® ASSESSMENT

There are four ways clients can complete the MBTI assessment.

1. MBTI®Complete

Administration time: 60–90 minutes

- The assessment is taken online prior to an in-person individual or group session to explore and apply type.
- The practitioner can administer either Step I items or Step II items.
- Clients take the assessment and then work through an online Interactive Learning Session that includes a basic introduction to type, an opportunity to self-assess on the four preference pairs, presentation of their Step I reported type, and exploration of their best-fit type.
- At the end of the process, clients receive three pages of information about the type they chose as their best-fit type.
- For each client, the practitioner receives a report that contains these three pages of information plus the client's MBTI® Step I™ Profile report, which shows the probability indexes and categories for the type the client reported on the assessment.
- The practitioner can order, for an additional fee, a range of other Step I interpretive reports, such as the Interpretive Report for Organizations or the Personal Impact Report. The practitioner can also order the Step II Interpretive Report (provided that the Step II items were administered) without asking the client to complete the assessment again. These reports will reflect the four-letter best-fit type the client chose through MBTI®Complete. If, during a subsequent in-person session, the client decides that a different type is a better fit, the practitioner can use the Elevate® platform to provide a new report based on the client's verified type.

Possible uses/indications

- When a practitioner has limited one-on-one time with a client and wants to focus that time on applying type insights. Through MBTI®Complete, clients will have gained some familiarity with the preferences, self-assessed their type, and received a report on what they see as their best-fit type. This means that during a subsequent individual or group session to explore and apply type the practitioner will only need to briefly recap the preferences and double-check best-fit type before moving on to applying this understanding.
- When a practitioner wants to know client results and initial type verification prior to an introductory type session.
- For clients at a distance, with whom the practitioner will be interacting by phone or email.
- For a client joining a team or work group that has already been using type, to enable the new member to get up to speed quickly.

Keep in mind

- It is crucial that this online process be the starting point of exploration, not the end. Clients need an opportunity to interact with an MBTI® Certified Practitioner one-on-one or in a workshop setting following the use of MBTI®Complete.
- It is still important to discuss with clients what they self-assessed and their reported results and whether they will require further exploration to be confident of their verified type.
- Clients should still review the detailed type descriptions in ITT to help them clarify their best-fit type.
- Clients must have internet access and the ability to download their type description at the end of the process.
- The practitioner must have access to The Myers-Briggs Company's Elevate platform or an authorized distributor's online administration site or bureau service.

OPTIONS FOR ADMINISTERING THE MBTI® ASSESSMENT *CONTINUED*

2. MBTI® Step I™ online

Administration time: 15–25 minutes

- The assessment is taken online prior to an in-person feedback session or workshop.
- A range of Step I reports are available that can be given to the client (see Online Reports in appendix B).
- The assessment produces Step I four-letter type and includes probability indexes and probability categories.
- The verified type option allows the practitioner to regenerate any interpretive report to reflect the client's best-fit type.

Possible uses/indications

- When a practitioner has limited one-on-one time with a client and wants to focus that time on giving feedback, helping the client verify a best-fit type, and applying insights
- When a practitioner wants to provide clients with reports that provide rich interpretive information for them to use during and after the feedback session
- To get the best indication of a client's Step I type with the most accurate scoring

Keep in mind

- Clients must have internet access.
- The practitioner must have access to The Myers-Briggs Company's Elevate platform or an authorized distributor's online administration site or bureau service.
- The most efficient approach is for the practitioner to have clients complete the MBTI Step II assessment (see option 3) even if only their Step I results will be used initially. The Step II assessment contains all the Step I items, which means practitioners have the option to first generate a Step I report and subsequently generate a Step II report for the same client without the client needing to take another assessment.

3. MBTI® Step II™ online

Administration time: 25–30 minutes

- The assessment is taken online prior to an in-person feedback session.
- A range of Step II and Step I reports are available that can be given to the client (see Online Reports in appendix B).
- The assessment produces Step II facet results and polarity index, and also Step I four-letter type, probability indexes, and probability categories.
- The verified type option allows the practitioner to regenerate any Step I or Step II interpretive report to reflect the client's best-fit type.

Possible uses/indications

- When a practitioner is using MBTI Step II scoring and reports. Online administration is the only way to access Step II information.
- When a practitioner wants to first take a client through Step I interpretation with an interpretive report and subsequently generate the client's Step II results. This is possible because the Step II assessment contains all the Step I items.

CONTINUED

OPTIONS FOR ADMINISTERING THE MBTI® ASSESSMENT CONTINUED

Keep in mind

- Clients must have internet access.
- The practitioner must have access to The Myers-Briggs Company's Elevate platform or an authorized distributor's online administration site or bureau service.

Note: MBTI Step II online administration produces both Step I four-letter type results and Step II facet results.

4. MBTI® Step I™ (Form M) self-scorable assessment

Administration time: 15–20 minutes

Scoring time: 15–20 minutes

- The assessment is administered when the practitioner and client are face-to-face in either one-on-one or group settings.
- This self-contained booklet includes the 93 MBTI Step I (Form M) items, an answer sheet, and self-scoring instructions.
- The assessment provides reported Step I type and scores presented as preference clarity categories.

Possible uses/indications

- When it is difficult or impossible for clients to access the internet
- When a practitioner cannot access The Myers-Briggs Company's Elevate platform or an authorized distributor's online administration site or bureau service
- When administration and feedback must be completed during the same in-person session

Keep in mind

- Administration and scoring require in-person interaction with the MBTI practitioner, which reduces by 30–40 minutes the time available in the session to explore and apply type.
- Self-scorable assessments should not be mailed to clients or otherwise distributed prior to a workshop or one-on-one meeting with a client.
- Computer scoring cannot be used with this version of the assessment.
- The practitioner cannot access results prior to the feedback session.

Note: The self-scorable version of the MBTI Step I assessment should not be mailed out or otherwise distributed prior to an introductory type session, even with a detailed cover letter. Experience shows that many clients will tear open the assessment booklet and score it prior to the session, regardless of the instructions they have been given.

When you use the Step I self-scorable assessment, follow these steps when you meet with your clients:

1. Clarify the purpose for using the assessment and the objectives for the session.
2. Give administration instructions and establish the desired mind-set for completing the assessment.
3. Distribute the self-scorable assessment and give clients time to complete the items.
4. After clients have completed the assessment, ask them to put the assessment aside without scoring it while you provide a standard introduction to type, with definitions, examples, and self-assessment.
5. Direct clients through scoring their responses.
6. Lead clients through the type verification process.

OPTIONS FOR ADMINISTERING THE MBTI® ASSESSMENT CONTINUED

Note: Once you have a client's verified Step I type from either online or self-scorable administration, you can use it to generate a range of MBTI Step I reports from The Myers-Briggs Company's Elevate platform or an authorized distributor's online administration site or bureau service.

REVIEW: ADMINISTRATION

POINTS TO REMEMBER

- Administration guidelines
- Establishing the desired client mind-set for completing the MBTI assessment
- Sequence of steps to follow when using the Step I self-scorable assessment

TEST YOUR LEARNING by responding to the following statements and questions. Check your answers using the key below.

1. When you are establishing the desired client mind-set for taking the MBTI assessment, you need to:
 - a. Be sure people realize how serious they need to be about completing the items
 - b. Be sure people know to respond according to how they are at work
 - c. Be sure people know to respond according to how they are at home with family
 - d. Be sure people understand that taking the assessment is voluntary and confidential
2. You are administering the MBTI assessment and someone asks you how much more time is available. The correct reply is:
 - a. Work quickly; you need to complete the items in 20 to 30 minutes
 - b. Take all the time you want so that you can think very carefully about your responses
 - c. There is no time limit
 - d. None of the above
3. When is it appropriate to have clients complete and score the Step I self-scorable assessment before they have received an introduction to type and self-assessed their type?
 - a. When workshop time is limited and you need to save time
 - b. It is never appropriate
 - c. When clients are mature participants who have a good level of self-knowledge
 - d. When clients have the *Introduction to Myers-Briggs® Type* booklet
4. A client questions the meaning of a word on the MBTI assessment. What is the appropriate response?
 - a. Tell the client, "Answer according to your understanding or skip that item."
 - b. Provide a standard dictionary for the client to use
 - c. Define the word, being sure to use neutral language and examples
 - d. All of the above are appropriate responses

Review answers: 1 d, 2 c, 3 b, 4 a

Interpreting MBTI® Results

The information and guidelines for presenting type to teams provided in Learning Module 1 also apply to presenting type to individuals. In all cases, presenting MBTI results needs to be part of an interactive process between client(s) and practitioner.

The practitioner's role in the MBTI type interpretation process is to help individuals verify the accuracy of their results. Practitioners do this by providing information about type and asking clients to consider the information in light of their knowledge of themselves. The practitioner needs to provide definitions and examples, written materials such as the *Introduction to Myers-Briggs® Type* booklet, opportunities for questions and discussion, and activities for or information about applying type.

Things to remember when interpreting results

Emphasize that respondents may agree or disagree with their MBTI results. Their **results are a hypothesis**—information about how they responded to the MBTI assessment items. In deciding on their best-fit type, your clients will also need to apply their knowledge and understanding of themselves.

Clients' responses to the MBTI items may be influenced by a number of factors, including expectations others have of them, their education and training, and their current work or personal situation. As the practitioner, it is your job to help your clients identify their true preferences apart from these influences.

Cultural and gender norms often influence how preferences are expressed.

The factors that influence how clients respond to the MBTI items also influence how they will respond to your explanations and definitions of type.

Be careful to give balanced and unbiased explanations of both preferences in each pair and to model proper use of type language and terms.

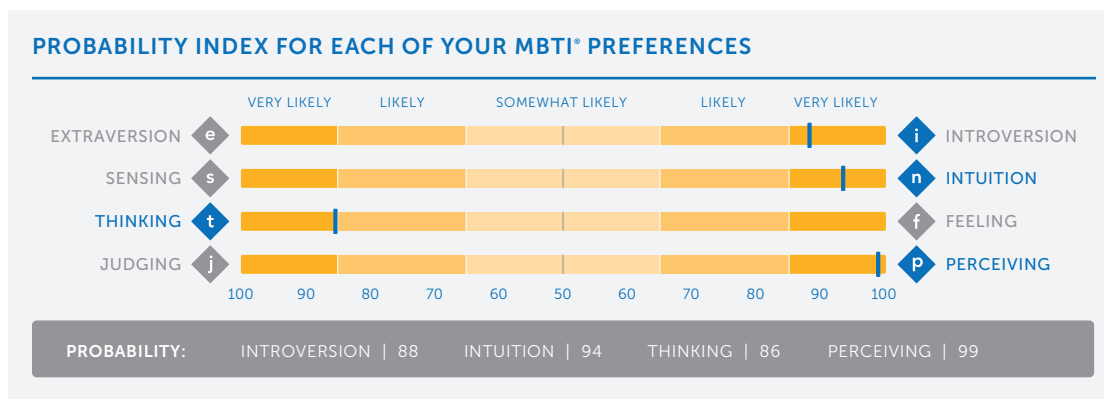
Be alert to clients' biases about type and help them reframe those.

Do not be concerned if clients disagree with their reported type. While it is worth exploring why they disagree, this is a perfectly normal response, especially when environmental factors, such as pressure to act in a particular way at work, affect how individuals respond to the assessment items. Review the *MBTI® Manual*, chapter 6, pp. 105–106, "Accuracy of Self-Reporting," for a list of common factors that influence self-reporting on the MBTI assessment.

Note: It is incorrect to assume that someone who prefers Thinking is "smarter" than someone who prefers Feeling, or that anyone who prefers Thinking is automatically intelligent. It is equally incorrect to assume that a person who prefers Feeling is more empathetic than one who prefers Thinking, or that anyone who prefers Feeling is automatically empathetic.

Interpreting the Probability Index

When the MBTI assessment is taken online, respondents receive a report identifying the preference they chose on each preference pair accompanied by a number between 51 and 99. For example, they might receive an E 97 or an I 66. This number is called the *probability index*. It indicates the likelihood of obtaining the same preference result if the assessment is taken again at a later time. The higher the probability index, the more consistent the individual was in responding to the items and the higher the likelihood that the preference is correct for that individual.



The probability index shows how clearly the respondent indicated a preference on a preference pair.

- **Higher probability index:** The respondent consistently chose one preference rather than the other and reported a preference clearly.
- **Lower probability index:** The respondent “split their vote” and did not report a preference as clearly.

Neither a higher probability index nor a lower one is good or bad. A probability index is merely an indication of how likely it is that an individual’s reported result is sorted into the correct side of a preference pair for that person.

The general rule: A probability index does not indicate better or worse results and should not be used as an indicator of a respondent’s effectiveness or skill level.

Probability indexes fall into three different scoring *probability categories*:

- **Very likely:** The respondent very consistently chose one preference over the other when responding to items related to the preference pair in question. There is a reasonably high probability that the respondent will agree that the reported preference is accurate.
- **Likely:** The respondent consistently chose one preference over the other when responding to items related to the preference pair in question. There is reasonable probability that the respondent will agree that the reported preference is accurate.
- **Somewhat likely:** The respondent did not consistently choose one preference over the other when responding to items related to the preference pair in question. While the reported type is more likely to be correct than incorrect, we can be less certain that the respondent will agree with the reported preference.

Preference Clarity Categories

Each preference result on the MBTI Step I (Form M) self-scorable assessment is presented as a letter identifying the preference chosen and a *preference clarity category*: very clear, clear, moderate, or slight. Preference clarity categories indicate the consistency with which a preference was reported. The greater the clarity, the greater the likelihood that the respondent will agree that the preference is accurate.

Note: A common error practitioners make in interpreting the numerical portion of MBTI results is assuming that it implies excellence. It is incorrect to assume that a person with a probability index of N 85 has a better command of Intuition than a person with N 70.

A Final Reminder About Interpreting Results

Research and practice indicate that respondents who report a preference clearly (higher probability index) are likely to agree with their results, while respondents who report less clearly (lower probability index) are likely to be less certain of their preference on that preference pair. However, there are many exceptions to this, and experienced practitioners are careful to ensure correct use of the probability index—both by themselves and by their clients.

The MBTI assessment has been proven reliable and valid. Research and practice indicate that most people agree with their type results, and assessment results should be treated as the best general indicator of Myers-Briggs type. In the global sample, when taken preference pair by preference pair, the percentage match between reported and best-fit preference is high, between 78.3% and 86.2% (see *MBTI® Manual*, chapter 7, table 7.6, p. 150). From a whole-type perspective, you can expect around 63% of your clients to agree with all four of their reported preferences and 78% to agree with three or four preferences (see *MBTI® Manual*, chapter 9, table 9.43, p. 277). When clients disagree with a preference in their reported type it is likely to be a preference on which their probability index is lower. However, even when a client reports preferences that are all in the “very likely” category, MBTI results must always be presented as a hypothesis requiring client verification during an interactive process with an MBTI® Certified Practitioner.

The Interpretation Process

Clients have the best opportunity to identify their best-fit type when practitioners follow the required steps for interpretation.

Steps in the interpretation process

1. Review the client's purpose for taking the MBTI assessment and outline the process you will be using.
2. Present a brief background on the MBTI theory and assessment—Jung, Myers, Briggs.
3. Establish the concept of *preference* using the handedness activity in the ITT booklet.
4. Introduce the preferences, being clear that there are no better or worse preferences or types. Define each preference pair and the eight preferences, giving relevant examples. Invite the client to self-assess during the process, prior to receiving results.
5. Return the client's results. Explain what they mean and do not mean.
6. Verify type by having the client read one or more full descriptions in the ITT booklet and exploring with the client what resonates and which aspects may be natural preferences versus learned behaviors. Have the client indicate which description best fits based on self-knowledge.

Remember, interpretation is a process. If the respondent is still unsure, see the suggestions below.

HELPING CLIENTS WHO ARE UNCLEAR ABOUT THEIR TYPE

Even when you have done everything right in administering the MBTI assessment—established the desired client mind-set, followed the proper steps in interpretation, used good examples and appropriate type descriptions—some clients will be unable to choose between two opposite preferences on one or more preference pairs. There can be several reasons for this. Clients may say, "I do both" or "I have to do both at work." To help such clients achieve clarity about a preference, try the following suggestions.

For any of the preference pairs

- Ask clients to give examples of their use of each preference in a pair. If they have taken the Step II assessment, point out that their Step II results may shed light on their use of both preferences and help them decide which is their overall preference.
- If the Step II assessment has not been administered, ask clients to provide examples of their use of the two preferences. When you have gained experience with the Step II assessment, you will probably be able to identify which facets clients are likely using in specific situations. In general, ask, "When do you use [preference]? How comfortable is that for you? When do you use [opposite preference]? How comfortable is it? Your *MBTI® Step I® Feedback Cards* will assist you in exploring scenarios and assist participants in identifying their preferences.
- Clients can benefit from exploring the various sources of pressure on their use of the preferences. These may include family, job role, organizational culture, and other sources.
- Listen for cues and feed them back to the client. For example, a client may say, "I *have* to do daily time sheets; it's part of my job." You can explore whether the client likes doing that or not. Use of language such as "I *must*," "I *have to*," and "I *should*" can be an indication of learned behavior rather than preference.

- Listen for bias and misunderstanding of preferences (e.g., “I can’t possibly prefer Introversion because I’m a salesperson” or “I’m not Extraverted because I don’t dominate conversations”). Clarify the MBTI meaning of the words.
- Exploring situations in which clients use each preference, where use of those preferences is rewarded or influenced by external pressures, and what learned behaviors may exist can be key in identifying natural preferences.
- Remind clients that they do not need to decide immediately what their preference is and that identifying it is a process. Often clients will notice their use of the preferences in the days and weeks following their introduction to the MBTI framework and become more confident of their preferences.

Note: When a client is unsure about a preference, avoid asking either-or questions: “So, do you do this, or do you do that?” The client has already responded to the Step I™ forced-choice questions, which didn’t help. You now need to give the client opportunities to reflect, to think and talk about experiencing use of this preference pair.

The following suggestions are especially useful if Step II™ feedback is not available or if Step II information has not been helpful in deciding on the underlying preference in a preference pair. These suggestions are taken from the *MBTI® Step I™ Feedback Cards*, which provide five aspects of each preference pair to explore during a feedback session. The feedback cards provide questions, prompts, and typical responses for each preference pair.



For E–I: Ask clients open-ended questions related to their comfort level in different settings, such as in large social groups or when working alone on a project. Ask about what energizes them or about how much alone time they need to “recover” from a day that required them to use a lot of Extraversion.



For S–N: Ask clients how they prefer to learn about a new idea or a suggestion for change. Then ask whether they see themselves seeking more Sensing information or more Intuitive information to understand the new idea or suggestion. Show them an everyday object (e.g., a coffee cup or a piece of clothing), then ask them how they think what they noticed about the object might relate to their preference for S or N.



For T–F: Ask clients to reflect on a decision they made recently. What was important to them in making that decision? Did their process seem more a logical Thinking process or more a decision based on values and concerns for the people involved (Feeling)?



For J–P: Ask clients how they plan a project and then ask them to reflect on how this relates to their preference for Judging or Perceiving. Ask them to reflect on and discuss how they use plans and agendas. Ask them to reflect on and discuss how they deal with last-minute changes in plans. And ask what they think their responses may indicate about their J–P preference.

Remember: It is not your role to identify your clients’ type. It is your role to provide information that can help your clients clarify their type or offer support for continuing to explore.

OUTLINE FOR PRESENTING TYPE TO INDIVIDUALS

Distribute the ITT booklet and use it during your introductory type session. It will lead you through the process, provide a structure for you, and ensure that your clients get accurate information. You can also provide the *Exploring Your Myers-Briggs® Type Workbook*, the structure of which reflects the feedback process. The workbook provides space for clients to make notes and create an action plan that they can refer to after the session.

Listed below are the steps for presenting type to individuals.

1. Clarify why the client is taking the MBTI assessment and establish confidentiality policies, including how and for how long you will store the client's MBTI data.

2. Outline the process you will use during your introductory type session.

3. Give brief background on/context for the MBTI assessment.

Based on theory developed by Jung and Myers

Instrument developed beginning in the early 1940s and revised many times in the intervening years

Global Step I assessment published in 2018 based on data from a global sample of more than 16,000 participants in 20 countries who took the global research version of the MBTI assessment in 19 languages

Most widely used personality inventory in the world

4. Define preference as used by the MBTI assessment.

Use "handedness" activity (ITT, p. 4)

Distinguish natural preference from developed skills

5. Define each pair of opposite preferences and give examples appropriate to the client.

Be sure to give equal time to both preferences and watch for biases—your own and your client's.

Direct the client's attention to definitions and characteristics (ITT, pp. 5–6).

Ask the client to talk about situational use of each preference in the pair: "When do you use Extraversion? When do you use your Introverted part?" This affirms that everyone uses both preferences in the pair and often helps clients clarify which preference is most energizing and which is more a response to environmental requirements.

Ask the client to self-assess for each pair of opposites: "Which do you think is your natural preference?" Refer back to the handedness activity if the client is having difficulty distinguishing natural preference from developed skills.

CONTINUED

OUTLINE FOR PRESENTING TYPE TO INDIVIDUALS *CONTINUED*

6. Verify type and decide on "best fit," if possible.

After going through all four sets of opposites, help the client identify a "first hypothesis," the four preferences the client chose as you were defining the preferences (ITT, p. 7).

Return the client's results, saying, "Here is a report on how you responded to the items on the MBTI assessment. This is your 'second hypothesis'" (ITT, p. 7). This gives clients clear ownership of their MBTI results.

If the two hypotheses are the same, have the client read the full description of that type (ITT, pp. 10–41) and discuss: What fits? What doesn't fit?

If the two hypotheses differ, lead the client through a verification process such as the one outlined in ITT (p. 8).

7. Use resources to help the client apply the information to his or her purpose for taking the assessment.

Applications material in ITT

Other resources

REVIEW: INTERPRETING MBTI® RESULTS

POINTS TO REMEMBER

- Steps in introducing type to individuals
- Meaning of results, scores, and probability indexes
- Practitioner's role: client's opportunity to choose best-fit type
- Helping clients who are undecided identify which type fits them best
- Making sure undecided clients do not feel pressured to decide on a type before they are ready

TEST YOUR LEARNING by responding to the following statements and questions. Check your answers using the key below.

1. When you are giving a basic introduction to and interpretation of the MBTI assessment, be sure to include:
 - a. Important Jungian psychological terms such as *psychological complex*
 - b. Nonbiased, balanced descriptions of the preference pair opposites
 - c. Explanation of latent class analysis scoring
 - d. Definitions of basic terms such as *normal distribution*
2. When you are giving a basic introduction to and interpretation of the MBTI assessment, which of the following is not important?
 - a. Emphasizing the importance of memorizing how the probability index links to the probability categories
 - b. Clarifying that there are no good or bad preferences or types
 - c. Explaining that we all use all the preferences
 - d. Making clear that type does not measure skills and abilities
3. If you were returning results to a client who reported T 53 (somewhat likely), which of the following would be a correct statement for you to make?
 - a. The score indicates that you may have trouble making decisions
 - b. The score indicates that you are probably well balanced in your decision making
 - c. The score indicates that you "split your vote" on the T and F items on the MBTI assessment
 - d. The score indicates that you are not clear about your preference
4. When you return results to clients and they disagree with them, the best response for you to make is:
 - a. Ask them to read the descriptions for their self-assessed type and their reported type, as well as other types if needed, to see which type fits best for them
 - b. Ask them to take the MBTI assessment again, this time thinking of themselves as a young person
 - c. Explain that the MBTI assessment is reliable and valid, so the results are likely to be correct
 - d. Suggest that they ask others (a close friend or colleague) to complete the MBTI items based on how they see the client
5. Which of the following is a reason respondents might disagree with their MBTI results?
 - a. Their English reading ability is measured as ninth-grade level
 - b. They are 18 years old, too young to have a type
 - c. They have developed equal use of all the preferences identified by type
 - d. They responded to the items based on how they are at work

Review answers: 1 b, 2 a, 3 c, 4 a, 5 d

Interpretation Practice

One of the requirements for MBTI certification is that you practice interpreting the MBTI assessment. Your initial practice will occur in a role-play activity in the afternoon of Day 2 of the certification program.

Your facilitator will create trios (or pairs or quartets, depending on the size of the group) of participants who will work together during this activity. The primary guideline for creating the trios is maximum type diversity within each trio, given the types in the program. Your facilitator will explain on Day 1 of the program the roles and steps in the activity and ask you to meet briefly with your trio colleagues to structure your activity (that is, to decide who will play each role in each round) and to exchange results.

During the role-play activity, each participant will play three roles, one in each of three rounds:

Professional

An MBTI® Certified Practitioner meeting with an individual client to provide an introductory explanation of type and the client's MBTI results.

Assumptions:

- You previously discussed with the client the purpose for using the MBTI assessment and agreed that it is appropriate.
- You administered the MBTI assessment to your client, with appropriate guidelines and mind-set.
- You are now meeting with the client to go through the steps of introducing type and the assessment, having the client self-assess as you define the preferences and preference pairs, providing the client's reported type, and leading the client through a verification process to arrive at best-fit type.

Client

A person who is interested in understanding how type may apply to them, who has completed the MBTI assessment, and who is now meeting with the professional to get their MBTI results.

Observer

A helpful colleague who will not participate in the professional-client interaction but instead will observe carefully and take notes with which to provide constructive feedback to the professional following the session with the client. Use the Observer's Worksheet in appendix C in this *Participant's Resource Guide* to record your notes as you observe the professional. Give the worksheet to the professional at the end of the feedback.

When the number of participants in a workshop necessitates using pairs or quartets for this activity, your facilitator will meet with you to explain how the activity will be modified. Every participant is required to play the role of professional.

LEARNING MODULE 3 ACTION PLAN

In the table below, use a pencil to assess where you are right now.

During the certification program, you will be directed to review and revise your self-assessment and action plan each evening. Your final task in the program will be to identify steps to prepare yourself to use the MBTI assessment in your work setting.

✓ Put a check mark in the box that identifies your current self-assessment.

- Got It: ✓ Have enough information to do this competently now
 Need More: ✓ Generally understand, but need more information and/or practice
 Don't Have It: ✓ Not at all confident of my current knowledge or ability to use it
 Summary: ✓ Satisfied, confident, ready to go with this item
 ✗ Want to include this in my action plan steps as I go forward

Things I need to know	Got It	Need More	Don't Have It	Summary for Action Plan
ADMINISTRATION				
Administration guidelines				
Mind-set				
Appropriate administration of the MBTI self-scorable assessment				
INTERPRETATION				
Interpreting results				
Interpreting scores/categories				
Interpretation process: steps				
Priorities for Learning Module 3	Ideas: Steps to take, materials to read, etc.			
1.				

CONTINUED

LEARNING MODULE 3 ACTION PLAN CONTINUED	
Priorities for Learning Module 3	Ideas: Steps to take, materials to read, etc.
2.	
3.	
4.	
5.	

LEARNING MODULE 4

DAY 3: Using the MBTI® Assessment for Individual and Leadership Development

LEARNING MODULE 4

TO PREPARE FOR DAY 3

Read in this *Participant's Resource Guide*:

- Learning Module 4

Read in *Introduction to Myers-Briggs® Type (ITT)* booklet:

- "Type Dynamics and Development," p. 46

Check your understanding by responding to the review questions in this module, pp. 60, 69–70, and 77–78.

TO DEEPEN YOUR UNDERSTANDING

To learn more about Learning Module 4 topics after the certification program, read the following.

- *MBTI® Manual*, chapter 5 (entire chapter), "Type Tables and Groupings of MBTI® Preferences," pp. 83–95
- *MBTI® Manual*, chapter 3 (entire chapter), "The Theory Behind the MBTI® Instrument," pp. 25–44
- *In the Grip*, by Naomi L. Quenk (available from The Myers-Briggs Company)
- *Introduction to Type® Dynamics and Development*, by Katharine D. Myers and Linda K. Kirby (available from The Myers-Briggs Company)

Agenda Day 3

Creating and exploring a team type table

Type dynamics: definitions, terms, "mechanics"

The eight dominant processes

Type and stress

- Type exaggeration
- "In the grip" of the inferior process

Type development

- Stages
- Culture's influence

Using type for leadership development

- With individual clients
- In leadership development programs

Learning Module 4 exam

Creating and Exploring Team Type Tables

In Learning Module 4 you will have an opportunity to learn how to create and explore an initial hypotheses about a team or group using team members' MBTI data.

The type table is designed to illustrate relationships among the types. Each preference appears in two of the rows or two of the columns of the type table. The type table is constructed as follows.



The E types are in the bottom two rows;
the I types are in the top two rows.

i	i	i	i
i	i	i	i
e	e	e	e
e	e	e	e



The S types are in the two left columns;
the N types are in the two right columns.

is	is	in	in
is	is	in	in
es	es	en	en
es	es	en	en



The T types are in the two outside columns;
the F types are in the two middle columns.

ist	isf	inf	int
ist	isf	inf	int
est	esf	enf	ent
est	esf	enf	ent



The J types are in the top and bottom rows;
the P types are in the two middle rows.

istj	isfj	infj	intj
istp	isfp	infp	intp
estp	esfp	enfp	entp
estj	esfj	enfj	entj

The type table is an effective tool for helping a team understand how type may be affecting its dynamics and effectiveness. After you have introduced type concepts, had individuals self-assess their type, returned results, and verified type, ask team members to sign in on a type table (if they are willing to do so) with their best-fit type or judgment of their probable type if they are not sure.

istj	isfj	infj	intj
istp	isfp	infp	intp
estp	esfp	enfp	entp
estj	esfj	enfj	entj

The Type Table

Dividing the Type Table

When people are first introduced to MBTI type, they can find it difficult to keep 16 types clearly in mind. It is helpful—both for the new practitioner and for clients—to divide the type table into four sections and focus on the common characteristics of the four types in each section.

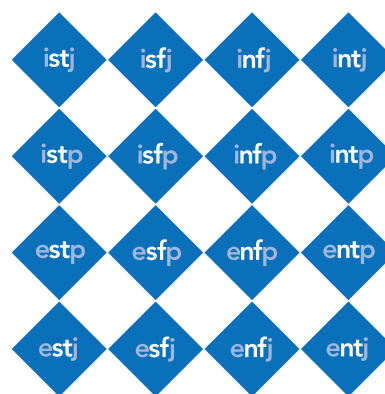
Two ways of dividing the type table are particularly useful for teams:

- The four columns of the type table: process pairs—ST, SF, NF, and NT (see ITT, pp. 44 and 48)
- The four rows of the type table: orientations—IJ, IP, EP, and EJ (see ITT, p. 45)

THE COLUMNS OF THE TYPE TABLE: PROCESS PAIRS

Each column of the type table consists of four types that share the same combination of mental processes, referred to as a *process pair*.

	Sensing and Thinking. People who prefer ST are fact oriented and logical. They contribute to a team by focusing on the realities and the bottom line.
	Sensing and Feeling. People who prefer SF are practical and personal. They contribute to a team by finding practical ways to support people and the group.
	Intuition and Feeling. People who prefer NF see the possibilities and potential in people. They contribute to a team by encouraging participation and providing insights for developing people.
	Intuition and Thinking. People who prefer NT see future possibilities and analyze them logically. They contribute to a team by bringing long-term strategies and creative problem solving.



	On a team, people who prefer			
	ST Sensing and Thinking	SF Sensing and Feeling	NF Intuition and Feeling	NT Intuition and Thinking
Focus attention on	Facts	Facts	Possibilities	Possibilities
Handle these with	Nonpersonal analysis	Personal warmth	Personal warmth	Nonpersonal analysis
Tend to be	Practical and matter-of-fact	Sympathetic and friendly	Enthusiastic and insightful	Logical and ingenious
And find scope for their abilities in	Technical areas with facts and objectives	Practical help and services for people	Understanding and communicating with people	Theoretical and technical developments

THE ROWS OF THE TYPE TABLE: ORIENTATION PAIRS

Each row of the type table consists of four types that share the same first and last letters—the orientations.



Introversion and Judging. People who prefer IJ develop their views carefully and hold them firmly. They complete the work for which they are responsible on time and expect the same of everyone else.



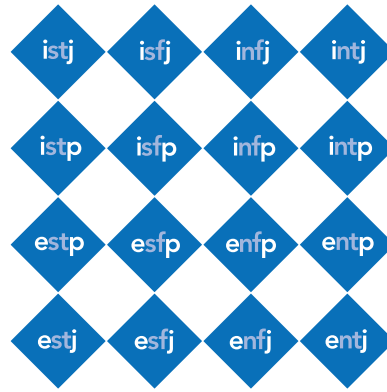
Introversion and Perceiving. People who prefer IP are flexible on the outside, while at the same time having very clear internal standards for making judgments. They fulfill their responsibilities to their own standards and within their own time frames.



Extraversion and Perceiving. People who prefer EP are natural networkers. They are open to new experiences and new ways of doing things and bring optimism, energy, and enthusiasm to their work.



Extraversion and Judging. People who prefer EJ see what needs to get done to move things forward. They create plans, structures, and time frames and keep others on track, moving toward the goal.



OTHER COMBINATIONS

Depending on your team's types and its objectives for using the MBTI assessment, you may find it useful to focus on other type combinations as well. The *Introduction to Myers-Briggs® Type* booklet identifies and defines some that you might want to explore. The *MBTI® Manual*, chapter 5, provides an extensive discussion of the type table and combinations. These selections are listed in the "To Deepen Your Understanding" section at the beginning of this module and are valuable resources for you following the workshop.

Exploring the Team Type Table

Use the following steps to lead team members in exploring the team's type distribution and how it affects team functioning. This exploration will provide a constructive foundation from which team members can negotiate with each other and agree on ways of working together that are more effective and harmonious.

1. Note one or more ways of looking at type distributions—whichever ones seem most important or helpful to this team:

By preference pairs: E–I, S–N, T–F, J–P
By columns: ST, SF, NF, NT (process pairs)
By rows: IJ, IP, EP, EJ (orientations)

2. Look at where the team is balanced (evenly split).

What do team members see as some of the effects of this balance? Do they use both sides, or does the balance sometimes result in a stalemate?

3. Look at where the team is imbalanced (majority-minority preferences).

What do team members see as some of the effects of this imbalance? How are type minority members included in team functioning? When and how does the team bring in the perspective of minority preferences?

4. Explore the effects of the leader's type.

How does the team leader's type contribute to the team's work? When might it get in the way of the team's work?

Note: Type distribution alone cannot "diagnose" team issues. The practitioner can use a team's type distribution to formulate some hypotheses and to generate questions for the team to discuss. We need to always remember, however:

- People are more than their type
- People of the same type may have developed different skills
- Other group dynamics also affect how team members work together

Using type distributions provides a perspective that explains differences and depersonalizes conflicts so that the team can discuss and negotiate possible solutions and ways to be more effective.

5. Look at where there may be gaps (absence of a type or types).

What is the impact on the team's performance if one or more types or process pairs are missing?

6. Based on what they have learned about themselves and each other, ask the team members to name two or three changes they can make to be more effective.

Lead the team in developing a specific action plan.

REVIEW: USING THE TYPE TABLE WITH TEAMS

POINTS TO REMEMBER

- Process pairs—the columns of the type table: ST, SF, NF, and NT
- Characteristics associated with each column
- Orientation pairs—the rows of the type table: IJ, IP, EP, and EJ
- Characteristics associated with each row

TEST YOUR LEARNING by responding to the following statements and questions. Check your answers using the key below.

- People who prefer Sensing and Thinking are most attracted to activities that involve:**
 - Facts collected and verified using the senses and logical analysis
 - Possibilities that reveal themselves in new experiences
 - Problem solving that allows them to use their ingenuity
 - Applying their practical solutions to interpersonal problems
- People who prefer Sensing and Feeling are most attracted to activities that involve:**
 - The impersonal and logical handling of others
 - Problem solving that allows them to use their imagination
 - Practical service to people important to them
 - Using their experience to improve processes
- People who prefer Intuition and Feeling are most attracted to activities that involve:**
 - Projects with equipment and tools
 - Possibilities for people
 - Facts about projects
 - Creating new and original systems
- People who prefer Intuition and Thinking are most attracted to activities that involve:**
 - Finding practical solutions to everyday problems
 - Impersonally analyzing systems, developing strategies
 - Practical service to people, creating harmony
 - Finding creative solutions to interpersonal issues
- According to type theory, which of the following sets of characteristics is associated with ENTP?**
 - Reflective, practical, logical, and open ended
 - Sociable, visionary, caring, and structured
 - Outgoing, concrete, analytical, and casual
 - Gregarious, see possibilities, analytical, and flexible
- According to type theory, which of the following activities would most appeal to ISFJ?**
 - Giving helpful support to co-workers
 - Leading large group meetings
 - Networking with other departments and organizations
 - Critiquing employee performance

Review answers: 1 a, 2 c, 3 b, 4 b, 5 d, 6 a

Understanding Type Dynamics

This module focuses on understanding and using personality type to assist clients in their development. The Jung-Myers type theory presents a dynamic picture of personality and provides a developmental perspective that is especially useful in leadership development, career development, and coaching.

Discussing type dynamics with clients can help them make sense of their experience of their personality type. For example:

- A person with ESTJ preferences said, “I’ve always wondered: I’m sure I prefer Extraversion, but I know when I’m learning something new, taking in brand-new information, I need to focus in, concentrate—it’s like I’m Introverted! Now I understand.”
- A person with INFP preferences said, “It’s always confused me. I’m pretty sure I prefer Introversion, but when I get a new idea, I can’t wait to talk about it with people, to bounce ideas off of them. I interrupt people, talk a lot—act like I prefer Extraversion! This explains it.”

Be aware that some clients may have been introduced to type earlier in an incorrect way, that is, as a static system rather than a dynamic one. In addition, to some clients, information about type dynamics may seem complicated and confusing: “I thought I understood type; I’ve known about it for years, and we use it at work. This just complicates everything.”

Be honest with these clients. Tell them that what they were told earlier was wrong or incomplete. Explain that type dynamics is the heart of Carl Jung’s system, the heart of what excited Briggs and Myers and led to their lifelong study of the theory and to their commitment to developing an assessment. The reason most people feel well understood by their type description is *because* it embodies the dynamics of their type. Otherwise, the description would be a dull and lifeless accounting of disconnected pieces.

A One-Dimensional View

The basic introduction to type presents MBTI results in terms of the four preference pairs and eight preferences. After they discover their four-letter type, most people using the MBTI assessment stay at that level. Using ENFP as an example:

ENFP = E + N + F + P

This leads to defining one’s type as though each preference were a separate aspect of personality:

- E Focuses attention on the external world
- N Likes to focus on the big picture; is interested in novel ideas
- F Makes decisions to support people and achieve group harmony
- P Approaches life in a casual, open-ended, and spontaneous way

These statements are true for most people who prefer ENFP, but looking at type in this way results in a limited, one-dimensional view of personality and a misrepresentation of the Jung-Myers theory and the type descriptions.

A Dynamic Picture of Personality

The dynamic explanation of the MBTI assessment:

- Identifies and describes each type's dominant process—the core of the personality
- Shows what each type extraverts
- Makes clear that every type has a part that is introverted—usually not seen by others—and a part that is extraverted
- Provides the necessary base for using the model of type development
- Leads to understanding type and stress interactions

Note: You will not be expected to explain the process used in identifying the dynamics of a type, and you won't need to explain these mechanics to your clients. Each type description in the *Introduction to Myers-Briggs® Type* booklet specifies the dynamics. You do need to be able to explain the key principles of type dynamics if an interested client asks individually or during a group presentation.

BASIC TERMS AND SUMMARY

First, let's review some basic terms related to the type preferences and a brief summary of the dynamic view of type.

According to Jung's theory and the MBTI assessment, Sensing (S), Intuition (N), Thinking (T), and Feeling (F) are the four preferences known as the basic mental processes (or functions, as Jung called them) used by people. Type theory asserts the following about the four processes:

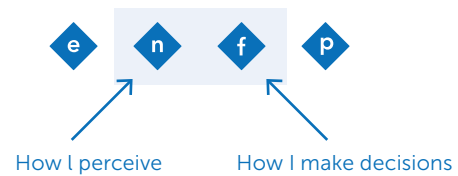
	Orientation of energy	
	Perceiving processes	
	Judging processes	
	Orientation to the outside world	

- We all use all four processes in both the external and internal worlds.
- There is an order to how we use and develop the processes.
- We use, develop, and rely on one process more than the others. This favorite process is called the *dominant* (first) process.
- Our second favorite, second in both development and use, is called the *auxiliary* (second) process.
- The auxiliary process provides balance to the personality in two ways:
 - If the dominant process is a perceiving process (S or N), the auxiliary process is one of the judging processes (T or F), and vice versa. This means each individual has a reliable way to access and use information and also a reliable way to arrive at decisions.
 - If the energy of the dominant process is directed toward the outer world (extraverted), the energy of the auxiliary process will be directed toward the inner world (introverted), and vice versa. This means that the individual has a reliable way to operate in both the outer and inner worlds.

APPLYING THE BASICS: THE DYNAMIC PICTURE OF ENFP

The two middle letters of a type represent the dominant and auxiliary processes for that type.

- One of them identifies the preferred **perceiving process**—N for ENFP.
- The other one identifies the preferred **judging process**—F for ENFP.



The Jung-Myers theory tells us that one of those processes will be directed into the outer world, while the other will be used primarily in the inner world.

HIERARCHY OF THE PROCESSES

Everyone uses all four of the mental processes. Each personality type has a hierarchy of processes—a specific order of development and use of the four processes.

- The two middle letters in a four-letter type—the preferred way of perceiving (using Sensing or Intuition) and the preferred way of judging (using Thinking or Feeling)—are the dominant (first, most preferred) and auxiliary (second) processes of that type.
- The other two mental processes—the two that don't appear in the four-letter type—are the third, or tertiary, and the fourth, or inferior, processes of that type.

HIERARCHY OF THE PROCESSES

The two processes shown in a four-letter type (the two middle letters)

1. **Dominant (first):** The core of the personality, the driving force
2. **Auxiliary (second) process:** Provides balance for the dominant process

The two processes that are *not* in the four-letter type

3. **Tertiary (third) process:** Largely unconscious but available with effort
4. **Inferior (fourth) function (process):** Largely unconscious, and typically undeveloped

BALANCE PROVIDED BY THE AUXILIARY PROCESS

One of the most important contributions Myers and Briggs made to the understanding and use of Jung's theory of personality was identifying the balancing role of the auxiliary process. The auxiliary process provides balance for the personality in two ways:

- **Balance between extraversion and introversion:** If the dominant process is extraverted (used in the external world), the auxiliary process provides balance as the mental process used in the internal world. If the dominant process is introverted (used in the internal world), the auxiliary process provides balance as the mental process used in the external world.
- **Balance between perceiving and judging:** If the dominant process is Sensing or Intuition (a perceiving process), the auxiliary process balances by providing a comfortable way of making decisions (a judging process). If the dominant process is Thinking or Feeling (a judging process), the auxiliary process balances by providing a reliable way of taking in information (a perceiving process).

Note that “balance” does not mean “equal.” According to type theory, the dominant process is the core of the type and receives more energy than the auxiliary process. But a personality with only the dominant process developed—and not also the auxiliary process—would be one-sided and out of balance.

ROLE OF THE J–P PAIR OF OPPOSITES IN TYPE DYNAMICS

Myers and Briggs developed the Judging–Perceiving (J–P) preference pair to provide a method for identifying which of an individual's preferred processes the individual extraverts.

J (Judging): The preferred judging process (T or F) is extraverted

P (Perceiving): The preferred perceiving process (S or N) is extraverted

In addition, the J–P pair identifies opposite personality characteristics:

- People who prefer Judging (J) prefer to make judgments and decisions when operating in the outside world. They like clear goals, plans, and an organized outer world.
- People who prefer Perceiving (P) prefer to perceive as much as possible when operating in the outside world. They like a spontaneous, flexible approach to the outside world, delaying making a decision until they feel they have sufficient information.

Note: J–P identifies the preference a type uses in the outer world—the extraverted process, regardless of whether the person *prefers* Extraversion or Introversion.

Summary: Identifying a Type's Dynamics

There are three steps in identifying a type's dynamics:

1. J–P “points to” the process that is extraverted.

J: the judging process in the type, T or F, is extraverted

P: the perceiving process in the type, S or N, is extraverted

2. For balance, the other process in the type is introverted.

3. The first letter, E or I, identifies which of those two processes in the type is the dominant, most preferred process.

E: the **extraverted** process is dominant for this type

I: the **introverted** process is dominant for this type

Applying the Three Steps to Identify a Type's Dynamics

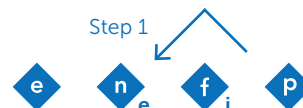
Note: You don't need to memorize these steps. You do need to understand the rationale for them, the logic behind them, and the procedure that will enable you to figure out the dynamics of any type. These will be covered later.

1. The last letter of a type, J or P, "points to" the process that this type extraverts—the process that is out in the world for others to see. If the last letter is J, this type extraverts its preferred judging process (T or F). If the last letter is P, this type extraverts its preferred perceiving process (S or N).
2. For balance, the other mental process in the type is introverted, or used in the inner world. Everyone needs one mental process to use in the external world and one mental process to use in his or her internal world.
3. People with a preference for Extraversion use their favorite, or dominant, process in the external world. People who prefer Introversion use their favorite, or dominant, process in their internal world.

To illustrate the three steps, we'll first look at the type dynamics of ENFP.

The type dynamics of ENFP

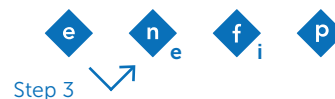
1. The last letter, P, "points to" the perceiving process, N, which is extraverted: N_e .



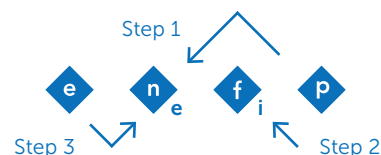
2. The other middle letter, F (which represents the other mental process, the judging process), is introverted: F_i .



3. People of this type prefer Extraversion, so they use their favorite, or dominant, process in the external world. Thus the extraverted process, N_e , is the dominant process.



The three steps for ENFP

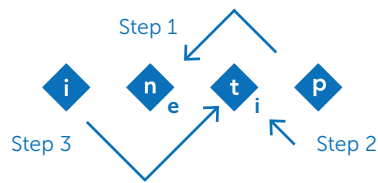


Translated into everyday language, when you meet someone who has preferences for ENFP, the following occurs:

- You see the person's dominant extraverted Intuition—scanning for new ideas, excited by possibilities, energized by brainstorming, enthusiastic.
- You do not usually see the person's auxiliary Feeling—core values guide decisions, but they're held inside, not typically articulated.
- And you are not likely to see the person's Thinking and Sensing, his or her tertiary and fourth processes.

Let's use the same process for an introverted type, INTP:

The type dynamics of INTP



1. The last letter, P, "points to" the perceiving mental process, N, which is extraverted: N_e .
2. The other middle letter, T, representing the other mental process (the judging process), is introverted: T_i .
3. People of this type prefer Introversion, so they use their favorite, or dominant, process in their internal world. Thus the introverted process, T_i , is the dominant process.

Translated into everyday language, when you meet someone who has preferences for INTP, the following occurs:

- You see the person's auxiliary extraverted Intuition—curious, exploring and questioning ideas, tolerant of different styles.
- You generally don't see the person's dominant Thinking; the logical structure by which the person analyzes and decides is kept inside.
- And you are not likely to see the person's tertiary (Sensing) and fourth (Feeling) processes.

The Eight Dominant Processes

A benefit of learning and applying type dynamics is developing an understanding of the eight dominant processes (functions) of the types as Jung originally proposed in his type theory.

 Perceiving types		 Judging types	
Extraverted Sensing	Introverted Sensing	Extraverted Thinking	Introverted Thinking
Extraverted Intuition	Introverted Intuition	Extraverted Feeling	Introverted Feeling

Each of the processes takes on different characteristics depending on whether the orientation is extraverted or introverted. To begin to recognize the differences, follow these steps:

1. Think of the basic definition of the process

N Focus on the big picture, patterns, connections

2. Then apply the orientation to that definition

N_e Scan the environment for new ideas, paint the biggest possible picture, “see” patterns and connections, brainstorm with others to develop ideas

N_i Brainstorm within themselves, make connections inside, see the big picture and pattern in their mind

The following table briefly summarizes the essence of each of the eight dominant processes.

Also, see table 3.1 in the *MBTI® Manual* for a description of dominant extraverted and introverted processes.

The Dominant Processes	
ISTJ and ISFJ	Dominant process = Sensing, used in the introverted orientation Respect and rely on internally stored, realistic, and complete data about actual events and people important to them; able to access that information as needed.
ESTP and ESFP	Dominant process = Sensing, used in the extraverted orientation Delight in action and experience, stimulated by interaction with the world and people; focus on the present moment and enjoy using their creativity to respond in the moment.
INFJ and INTJ	Dominant process = Intuition, used in the introverted orientation Develop and rely on clear, complex inner insights about the present and future and how they relate; maintain a clear sense of direction.
ENFP and ENTJ	Dominant process = Intuition, used in the extraverted orientation Scan the environment for new and stimulating ideas and enthusiastically pursue them with others; search for the most creative and interesting idea.

CONTINUED

The Dominant Processes *CONTINUED*

ISTP and INTP	Dominant process = Thinking, used in the introverted orientation Logically organize vast amounts of data, ideas, or concepts into systematic, explanatory structures; search for the "truth."
ESTJ and ENTJ	Dominant process = Thinking, used in the extraverted orientation Decisively, logically, and efficiently structure the external environment to achieve group and organizational goals.
ISFP and INFP	Dominant process = Feeling, used in the introverted orientation Assess everything by their strong inner value system about honoring and supporting human beings; search for what's morally "right."
ESFJ and ENFJ	Dominant process = Feeling, used in the extraverted orientation Decisively structure the external environment to meet the needs of people and to fit with their personal values.

Source: Adapted from Barger, Nancy J., and Kirby, Linda K., *Introduction to Type® and Change*. Sunnyvale, CA: The Myers-Briggs Company, 2004.

To expand your understanding of type dynamics, read the description of your type in the *Introduction to Myers-Briggs® Type* booklet.

Type	Page	Dominant process	Type	Page	Dominant process
ISTJ	pp. 10–11	Introverted Sensing	ISTP	pp. 18–19	Introverted Thinking
ISFJ	pp. 12–13	Introverted Sensing	INTP	pp. 24–25	Introverted Thinking
ESTP	pp. 26–27	Extraverted Sensing	ESTJ	pp. 34–35	Extraverted Thinking
ESFP	pp. 28–29	Extraverted Sensing	ENTJ	pp. 40–41	Extraverted Thinking
INFJ	pp. 14–15	Introverted Intuition	ISFP	pp. 20–21	Introverted Feeling
INTJ	pp. 16–17	Introverted Intuition	INFP	pp. 22–23	Introverted Feeling
ENFP	pp. 30–31	Extraverted Intuition	ESFJ	pp. 36–37	Extraverted Feeling
ENTP	pp. 32–33	Extraverted Intuition	ENFJ	pp. 38–39	Extraverted Feeling

Do you recognize your dominant process as you use it in your daily life?

Then read the description of your opposite type (opposite on all four preferences). Do you see people you know? Do you see things about others that can irritate you?

Applying type dynamics to yourself and to people you know enhances your appreciation of the complexity of human personality as seen through psychological type.

REVIEW: TYPE DYNAMICS

POINTS TO REMEMBER

- Mental processes
 - Perceiving (S and N)
 - Judging (T and F)
- Orientations (E–I and J–P)
- Role of the J–P preference pair in dynamics
- Definitions of dominant, auxiliary, tertiary, and inferior processes

TEST YOUR LEARNING by responding to the following statements. Check your answers using the key below.

1. In type theory, the dominant process is:

- a. The process that is least used
- b. The favorite process
- c. The process that is extraverted
- d. The process that is introverted

2. In type theory, the auxiliary process is:

- a. Opposite the dominant process
- b. The same as the dominant process, but in the opposite orientation
- c. The process that provides some balance to the dominant process
- d. The process that is least preferred

3. In type theory, the dominant and auxiliary processes:

- a. Are the middle two letters of a person's type
- b. Are largely unknown to the outside world
- c. Deal with only the outside world
- d. Deal with only the inside world

4. In type theory, if the dominant process is a perceiving process, then:

- a. The auxiliary will be introverted
- b. The auxiliary will be extraverted
- c. The auxiliary will be a judging process
- d. The auxiliary will also be a perceiving process

5. Our general orientation of mental energy is identified by:

- a. The J–P preference pair
- b. The E–I preference pair
- c. The S–N preference pair
- d. The T–F preference pair

6. The last letter in the four-letter type:

- a. Identifies which process is introverted
- b. Identifies the fourth, or inferior, process
- c. Identifies which process is extraverted
- d. Does not help in identifying dynamics

CONTINUED

REVIEW: TYPE DYNAMICS *CONTINUED*

7. In type theory, if the dominant process is a judging one, then:

- a. The auxiliary process will be extraverted
 - b. The auxiliary process will be a perceiving process
 - c. The auxiliary process will be introverted
 - d. The auxiliary process will also be a judging process
-

8. If people show the world their judging process, then:

- a. They show their preferred way of making decisions
 - b. They show their dominant process
 - c. They show their auxiliary process
 - d. They show their way of taking in information
-

9. The first letter in a four-letter type indicates:

- a. The orientation of the inferior process
 - b. The orientation of the tertiary process
 - c. The orientation of the auxiliary process
 - d. The orientation of the dominant process
-

Review answers: 1 b, 2 c, 3 a, 4 c, 5 b, 6 c, 7 b, 8 a, 9 d

Type and Stress

Once we understand the dynamic view of personality identified by a four-letter type, we can use some of the deeper, more developmental possibilities that are part of the psychological type approach to personality.

Type dynamics—and especially the third and fourth processes—becomes important as we look at the interactions of type and stress.

Type Exaggeration

Often, people's type-related response to everyday stress appears as "type exaggeration": unconsciously, additional energy is directed into their best, most reliable part—the dominant process. For example:

- On a good day, a dominant extraverted Thinking type (ESTJ or ENTJ) solicits the opinions of others and includes in decisions the people involved; in exaggerated mode, the same person may become dictatorial—barking orders, enforcing time frames, overpowering obstacles to complete goals.
- On a good day, dominant introverted Sensing types (ISTJ and ISFJ) sift through their stored information, select the relevant experiential data, and present it in a calm, balanced, and helpful manner; in exaggerated mode, the same individuals may withdraw energy and contribution (remember, people who prefer Introversion use their dominant process internally), insisting on operating strictly according to the rules.

The following table looks at the 16 types grouped by dominant process, suggesting how they typically behave when they are at their best and when their dominant process is exaggerated due to stress.

What Types Look Like at Their Best and in an Exaggerated State

ISTJ and ISFJ Dominant Introverted Sensing Types

At their best

Are selective—choose the right facts
Have excellent recall for specifics
Are certain of facts and opinions
Reflect before acting in a timely way
Communicate effectively and appropriately

In an exaggerated state

Fixate on the one "right" fact
Obsess about minute, unimportant data
Are dogmatic
Become unable to make decisions or take action
Shut down, withdraw

ESTP and ESFP Dominant Extraverted Sensing Types

At their best

Experience in the moment
Are active
Are talkative and sociable
Are straightforward and clear
Pay attention to detail

In an exaggerated state

Rapidly seek and engage in serial experience with little pause
Become hyperactive
Chatter and disturb others, disrupt
Overly focus on the short term
Get stuck—cannot collect enough evidence to make a decision

CONTINUED

What Types Look Like at Their Best and in an Exaggerated State *CONTINUED*

INFJ and INTJ Dominant Introverted Intuition Types

At their best

Are visionary
Are problem solvers
See connections
Develop patterns
Brainstorm "with themselves," inside

In an exaggerated state

Have unrealistic, even wild, visions
Are arrogant about their ideas and solutions
Overcomplicate things—everything is connected
Force data to fit their patterns
Are driven inward, won't or can't ask for help

ENFP and ENTP Dominant Extraverted Intuition Types

At their best

Form global pictures and understandings
Are innovative
Are enthusiastic, fast paced
See possibilities
Are flexible

In an exaggerated state

Are obsessed with/convinced of links between things
Want change for the sake of change—novelty
Are over the top—frantic, out of control
Are swamped with options, can't decide
Flit from one activity to another

ISTP and INTP Dominant Introverted Thinking Types

At their best

Persistently search for true, correct analysis
Experience depth of concentration
Are logical
Are objective
Are self-motivated

In an exaggerated state

Obsessively search for the truth about everything
Get lost in concentration—forget to attend to the basics of life
Accept only (their own) logic
Become totally detached
Are driven, like a machine out of control

ESTJ and ENTJ Dominant Extraverted Thinking Types

At their best

Are coolheaded, calm
Are rational
Present goals with clarity
Are logical
Are analytical

In an exaggerated state

Become detached and cold
Feel everything must be rational
Oversimplify for the sake of clarity
Interrupt and critique others' lack of logic
Dominate by dissection

ISFP and INFP Dominant Introverted Feeling Types

At their best

Are empathetic
Think people matter, including themselves
Are independent
Are sensitive
Are idealistic

In an exaggerated state

Are rescuers
Carry the weight of the world on their shoulders
Isolate themselves
Become hypersensitive
Become pompous and demagogic

ESFJ and ENFJ Dominant Extraverted Feeling Types

At their best

Are encouraging
Are interested in others
Seek harmony
Are outward looking
Are people and relationship oriented

In an exaggerated state

Are insistent: "Here's what will be best for you"
Become intrusive, prying
Ignore/deny problems for the sake of superficial harmony
Lack focus, become scattered
Overidentify with others, become overburdened

Source: Adapted from Barger, Nancy J., and Kirby, Linda K., *Introduction to Type® and Change*. Sunnyvale, CA: The Myers-Briggs Company, 2004.

Though type exaggeration is often unpleasant for others and tiring for the person experiencing it, it doesn't change the underlying personality type (i.e., the person is still recognizably his or her type).

Dealing with Stress

What can you do to deal with stress? Most important, you can recognize and acknowledge the type-related ways you may express it—your type exaggeration. Then, when you recognize that you are slipping into an exaggerated state, you can use your best coping mechanisms: breathe deeply, take a walk, play a computer game, talk to a colleague, take a time-out—whatever works for you. It's also important to learn from these experiences.

- Can you identify what has been causing you the greatest stress?
- Are there things you can change about that?
- Can colleagues or friends help?

We can't eliminate all stress in our work life, but recognizing our reactions to it and observing their effects may guide us toward modifying our work to reduce the stress.

This information can also enable us to help our colleagues. Instead of reacting with our first, usually negative, response to colleagues' type exaggeration, we can recognize what is going on for them. At that point, it can be helpful to ask, "What can I do that would be most helpful to you right now?" Then respond positively to the request, if you can, even though the request may be quite different from what you find helpful when you're under pressure. It's a time to be kind to yourself and others.

Source: Adapted from Barger, Nancy J., and Kirby, Linda K., *Introduction to Type® and Change*. Sunnyvale, CA: The Myers-Briggs Company, 2004.

Eruptions of the Inferior Process: Being "In the Grip"

Both theory and experience have demonstrated that lowering of the energy typically available to the dominant process (e.g., extraverted Thinking) tends to set the stage for emergence of the inferior process (e.g., introverted Feeling for an extraverted Thinking type).

According to type theory, the fourth, or inferior, process is the least developed, most unconscious mental process because as energy is directed into the dominant process, its opposite, the inferior process, receives very little energy. People frequently develop some skill in purposefully using their least developed process, typically in the service of their preferred processes (the dominant and auxiliary processes). For example:

- **Dominant introverted Intuitive types** (INFJ and INTJ) may learn the skill of balancing a checkbook using their inferior Sensing—so that they can devote most of their time to their intellectual passions.
- **Dominant extraverted Thinking types** (ESTJ and ENTJ) may learn the importance of including the impacts on people in their decision making because they have learned that doing so makes their organization run smoothly.

While we all can draw on our tertiary and inferior processes and develop skills related to them, having to do so throughout the day or most of the time can be very fatiguing and stressful.

People can and do use their fourth, inferior, process when it is necessary and appropriate for particular situations, though usually not with the comfort and facility with which they use their dominant and auxiliary processes.

However, the inferior process can also appear spontaneously and unbidden when a person is experiencing stress (such as having a major deadline looming or taking a certification exam), fatigue, or illness or is under the influence of alcohol or other mind-altering drugs. A person in this state is often described as being “in the grip” of the inferior process.

In such situations, the inferior process may erupt from the unconscious and, for a time, completely take over the conscious mind. People say, “I don’t know what came over me” or “I was beside myself.”

While this is an unpleasant experience for everyone, it is typically an attempt by people’s psyche to get them back in balance or to insist that they direct their attention to something they have been vigorously ignoring—something related to their inferior process or function.

Your type description in the *Introduction to Myers-Briggs® Type* booklet ends with a brief summary describing what a stress-induced eruption of the inferior process may look like for people of your type.

The process of moving into the grip often involves first exaggerating one’s dominant process, with no balance available from the other processes. People in an exaggerated state often look like a caricature of their type.

The specific content of thought/feeling when in the grip will vary among individuals, but there are certain predictable forms the inferior process will take in different types. The following are some general descriptions that most people recognize as part of their own “grip experience.”

The Grip Experience	
ISTJ and ISFJ	Dominant introverted Sensing/inferior extraverted Intuition Verbalize negative fantasies, catastrophize and imagine dire possibilities, doom and gloom. Verbally adrift, distracted, disorganized, unfocused, confused. May lose objects and make impulsive decisions.
ESTP and ESFP	Dominant extraverted Sensing/inferior introverted Intuition Uncharacteristic focus on inner complexities and the ultimate meaning of life. Attribute great significance to random, unrelated events, focus on dire inner possibilities, and feel overwhelmed with internal clouds of doom. Feel hopeless.
INFJ and INTJ	Dominant introverted Intuition/inferior extraverted Sensing Put the external world in order, make endless lists, try to control something, take action without planning, want someone to take care of them but can't ask, overdo Sensing activities such as eating, drinking, exercising, watching TV.
ENFP and ENTP	Dominant extraverted Intuition/inferior introverted Sensing Focus on one fact or detail and lose the big picture. May become convinced that they have a dire illness. Obsess about whatever is happening at the moment and are unable to move on from that. May become depressed and see no way out of it.
ISTP and INTP	Dominant introverted Thinking/inferior extraverted Feeling Become concerned about relationship issues. May misread cues and conclude that people dislike them. Make black-and-white emotional statements, feel unloved and unlovable; lose typical control and have emotional outbursts.
ESTJ and ENTJ	Dominant extraverted Thinking/inferior introverted Feeling Hypersensitive to signs that they are unappreciated, feel alone and unloved, a victim. Experience despair and depression internally but maintain outer competence, so people are unaware of their distress.
ISFP and INFP	Dominant introverted Feeling/inferior extraverted Thinking Are critical of others and see incompetence all around them; may then turn this on themselves, becoming convinced of their own incompetence. May take ill-advised, precipitous action to correct their imagined mistakes.
ESFJ and ENFJ	Dominant extraverted Feeling/inferior introverted Thinking Make exaggerated, black-and-white judgments of everything and everyone, including themselves. Use faulty logic to support their negative judgments and then become confused and despairing. Search for “truth,” often turning to experts and self-help books.

Source: Adapted from Quenk, Naomi L., and Barger, Nancy J., *Inferior Function*.

Type Development

Type development concerns how a person's natural preferences evolve over the life span. It starts at an early age and can be helped or hindered by the environment. In other words, type development is a product of both nature and nurture.

The goal of type development is captured in the following statement from Isabel Myers:

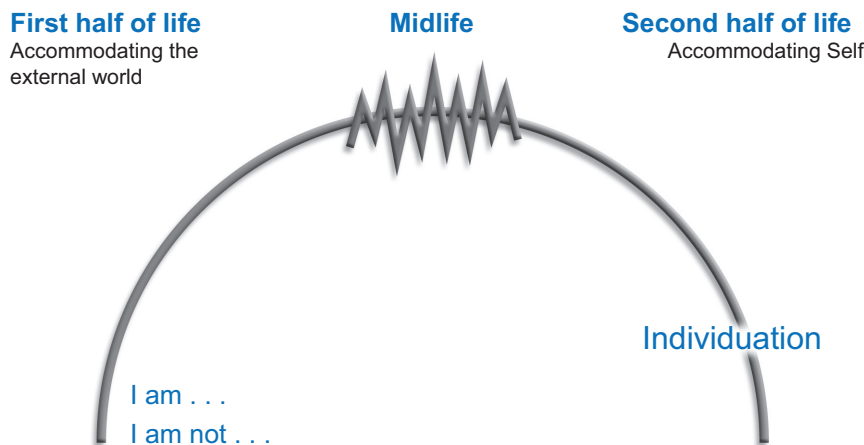
The essence of type development is the development of perception and judgment and of appropriate ways to use them. . . . By definition, people with adequate perception see the relevant aspects of any situation; if they have adequate judgment, they make good decisions and carry them out. (Myers, Isabel B., with Myers, Peter B., *Gifts Differing: Understanding Personality Type*, p. 167. Boston, MA: Nicholas Brealey, 1980/1995)

In other words, the goal of type development includes

- Developing a clear dominant process and using it well
- Developing an auxiliary process that supports and balances the dominant process and is used in the opposite attitude

Stages of Type Development

The Jung-Myers model of development identifies three general stages:



- In the **first half of life**, it is important to put effort and energy into the dominant and auxiliary processes—to recognize them and to develop confidence and facility in using them. This includes learning to be effective in the world while also developing one's personality type. In this process, family and culture influence how a person develops his or her natural type preferences.
- The Jung-Myers model also considers what we refer to as **midlife**—a major transition in energy and interests. The model sees this transition as an internal shift, a natural reorientation of energy at the point in life when people become aware of their limitations in terms of both time and possibilities. This recognition leads to questioning the decisions one has made, the adjustments one has made. Midlife is a challenging—and often uncomfortable—time. Going through this period is necessary, however, to bring energy to development in the second half of life.

- In the **second half of life**, according to Jung and Myers, it is possible to develop additional comfort with using the nonpreferred mental processes, the tertiary and inferior processes. This development may take the form of new hobbies and interests, and sometimes a change of career. Jung used the term *individuation* to describe the purpose of lifelong development: the quest for wholeness, the increasing ability/freedom to choose, the journey toward becoming one's best self.

Jung, Briggs, and Myers believed that as people age **their natural type does not change**. Instead, people's development of their tertiary and inferior areas ideally leads to more choices, less rigidity, and more energy, and therefore differences in how they express their type.

REVIEW: TYPE AND STRESS; TYPE DEVELOPMENT

POINTS TO REMEMBER, TYPE AND STRESS

- Type exaggeration
- "In the grip" of the inferior process

POINTS TO REMEMBER, TYPE DEVELOPMENT

- Natural preferences
- Stages of type development
- Goals of type development in the first half of life
- Goals of type development in the second half of life
- Overall goals of type development

TEST YOUR LEARNING by responding to the following statements and questions. Check your answers using the key below.

1. Everyday stress may cause the dominant process to become:

- a. Less reliable
- b. Exaggerated
- c. More like the auxiliary process
- d. Unable to operate

2. Being "in the grip" of the inferior process means people are:

- a. Relaxed
- b. Excited
- c. Very stressed
- d. In control

3. Good type development is necessary:

- a. To help people focus on relevant information and decide appropriately and effectively
- b. For healthy development after midlife, but not before
- c. For healthy growth of children and young adults, but not for older adults
- d. To protect people from environmental influences

CONTINUED

REVIEW: TYPE AND STRESS; TYPE DEVELOPMENT CONTINUED

4. Which of the following is part of type development?

- a. Developing all the processes in both extraverted and introverted attitudes equally
 - b. Developing the dominant and auxiliary processes and using the less preferred processes when appropriate
 - c. Staying focused on the dominant and auxiliary processes throughout life
 - d. Learning how to avoid being "in the grip" of the inferior process
-

5. During the first half of life, people may work at developing their:

- a. Inferior process
 - b. Tertiary and inferior processes
 - c. Dominant and auxiliary processes
 - d. None of the above
-

6. Which of the following is true of environmental influences on type development?

- a. Environment influences how people learn to use their type preferences
 - b. Environment does not influence type development
 - c. Jung's model of development does not include environmental influences
 - d. Types are expressed the same way (look the same) around the world
-

Review answers: 1 b, 2 c, 3 a, 4 b, 5 c, 6 a

Using the MBTI® Assessment for Leadership Development

Knowledge of the deeper levels of type is especially helpful when using the MBTI assessment with leaders:

- In individual coaching sessions
- In leadership development training programs

Exploring leaders' type dynamics and development with them is often relevant to the goals they bring to coaching and to leadership development training:

- Understanding their type description more fully, including the "Possible Areas for Growth"
- Applying the model of three stages of development (first half of life, midlife, second half of life) to their own individual development
- Identifying their developmental challenges and setting goals

In individual coaching situations, MBTI practitioners can ask questions about the feedback leaders have received and help them identify how that feedback fits with their type.

- What attributes in your type description may have led to the perception expressed by those you supervise? By those you report to? By your peers?
 - The process you introvert?
 - The process you extravert?
- Does the feedback you have received indicate areas in which you could develop your type?
 - Ways to use your less-preferred third and fourth processes?
 - Ways to moderate or adapt the use of your preferred first or second processes when situations call for it?
- Would you like to work on any of these areas?

Example: A leader who prefers introverted Thinking (ISTP or INTP) might get feedback that others don't understand the basis of that leader's decisions and find them arbitrary.

- Review the introverted Thinking process to illustrate that others don't "see" the leader's decision-making process because it is used internally.
- Developmental opportunity: "Would you like to work on ways to articulate your decision-making process?"
- Let people know that you welcome their asking how you arrived at a decision if it isn't clear to them.

Combining the MBTI assessment with a 360° feedback instrument can be especially helpful in such coaching situations.

In leadership development training programs, using the MBTI assessment to focus on decision-making style is particularly useful to leaders. The last two letters of leaders' type speak to this style. We will demonstrate in the certification program ways to use this approach to leadership development training.

The table below identifies how common each of the decision-making styles (TJ, TP, FJ, FP) is among leaders. The table shows the type distributions in the global sample of 16,773 adults (notated as "GS" in the table) who took the global research version of the MBTI assessment, and in a sample of 192,499 executives and top executives (notated as "EX" in the table) who took prior forms of the MBTI assessment and whose data were captured and combined from CPP and OPP commercial databases.

ISTJ GS 15.9% EX 13.0%	ISFJ GS 8.4% EX 2.1%	INFJ GS 2.3% EX 1.4%	INTJ GS 2.6% EX 6.1%
ISTP GS 9.8% EX 3.4%	ISFP GS 6.6% EX 0.8%	INFP GS 6.3% EX 1.9%	INTP GS 4.8% EX 5.1%
ESTP GS 6.1% EX 5.8%	ESFP GS 6.0% EX 1.8%	ENFP GS 8.2% EX 5.6%	ENTP GS 4.3% EX 10.7%
ESTJ GS 9.0% EX 20.8%	ESFJ GS 5.7% EX 4.1%	ENFJ GS 2.2% EX 4.0%	ENTJ GS 1.8% EX 13.4%

GS = MBTI global research sample, N = 16,773 respondents to the global research version of the MBTI assessment.
EX = executives and top executives, N = 192,499 executives and top executives from CPP, Inc., and OPP Ltd commercial databases.

Leading and Following Styles of TJ, TP, FP, and FJ

Combinations of the **judging process** (T or F) and the preferred **orientation to the outside world** (J or P) influence preferred leadership, management, and followership styles.

TJ Logical decision makers	Analytical, decisive leaders. Make decisions based on principles and systems, overall impacts, and rational assessment of outcomes, and can be tough-minded in implementing those decisions. Effective implementers of policies, if they respect the leader.
TP Adaptable problem solvers	Lead by example. Value and display technical expertise, and create consistent and orderly frameworks for working. Objective, skeptical, and curious. Will change course as new information comes in. Effective problem solvers, if interested.
FP Supportive coaches	Warm, flexible, and encouraging leaders. Support individual work styles and like to involve others in decisions. Prefer collegial relationships, shared rewards, and consensus in decisions. Energetic followers if treated with respect.
FJ Values-based decision makers	Warm, decisive leaders. Make decisions based on their personal values and empathy with others. Strive for harmony, consensus, and a supportive environment, are expressive and often inspiring. Loyal followers if the leader honors their values.

Source: Myers, Isabel B., *Introduction to Myers-Briggs® Type* (7th ed.). Sunnyvale, CA: The Myers-Briggs Company, 2015.

Type distributions of leaders show consistent patterns across cultures, as shown in the following table. This table and the information about the composition of the samples it contains illustrate the substantial amount of research that has been conducted on the MBTI assessment across the world. We will discuss this further in the certification program.

Samples of TJ Leaders by Region			
ISTJ	%	INTJ	%
Africa	19.6	Africa	6.9
Asia	19.7	Asia	6.0
Australia/New Zealand	11.7	Australia/New Zealand	6.2
Europe	12.4	Europe	5.9
India	22.3	India	6.3
Latin America	22.4	Latin America	3.8
Middle East	17.0	Middle East	4.6
North America	13.9	North America	6.4
ESTJ	%	ENTJ	%
Africa	21.9	Africa	11.1
Asia	28.8	Asia	10.7
Australia/New Zealand	17.1	Australia/New Zealand	13.5
Europe	22.5	Europe	13.3
India	31.1	India	8.8
Latin America	37.1	Latin America	8.2
Middle East	31.1	Middle East	11.3
North America	17.8	North America	11.3

Note: Samples of convenience from CPP database. Includes only those participants who reported being an executive or top executive and indicated country of residence. Total sample is 99,371 executives and top executives. Africa, *N* = 3,191; Asia, *N* = 3,905; Australia/New Zealand, *N* = 1,206; Europe, *N* = 5,365; India, *N* = 1,054; Latin America, *N* = 3,642; Middle East, *N* = 1,430; North America, *N* = 79,578.

The data table below details the demographics of the leaders samples presented in the type table above.

Demographics of the TJ Leaders Samples				
Region	Countries included	Gender	Avg age	Avg yrs in occupation
Africa N = 3,191	Algeria, Angola, Benin, Botswana, Burundi, Cameroon, Congo, Djibouti, Equatorial Guinea, Ethiopia, Gabon, Gambia, Ghana, Guinea, Ivory Coast, Kenya, Lesotho, Liberia, Libya, Madagascar, Malawi, Mali, Mauritania, Mauritius, Morocco, Mozambique, Namibia, Niger, Nigeria, Reunion, Rwanda, Senegal, Seychelles, Sierra Leone, Somalia, South Africa, Swaziland, Tanzania, Togo, Tunisia, Uganda, Zaire, Zimbabwe, Zambia	25.8% women 74.2% men	44	16
Asia N = 3,905	Afghanistan, American Samoa, Armenia, Azerbaijan, Bangladesh, Cambodia, Cook Islands, Fiji, French Polynesia, Guam, Hong Kong, India, Indonesia, Japan, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, Laos, Macao, Malaysia, Maldives, Micronesia, Mongolia, Myanmar, Nepal, New Caledonia, Northern Mariana Islands, Pakistan, Palau, Peoples Republic of China, Philippines, Singapore, South Korea, Taiwan, Tajikistan, Thailand, Turkey, Turkmenistan, Union Island, Uzbekistan, Vietnam	30.6% women 69.4% men	42	15
Australia & New Zealand N = 1,206	Australia, New Zealand	23.1% women 76.9% men	45	18
Europe N = 5,365	Albania, Andorra, Austria, Belgium, Bulgaria, Channel Islands, Croatia, Cyprus, Czech Republic, Denmark, Estonia, Finland, France, Georgia, Germany, Gibraltar, Greece, Hungary, Iceland, Ireland, Italy, Latvia, Lithuania, Luxembourg, Macedonia, Malta, Moldova, Monaco, Netherlands, Norway, Poland, Portugal, Romania, Russia, Serbia, Slovakia, Slovenia, Spain, Sweden, Switzerland, Ukraine, United Kingdom, Yugoslavia	22.1% women 77.9% men	44	17
India N = 1,054	India, Sri Lanka	12.6% women 87.4% men	41	16
Latin America N = 3,642	Anguilla, Antigua, Argentina, Aruba, Bahamas, Barbados, Belize, Bermuda, Bolivia, Brazil, British Virgin Islands, Cayman Islands, Chile, Colombia, Costa Rica, Curacao, Dominica, Dominican Republic, Ecuador, El Salvador, French Guiana, Grenada, Guatemala, Guyana, Haiti, Honduras, Jamaica, Martinique, Mexico, Montserrat, Netherlands Antilles, Nicaragua, Panama, Paraguay, Puerto Rico, Peru, St. Barthelemy, St. Christopher, St. Croix, St. Kitts, St. Lucia, St. Thomas, St. Vincent and the Grenadines, Suriname, Tortola, Trinidad and Tobago, U.S. Virgin Islands, Uruguay, Venezuela	25.4% women 74.6% men	43	17
Middle East N = 1,430	Bahrain, Egypt, Israel, Iraq, Iran, Jordan, Kuwait, Lebanon, Oman, Qatar, Saudi Arabia, Syria, United Arab Emirates	18.9% women 81.1% men	42	16
North America N = 79,578	Canada, United States of America	33.6% women 66.4% men	47	20

LEARNING MODULE 4 ACTION PLAN

In the table below, use a pencil to assess where you are right now.

During the certification program, you will be directed to review and revise your self-assessment and action plan each evening. Your final task in the program will be to identify steps to prepare yourself to use the MBTI assessment in your work setting.

✓ Put a check mark in the box that identifies your current self-assessment.

- Got It:** ✓ Have enough information to do this competently now
Need More: ✓ Generally understand, but need more information and/or practice
Don't Have It: ✓ Not at all confident of my current knowledge or ability to use it
Summary: ✓ Satisfied, confident, ready to go with this item
 ✗ Want to include this in my action plan steps as I go forward

Things I need to know	Got It	Need More	Don't Have It	Summary for Action Plan
TYPE DYNAMICS				
Definition				
The mental functions or processes				
The orientations				
Definitions in hierarchy of processes				
Balance from auxiliary process				
How dynamics applies to my type				
TYPE AND STRESS				
Type's influence on what stresses different types				
Type exaggeration				
"In the grip" of the inferior process				
TYPE DEVELOPMENT				
Goal of type development				
Jung-Myers stages of life				
USING TYPE DYNAMICS TO DEVELOP CLIENTS				
Explaining the type development model				
Explaining type and stress interactions				

LEARNING MODULE 4 ACTION PLAN CONTINUED	
Priorities for Learning Module 4	Ideas: Steps to take, materials to read, etc.
1.	
2.	
3.	
4.	
5.	

DAY 4: Understanding and Using the MBTI® Step II™ Assessment and Interpretive Report

LEARNING MODULE 5

TO PREPARE FOR DAY 4

Read in this *Participant's Resource Guide*:

- Learning Module 5

TO DEEPEN YOUR UNDERSTANDING

To ensure that you have adequate understanding, read the following resources. These resources offer in-depth information about the MBTI Step II assessment and guidance for using it with clients.

- *MBTI® Step II® User's Guide*
- *MBTI® Manual for the Global Step I® and Step II® Assessments*
- *Understanding Your MBTI® Step II® Results*
 - This resource is designed for practitioners to provide to clients as they work with them to interpret their Step II results.
- *MBTI® Step II® Feedback Cards*

Agenda Day 4

Development and uses of the MBTI® Step II™ assessment

What is the MBTI® Step II™ Interpretive Report?

Facet definitions and activities: MBTI® Step II™ Interpretive Report, pp. 5–8

Remainder of report, pp. 9–17

Interpretation practice

Using the MBTI Step II assessment with a team or Step II leadership development case studies
(as determined by the program facilitator)

Module 5 exam

Close of MBTI® Certification Program

Development of the MBTI® Step II™ Assessment

The original focus of Isabel Myers and Katharine Briggs' work was creating an assessment that would give individuals access to Carl Jung's theory of psychological types, which explains important aspects of personality and daily functioning. The assessment identifies four pairs of opposite preferences. Individuals taking the assessment choose one preference from each pair, which then combine to form a dynamic personality pattern as defined by the Jung-Myers theory of personality type. This assessment is available as the MBTI Step I assessment.

Myers' Early Identification of Facets

From the beginning of her work developing test items, Myers noticed patterns in individual responses that clustered together—a set of several items that individuals answered in a similar way. She began to keep track of these clusters, naming them and testing her hypothesis that they formed distinct subsets of items.

For example, she called one of these clusters "sociability." The cluster included several items that related to Extraversion and Introversion but were responded to similarly by individual clients regardless of their E–I preference. That is, an individual might respond to all or most of these items in the direction of "sociability" regardless of whether the individual reported a preference for E or I in the whole set of E–I items.

Myers knew that not all people who prefer Extraversion are alike, that people use and express their preferences in different ways. Her hope was to individualize type reports, and she saw the clusters she had identified as a potential tool for doing so.

Form J and Form K

In the 1980s, Peter Myers and Katharine Myers (owners of the MBTI assessment following Isabel Myers' death in 1980) pursued Myers' interest in individualizing type descriptions by creating a team of experts headed by David Saunders, a psychometrician who had worked with Myers when she was developing the MBTI assessment. Saunders conducted a factor analysis of the 290-item MBTI Form J assessment, a research form consisting of all the items Isabel Myers had ever written. Saunders' analysis identified 20 facets that seemed to be specific aspects of the Step I type preference pairs.

In 1989, CPP, Inc. (now The Myers-Briggs Company), published the MBTI Form K assessment, which produced an individual's results on the 20 facets Saunders' work had identified. This assessment later became known as the Step II assessment. For more detailed information about the development of the Step II assessment, see relevant chapters in the MBTI manual.

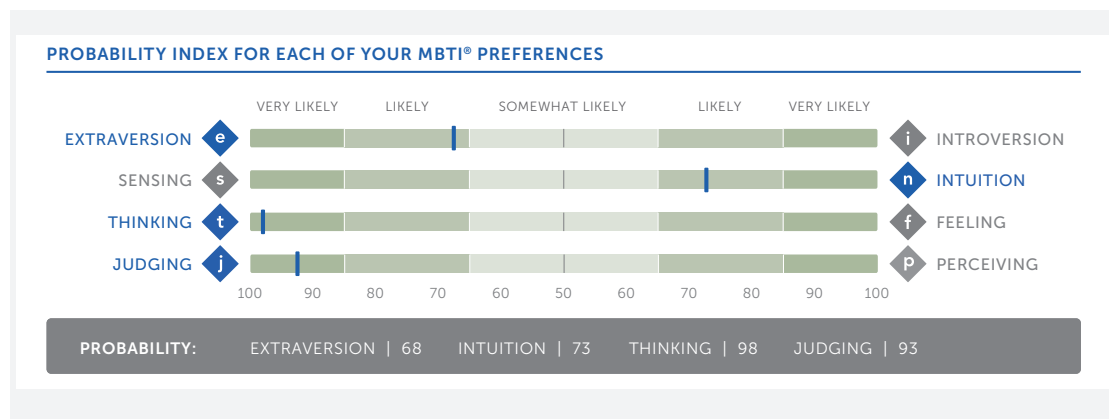
Form Q and the Global Step II™ Assessment

In the late 1990s, CPP, Inc., collected data from a national sample of about 1,400 adults and used these data and the item response theory scoring process to create a new form of the Step II assessment, Form Q. In the mid-2010s, a global research initiative triggered another revision of the Step II assessment, resulting in the 143-item MBTI® Global Step II™ assessment. The Global Step II assessment is the form used to generate the current MBTI® Step II™ Interpretive Report.

The MBTI® Step II™ Interpretive Report

The MBTI® Step II™ Interpretive Report is produced using an individual's responses to the 143 items on the Global Step II assessment. The scoring identifies preferences on 20 Step II facets—5 for each of the Step I preference pairs. Computer scoring of the Global Step II assessment also produces an individual's four-letter Step I type based on the 92 Step I items, which are included in the 143-item set of the Global Step II assessment.

The figure below is an example of the Step I results graphic that appears on p. 3 of the MBTI® Step II™ Interpretive Report.



The 20 Step II™ Facets

e EXTRAVERSION

Initiating
Expressive
Gregarious
Active
Enthusiastic

i INTROVERSION

Receiving
Contained
Intimate
Reflective
Quiet

s SENSING

Concrete
Realistic
Practical
Experiential
Traditional

n INTUITION

Abstract
Imaginative
Conceptual
Theoretical
Original

t THINKING

Logical
Reasonable
Questioning
Critical
Tough

f FEELING

Empathetic
Compassionate
Accommodating
Accepting
Tender

j JUDGING

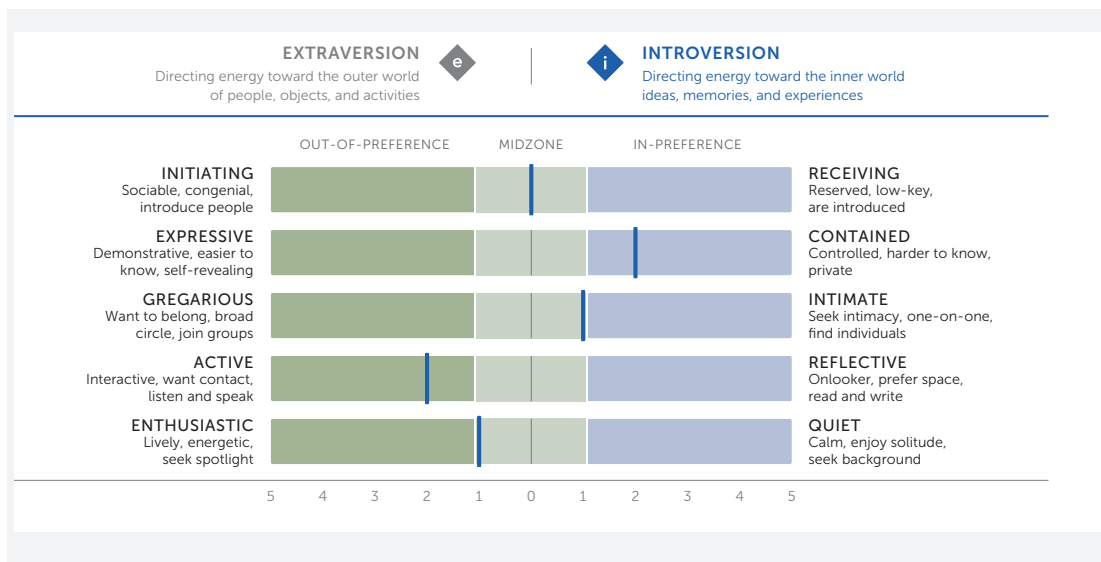
Systematic
Planful
Early Starting
Scheduled
Methodical

p PERCEIVING

Casual
Open-Ended
Pressure-Prompted
Spontaneous
Emergent

Clients receive a score on each of the 20 facets. Page 4 of the MBTI® Step II™ Interpretive Report identifies the Step II facets and explains the three categories in which the facet results are interpreted: in-preference, midzone, and out-of-preference. Professionals can use this page to introduce clients to what they will see in the report.

- **In-preference:** This means the client's facet result corresponds to their reported underlying Step I preference.
- **Out-of-preference:** This means the client responded to the items on that facet in the direction opposite their overall preference on that preference pair.
- **Midzone:** This means the client responded to about the same number of items favoring each of the opposite poles of that facet, resulting in a score of 0 or 1 on the facet.



Verified Type Option

Because Step I type influences how facet results are described (in-preference, midzone, or out-of-preference), the Step II scoring program includes a “verified type option.” This option can be used by the MBTI practitioner to rerun the MBTI® Step II™ Interpretive Report when the client disagrees with their reported Step I results. Alternatively, if a client verified on a previous MBTI administration a type that is different from their reported type, the practitioner can request a verified type report before the client responds to the Step II items. See the *MBTI® Step II™ User’s Guide*, pp. 53 and 73, for more information about the verified type option.



Your Step I™ Results

Your reported type came out to be ESTJ.

The type you verified as your best-fit type

ESTJ

Extraversion | Sensing | Thinking | Judging

This report is based on your verified type.

ESTJs are typically logical, analytical, and objectively critical. They like to organize projects and then act to get things done in a systematic, timely, and efficient manner. ESTJs focus on seeing things as they are, not as they might be. They are matter-of-fact, practical, realistic, and concerned with the here and now. Past experience helps them solve problems, and they want to be sure that their plans and decisions are based on solid fact.

They like having definite guidelines to govern the way they do things. If they are to change their way of doing something, they need to change their reasons for doing it. Logical and consistent, ESTJs make quick decisions. Their focus is on the immediate, visible, and tangible. They like to solve problems and organize things and then move on. They have little patience for confusion or inefficiency. With their focus on getting the task done, they may proceed without consulting others.

ESTJs are likely to be most satisfied in a work environment that values setting goals, making decisions, being organized, and getting things done. People can count on them to follow through in an organized, efficient, and practical manner.

Guidance from Resources

The *MBTI® Manual* and the *MBTI® Step II™ User's Guide* provide descriptions of each pole and of the midzone on each facet. Listed below is a breakdown of where to find specific information in these two resources.

MBTI® Manual

- Summary of facet content:
chapter 4, table 4.2, p. 69
- Brief descriptions of the opposite poles on each facet:
chapter 2, tables 2.1–2.4, pp. 18–21
- In-depth narrative descriptions of the opposite poles on each facet:
chapter 4, pp. 70–81
- Facet scoring categories:
chapter 6, pp. 109–110
- Sources of midzone scores:
chapter 6, p. 111
- General midzone descriptions of the 20 Global Step II facets:
chapter 6, table 6.3, pp. 112–113
- Percentage of out-of-preference facet scores for each of the 16 types:
chapter 6, tables 6.11–6.26, pp. 124–127
- Discussion of interpretation of midzone scores in the context of Step I information:
chapter 6, pp. 122–128

MBTI® Step II™ User's Guide

- Facet pole and midzone definitions:
chapter 1
- Midzone results interpretation:
chapter 4
- Out-of-preference results interpretation:
chapter 3

During the certification program, we will briefly define each of the facets and then conduct activities related to some of the facets using participants' Step II Interpretive Reports.

Note: The *MBTI® Step II™ Interpretive Report* includes a description of each of an individual's facet results based on that person's facet scores and Step I preference results. These individualized descriptions are part of the copyrighted report and are not reproduced in any of the written materials.

Applications of the *MBTI® Step II™ Interpretive Report*

The *MBTI® Step II™ Interpretive Report* includes sections on the following applications:

- Communicating
- Managing Conflict
- Dealing with Change
- Making Decisions

Each application section provides the client's results on facets relevant to that application and offers tips for using those facets more effectively. The facets chosen for each application are ones that particularly influence a person's style in that area (e.g., communication style, conflict management style, etc.). The *MBTI® Manual* and the *MBTI® Step II™ User's Guide* provide additional guidance.

Interpreting Step II™ Results Using the Interpretive Report

Use the following steps to interpret an individual client's Step II results using the MBTI® Step II™ Interpretive Report.

1. Conduct a standard MBTI Step I verification and interpretation session if your client has not had one.

If the client has had such a session, review and confirm their understanding of the Step I type they identified (p. 3).

2. Explain what the Step II assessment does.

Using a sample report, explain the features of the Step II report and how to read Step II facet results (p. 4).

3. Give your client their report and verify Step II results.

Describe the opposites in each facet.

Ask the client to read their results on the facet and then ask for examples.

Unlike the four Step I preference pairs, Step II facets do not lend themselves to prior self-assessment. Facet content is too narrow and specific for that purpose. However, after your client has read the statements associated with each result, be sure to ask them to comment on their accuracy and/or point out statements that don't fit them. The client may indicate that a different category (midzone or the other pole) fits better. For any facet result that doesn't fit, ask your client for examples of their use of that facet. With midzone and out-of-preference scores, ask the client for examples of how that use of the facet works for them (pp. 5–8).

4. Focus on parts of the report that are relevant to the reason the client took the assessment.

Typically, you will not explore all the application material in the report with your client in one session. Plan to follow up at a later session, if possible.

5. Review and reinforce the importance of your client's whole type.

Include type dynamics (pp. 13–14).

6. Ideally, schedule a follow-up session.

The report includes a great deal of information, and clients typically need some time to review and digest it. Afterward, they may have questions about particular parts of the content, often about developmental opportunities suggested by the report.

Learning Module 5 of the certification program will review these steps and provide an opportunity for you to practice with a colleague interpreting Step II results using the Step II report.

Remember, if clients disagree with their reported Step I results after taking the Step II assessment, the MBTI practitioner can rerun their Step II Interpretive Report with a verified type.

GUIDANCE FROM RESOURCES

The *MBTI® Manual* and the *MBTI® Step II® User's Guide* give descriptions of the facet poles, describe midzone results, and offer guidance for interpreting out-of-preference and midzone results. Listed below is a breakdown of where to find specific information in these two resources.

MBTI® Manual

- Recommended steps for interpreting Step II results: chapter 6, pp. 118–119

MBTI® Step II® User's Guide

- How to conduct an individual interpretation session: chapter 8, pp. 75–79
- Group interpretation: chapter 8, pp. 79–80

INTERPRETING PUZZLING STEP II™ PROFILES

While most clients find their Step II report accurate and valuable, some will receive results that seem contradictory. The *MBTI® Step II® User's Guide* discusses such situations, provides examples, and suggests ways to respond effectively to client concerns. For example, the *User's Guide* addresses the following situations:

- Two facet result descriptions on a report that seem to contradict each other (pp. 83–84)
- Apparent inconsistency between Step I and Step II results (pp. 80–81)

Points to cover when exploring these puzzling profiles with clients include the following:

Explain to the client

- The facets do not “add up” to the preferences. The overall preference scales contain many items that cover a wide range of relevant information.
- Step II scoring uses a different method and item weights than does Step I scoring.
- Therefore, for example, it is possible (but rare) for a client to have three facet scores in the direction of one preference and report a preference that is in the opposite direction.

Explore with the client

- Does the client have any idea when or how any out-of-preference facet use developed?
- How do midzone and out-of-preference facets influence the way the client uses this preference?
- How effective is the client's use of the underlying preference?
- Are there any developmental opportunities here?

USING STEP II™ FACETS TO HELP VERIFY STEP I™ TYPE

Discussing the Step II facets with your clients can help them separate their natural dispositions from the behaviors and skills they have worked to develop. Once you have reviewed all 20 facets, it can

LEARNING MODULE 5: Understanding and Using the Step II™ Assessment and Interpretive Report

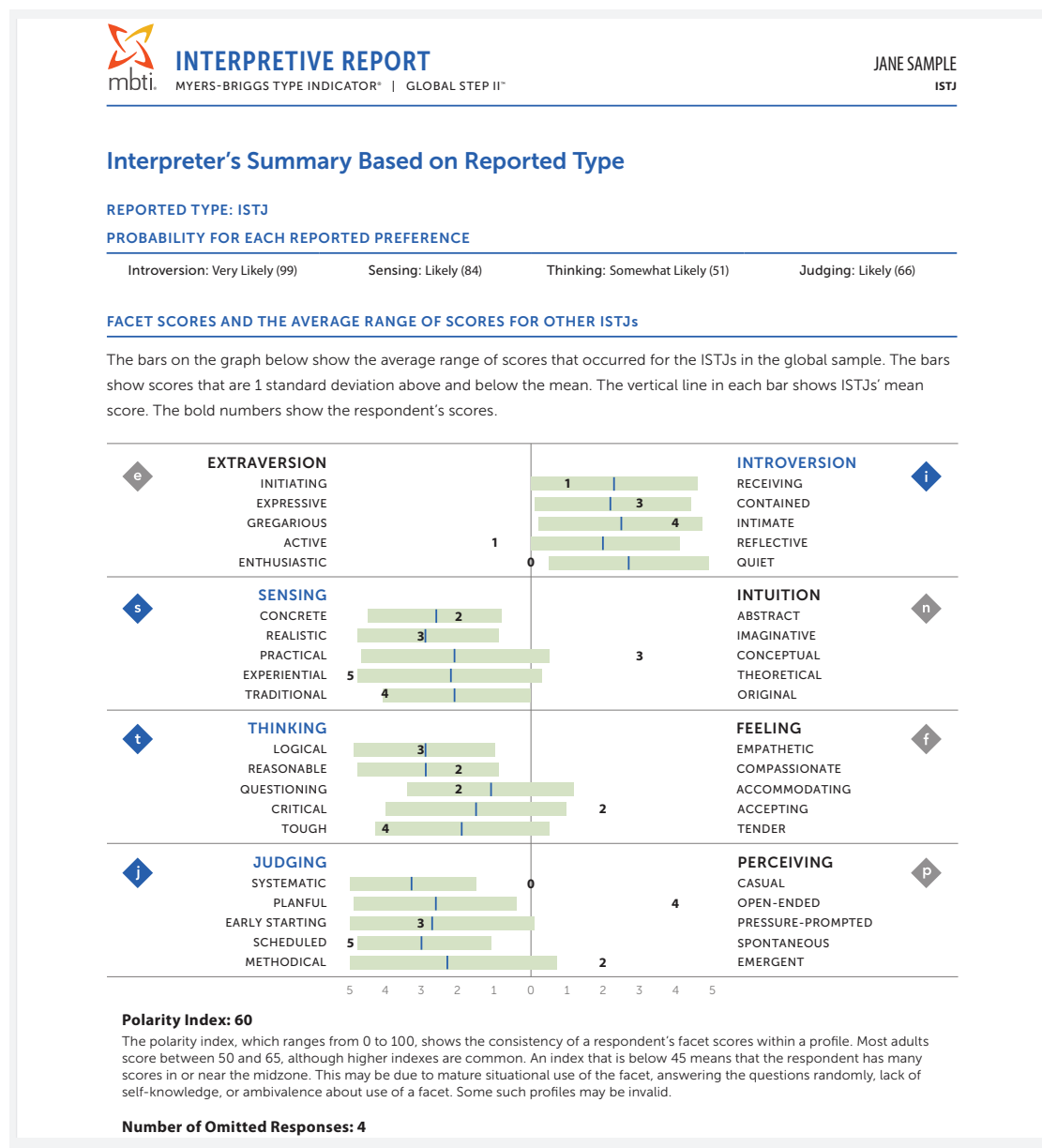
be useful to take clients back to the type descriptions in *Introduction to Myers-Briggs® Type* and explore whether Step II knowledge has helped them understand some of their life choices and verify their Step I type. Should clients verify a different best-fit type as a result of this process, you can offer to generate a new verified type report for them.

USING THE MBTI® STEP II™ INTERPRETIVE REPORT WITH TEAMS

The MBTI® Step II™ Interpretive Report is also valuable for use with teams. The certification program will model presenting the Step II report to a group and outline a structure for using it with groups.

TECHNICAL ASPECTS OF STEP II™ RESULTS

The Interpreter's Summary, on the last page of the MBTI® Step II™ Interpretive Report, includes information about several technical aspects of Step II results, as shown in the figure below. This Summary page should not be given to clients.



- **Step I type results:** 92 of the 143 Step II items are the items on the Step I assessment. The Step II report scores those 92 items to produce the Step I type (the preferences with their probability indexes).
- **Individual facet results:** Clients receive scores indicating how they responded to the items on each of the 20 Step II facets. The facets are graphed with 0 in the middle and scores of 1 to 5 going out toward both poles. A score of 5 indicates that all the items on that facet were answered in the direction of that pole; a score of 0 indicates an equal number of responses favoring each pole.
- **Average range of scores:** This term refers to the average range of scores for people of the same type in the Step II global sample. The "average range" is identified as ± 1 standard deviation, meaning that about two-thirds of the people of that type in the sample scored in that range.
- **Polarity index:** This is an indication of how consistently the client scored toward the poles of the 20 facets. The polarity index can range from 0 to 100. A polarity index of 100 indicates that a person's facet scores are all at the poles (i.e., all scores are "5," regardless of which poles are chosen; see *MBTI® Manual*, pp. 114–116). A polarity index of 0 would indicate that a client scored 0 on all facets.

GUIDANCE FROM RESOURCES

All these technical terms will be explored further during the certification program. For more information, consult the following resources:

- **Interpreter's Summary:** *MBTI® Step II™ User's Guide*, chapter 6, pp. 64–69
- **Average range of scores:** *MBTI® Step II™ User's Guide*, chapter 6, pp. 64–65
- **Polarity index:** *MBTI® Manual*, chapter 6, pp. 114–117, and chapter 8, pp. 179–181; *MBTI® Step II™ User's Guide*, chapter 6, pp. 65–67

REVIEW: MBTI® STEP II™ ASSESSMENT

POINTS TO REMEMBER

- Facet results: in-preference, out-of-preference, and midzone
- Layout of the MBTI® Step II™ Interpretive Report
- Steps in interpreting Step II results
- How to verify client results
- Average range of scores
- Polarity index

LEARNING MODULE 5 ACTION PLAN

In the table below, use a pencil to assess where you are right now.

During the certification program, you will be directed to review and revise your self-assessment and action plan each evening. Your final task in the program will be to identify steps to prepare yourself to use the MBTI assessment in your work setting.

✓ Put a check mark in the box that identifies your current self-assessment.

- Got It: ✓ Have enough information to do this competently now
- Need More: ✓ Generally understand, but need more information and/or practice
- Don't Have It: ✓ Not at all confident of my current knowledge or ability to use it
- Summary: ✓ Satisfied, confident, ready to go with this item
- ✗ Want to include this in my action plan steps as I go forward

Things I need to know	Got It	Need More	Don't Have It	Summary for Action Plan
DEVELOPMENT OF STEP II ASSESSMENT				
MBTI® STEP II™ INTERPRETIVE REPORT				
Layout of client facet results				
In-preference results				
Out-of-preference results				
Midzone results				
INTERPRETING STEP II RESULTS				
Steps in interpretation				
TECHNICAL ASPECTS OF STEP II RESULTS				
Facet scores				
Average range of scores				
Polarity index				

MBTI® Technical Overview

Note: This appendix is not required reading for the certification program. It is included here as a resource for deepening your understanding as you begin using type with clients.

Skill in using psychometric tools is not required for eligibility to purchase, administer, and interpret the MBTI® assessment. However, it is important that you be able to answer your clients' questions about technical aspects of the MBTI assessment. Learning Module 2 in this guide presents the most frequently asked questions about the assessment and effective ways for you to respond to them.

The information provided in Learning Module 2 is sufficient for most practitioners' uses. However, some practitioners and/or their clients may wish to pursue a deeper understanding of psychological testing applied to the MBTI assessment. This appendix presents technical information to help you increase your knowledge about the construction, reliability, and validity of the MBTI assessment.

Construction of the MBTI® Assessment

When we turn to the topic of construction, we approach the MBTI assessment with questions that are asked about any psychological test:

- Where did the items come from? How were they developed?
- Why are the items written the way they are?
- How were items tested? How do we know they are working as intended?
- How is the assessment scored?
- How do we interpret the scores?

Type and Trait Theories and Instruments

READING ASSIGNMENT

- *MBTI® Manual*, chapter 1, "Introduction to MBTI® Step I" and Step II" Type," pp. 9–11, "Differences Between the MBTI® Instruments and Other Personality Instruments"; and pp. 7–8, "Identifying MBTI® Preferences"

THINGS TO KNOW

- | | |
|--|--|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Trait theory of personality<ul style="list-style-type: none">- Trait-measuring assessments- Meaning and interpretation of results | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Type theory of personality<ul style="list-style-type: none">- Type-sorting assessments- Meaning and interpretation of results |
|--|--|

UNDERSTANDING TRAIT THEORY

Most psychological tests measure personality traits. Traits are relatively stable behavioral habits that everyone has to some degree. Trait assessments report how much or how little of a particular trait the respondent has and displays in behavior. A person with a low score on the trait of extraversion would have and display less extraversion than most people; a client with a high score would have

and display more extraversion than most; and so on. On most trait measures, there is a range of scores that is most desirable.

UNDERSTANDING TYPE THEORY

In a type instrument like the MBTI assessment, the items are not designed to measure how much or how little of a behavior a client has or displays. Instead, their purpose is to sort the client into a category that describes a behavioral preference. It's an either-or question, so too much or too little is irrelevant. In this way, type is similar to other categorical sorting, such as hand preference or eye color.

The number a person gets on an MBTI preference when the items are scored is called the *probability index*. It indicates the consistency with which the person chose one preference in a pair over the other in responding to the MBTI items. The interpretation of the probability index is technically the probability that the person would choose the same preference on retest. It can also be considered how consistent the person's responses were with those of other people who have the same preference.

- **Higher probability index:** The person consistently chose one preference rather than the other on this set of opposites and reported a preference clearly.
- **Lower probability index:** The person was less consistent in choosing one preference over the other on this set of opposites and did not report the preference as clearly.

Neither a higher probability index nor a lower one is good or bad, too much or too little. A probability index is simply an indication of consistency in reporting a preference and the likelihood that the preference is reported accurately for the individual due to consistency in responding.

UNDERSTANDING THE DIFFERENCE

Understanding this difference between *trait* and *type* is important for interpretive understanding. Not understanding the difference can lead to misuse of MBTI results. Quantitative interpretation of MBTI results as an indication that a respondent has "more" or "less" of a preference is incorrect. Such a practice is the most pervasive source of misunderstanding and misinterpretation of the MBTI assessment.

The general rule: Do not assign meaning to the number score (probability index). It does not indicate how much or how little—that is, the score does not indicate quantity of a preference. It also does not indicate development or how well or poorly an individual uses a preference.

Note: While this understanding of differences between type- and trait-based instruments is important (because both are a simplified model of personality), observation of one's own and others' behavior will likely show that some individuals behave more consistently with their preferences and whole type, while others are less predictable. This results from a variety of factors, such as awareness of one's preferences, the social context, precursor events, and other social and psychological phenomena that affect behavior.

SUMMARY: TYPE AND TRAIT ASSESSMENTS AND THEORIES

- Type assessments sort respondents into categories. Trait assessments measure how much or how little of a trait a person has and displays.
- The MBTI assessment assumes that the type categories are equally positive. Trait assessments measure results that can be interpreted as positive or negative.

Development of the MBTI® Items and Testing Methods Used in Earlier Forms of the Step I™ Assessment

THINGS TO KNOW

- Item development process
 - Self-report forced-choice format
 - Everyday behaviors
 - Psychological opposites
- Testing the items
 - Criterion group
 - Phrase items and word pairs
 - Educational, developmental, and gender differences
 - Social desirability
 - Scale independence

DEVELOPING THE ASSESSMENT

In the early 1940s, Isabel Myers and Katharine Briggs decided to construct a psychological assessment that would make Carl Jung's personality theory accessible to a wide audience. Though both were college graduates, neither had trained in psychology; however, their study of Jung and applications of his theory provided the basis for their beginning to write items. They extensively tested and thoroughly revised their work over the next decades, which resulted in the publication in the late 1970s of the *Myers-Briggs Type Indicator®* Form G assessment.

The MBTI assessment you completed prior to the certification program was the MBTI® Global Step II™ assessment, which was developed by the publisher, The Myers-Briggs Company, in the mid-2010s. Item selection and scoring were based primarily on data from a global sample of more than 16,000 adults.

DEVELOPING THE ITEMS

Jung's theory and Myers' goals for her assessment dictated most of the decisions made about writing items.

- The theory says that the preferences are opposites. Myers decided to use a **forced-choice (either-or) format** for all the items. This approach had a number of advantages for early versions of the MBTI assessment. Specifically, it simplified the scoring (counting responses) rather than requiring complex mathematical computations; provided the respondent with items that are psychological opposites, consistent with the theory; and simplified response options for most items (note that some items on earlier forms had as many as five response options). However, the forced-choice format is not the only way in which type preferences could be evaluated.

Clients sometimes complain, "Why did I have to choose? I do both." Of course, everyone uses both preferences in each preference pair at least some of the time. The assessment items give two reasonable, normal response options and then force respondents to choose one—the one most characteristic of them.

- Myers wanted her assessment to allow ordinary people to understand how type theory applies to them. She decided to use **everyday behaviors**, situations, or options that would be familiar to a wide range of people.

Clients sometimes observe that the items seem trivial: “You’re saying these are predisposed preferences, they last throughout our life, they influence our choice of careers and our development path. Then you ask, ‘When you go somewhere for the day, would you rather plan what you will do and when, or just go?’”

Myers referred to the items as “straws in the wind,” with the wind being the underlying preference. Like the wind, preferences are not visible; but we can see the effects—typical everyday behaviors. Myers avoided psychological jargon and overly complex items. She began writing items based on differences in behaviors she and Briggs had observed in people they knew.

- Myers wanted her assessment to be appropriate for a wide range of people: she decided to use a **self-report format**.

Self-report assessments were not widely used in the early 1940s, when Myers began developing items. This approach to assessing personality fit with Myers’ values and goals.

- Myers wanted her assessment to work for people of all type preferences. She wrote items that are **psychologically opposite**.

Clients sometimes note that the two choices given are not logically opposite. Myers said that the choices are designed to “evoke a type response”—to appeal to type differences. If they are psychological opposites, they will discriminate between the two preferences in a pair.

Additionally, logical opposites would often result in one option being negative. The opposite of “competent,” for example, is “incompetent,” an option few would choose, regardless of their preference for, say, Thinking or Feeling.

TESTING THE ITEMS

- Myers wanted to test whether her items were working, so as a first phase of testing, she compiled a **criterion group** of about 20 people whose personality types she knew to respond to them. Because her test group consisted of people she knew, she was able to investigate unexpected responses by simply asking people why they gave the answer they did. Myers found that some of her group responded to the **phrase items** by thinking of the last time they had been in that situation, while others focused on key words to choose the behavior that was most characteristic of them.

Myers decided to try using **word pairs** to remove the situational influence. The word pairs worked and allowed Myers to increase the number of items without adding greatly to the time required to complete the assessment.

- Myers wanted her assessment to work for **people at different educational and developmental levels**, and for **both men and women**. She compiled larger, more diverse samples to identify items that worked in these different groups. As part of this process, she consistently checked for gender differences in responses to all items. She also checked for type differences and age differences. The items she eventually chose were those that worked for all ages and all types.

However, Myers found so many gender differences in the Thinking–Feeling items that she decided to create different scoring for men and women on that preference pair. This gender scoring difference remained in place until the Form M revision in the late 1990s, when T–F questions were identified that worked similarly for men and women. Although scoring is the same for men and women, there are some gender differences on the MBTI assessment, particularly on T–F, where women are more likely to score F and men are more likely to score T.

- Jung’s theory said that type identifies normal human characteristics shared by all; type patterns result from habitually using a “very early (probably innate) choice” (Myers, I. B., *Manual: The Myers-Briggs Type Indicator*®, 1962, p. 72) for some of these characteristics rather than others. Each preference is equally valuable.

Nevertheless, cultural and environmental influences typically result in some type-related behaviors being regarded more positively than others. For a forced-choice assessment to work, the two response options need to be equally acceptable and appealing so that respondents can choose the one that fits for them.

Myers used a formula to check for **social desirability**. It included checking the percentage of people who chose the preference opposite theirs. A percentage that exceeded Myers' set standards indicated that one preference in a pair was more socially desirable than the other. Items that fell into this category were modified or eliminated.

- Myers decided to use four separate preference pairs, but her goal was to identify the whole type—the personality pattern explained by Jung. While she did not expect the preferences to be evenly distributed in the population, she did expect to identify 16 different possible combinations of preferences. To achieve this result, the four **scales needed to remain independent**—that is, people's results on one of the scales should not predict their results on another scale.

SUMMARY: DEVELOPMENT AND TESTING OF THE MBTI® ITEMS

- Myers wrote forced-choice items to reflect Jung's theory of opposites.
- She wrote items about everyday behaviors and used a self-report format to make the assessment widely accessible.
- She wrote items with response options that were equally positive but that appealed to people with opposite preferences.
- She developed the first items using a small criterion group of people whose type preferences she knew.
- She then tested the items on larger, more diverse groups, checking to see that they worked for men and women and for people of different educational and developmental levels.
- The revision to create the Global Step I assessment used the same rigorous approach to the testing of items on even larger, more diverse groups of people worldwide.

Scoring the MBTI® Assessment

READING ASSIGNMENT

- *MBTI® Manual*, chapter 7 (entire chapter), "Construction of the MBTI® Global Assessments," pp. 133–159

THINGS TO KNOW

- Priorities for the Global Step I and Step II revision
- Translation of the global research version
- Data collection from samples from around the world
- Latent class analysis (LCA) scoring
- Item response theory (IRT) scoring
 - Item characteristic curve (ICC)
- MBTI results
- Probability index
 - Probability categories

PRIORITIES OF THE REVISION OF THE STEP I™ AND STEP II™ ASSESSMENTS

The overarching goals of the revision were to

- Preserve the integrity of the Step I and Step II forms of the assessment
- Improve the reliability and validity of the assessment overall

You can read more about the priorities for the revision in chapter 7 in the *MBTI® Manual*.

CREATION, TRANSLATION, AND DATA COLLECTION RELATED TO THE GLOBAL RESEARCH VERSION OF THE MBTI® ASSESSMENT

Information explaining how the global research version was created and translated can be found on p. 135 in the *MBTI® Manual*.

Information about the samples from which data were collected is also provided in the *MBTI® Manual* (pp. 135–138) and in the *MBTI® Manual Global Supplement Series*, available at www.themyersbriggs.com/mbti-manual-supplements.

LATENT CLASS ANALYSIS (LCA) SCORING

The Global Step I assessment uses LCA scoring for the four preference pairs. LCA creates item weights (among other statistics, such as bivariate residuals) for each item, which were used to select items and score the Step I results.

If you are interested in learning more about how LCA scoring is used with the MBTI assessment, or if you think your clients will want to know about this, refer to chapter 7 in the *MBTI® Manual*.

ITEM RESPONSE THEORY (IRT) SCORING

The Global Step II assessment uses IRT scoring, as did the prior Step I Form M and Step II Form Q assessments. IRT creates **item characteristic curves** (among other results) for each item, which form the basis of item selection decisions and scoring.

If you are interested in learning how IRT scoring is used with the MBTI assessment, or if you think your clients will want to know about this, refer to chapter 7 in the *MBTI® Manual* and the references it cites.

The difference between the Global Step I assessment's scoring method (LCA) and that of the Global Step II assessment (IRT) is related to the underlying theory. The Step I assessment is designed to measure categorical preferences. LCA is thus the appropriate statistical model because it is designed to best handle categories. Step II theory, on the other hand, does not presume that facets are categorical, and some or all facets may be structured as continuums. Because there was no theoretical rationale for using a categorical LCA approach with facets, IRT was selected as the best choice for scoring the Global Step II assessment.

In practice, both LCA and IRT (as well as classical test theory analyses) tend to identify the same items as strong and the same items as weak, and information provided by both LCA and IRT were used in the development of the global assessments. MBTI scales produced under both LCA and IRT approaches tend to be very highly correlated.

MBTI® RESULTS

LCA and IRT scoring occurs when the assessments are completed online. LCA scoring produces a letter identifying each preference and a probability value (**probability index**) that indicates the likelihood of getting the same preference on retest. LCA scoring also assigns probability index values to a **probability category** (somewhat likely, likely, very likely).

The Step I assessment (Form M) is available in a self-scorable version. This version is scored by the respondent. Self-scoring produces a letter identifying the preference chosen as well as its preference clarity category (slight, moderate, clear, very clear).

Online and self-scorable scoring are highly correlated, but online scoring is recommended for maximum accuracy.

Reliability and Validity of the MBTI® Assessment

When deciding to use the MBTI assessment—or any other assessment—the ethical practitioner needs to ask two questions:

- Is it reliable with the kinds of clients I'll be asking to take it?
- Are the results valid for the ways I'm intending to use them?

Chapter 8 in the *MBTI® Manual* presents evidence for the reliability of the Global Step I and Step II assessments. Chapters 9 and 10 contain a great deal of information about the validity of MBTI Step I and Step II results when used for a broad range of purposes.

To assess this information, we need to be able to understand a few basic statistical and psychometric terms, interpret the meaning of data presented in different ways, and read some of the tables in the manual. These topics are addressed below, with an explanation of how they are used in assessing MBTI reliability and validity.

Reliability

READING ASSIGNMENT

- *MBTI® Manual*, chapter 8 (entire chapter), "Reliability of the MBTI® Global Step I" and Step II" Assessments," pp. 161–182

Note: Are you knowledgeable about tests and measurements? If you are, read chapter 8 (pp. 161–182) in the *MBTI® Manual* first; then read the material below. If you are new to tests and measurements, read the information presented here first; then read chapter 8 in the *MBTI® Manual*.

THINGS TO KNOW

- Definition of reliability
- Factors affecting reliability
- Standards for assessing reliability correlation coefficients
- Internal consistency (coefficient alpha)
- Test-retest reliability

Reliability is concerned with the consistency of responding among items and the consistency of results over time.

Every assessment has some error in it. For example, you probably would not be surprised if when you weighed yourself Tuesday morning the result was slightly different than when you weighed yourself the day before. You know that scales aren't perfect and, as long as the results are close, you don't worry about it.

The same is true for tests. No test is perfect; every test has some degree of error. The important question is whether the test is consistent enough for us to feel comfortable using it.

There are two common methods for checking the reliability of a test:

- Internal consistency
- Test-retest

The *MBTI® Manual* provides information about both methods.

INTERNAL CONSISTENCY RELIABILITY

Internal consistency reliability checks to see whether respondents' answers within a scale are consistent—for example, on the Global Step I assessment, do people respond to the E–I items (and those for the other preference pairs) in a consistent way? One common way to check the internal consistency of psychometric assessments is through what is called “Cronbach’s alpha,” which is based on correlation.

A NOTE ON CORRELATIONS

Simply put, correlations are relationships between variables. We regularly see reports showing correlations. For example, we see reports of a relationship between years of education and income: The more years of education people have, the higher their income is likely to be. Other reports concern the relationship between amount of physical exercise and weight. These kinds of reports rely on correlational statistics.

Correlations are produced by a statistical formula that compares people’s results on two different variables to see whether and how closely they relate to each other. The product of the correlation formula is called the **correlation coefficient**, which is designated by the symbol r .

When people’s scores on two scales are plugged into the correlation formula, a number between -1 and 1 is produced, with zero (0) as the midpoint in the coefficient’s range of scores (e.g., $r = .31$). The closer the correlation coefficient is to 1 or -1 , the stronger the relationship. The closer the correlation coefficient is to 0 , the weaker the relationship. So two scales correlated at $r = .20$ have a closer relationship than two scales correlated at $r = .02$. Negative correlations indicate that as the value of one variable increases, the value of the second variable decreases. For example, there is a negative correlation between obesity and life expectancy. As obesity increases, life expectancy decreases. An example of a positive correlation is between height and weight. As height increases, weight tends to increase as well.

Coefficient alpha is a standard way of checking internal consistency. Coefficient alpha is a function of the number of items and the average of all the item correlations. In general, alphas above $.70$ are considered good.

SUMMARY OF THE DATA: INTERNAL CONSISTENCY

Tables 8.1–8.5 (pp. 165–166) in the *MBTI® Manual* report data on the internal consistency of the MBTI® Global Step I™ assessment. In these tables, the reliability coefficients are in the excellent range for different age groups, genders, and racial and ethnic groups. Tables 8.6–8.8 (pp. 167–170) show that the internal consistency reliabilities of the MBTI® Global Step II™ assessment are comparable to those of the subscales of other mainstream personality assessments.

TEST-RETEST RELIABILITY

The other primary way reliability is checked is “test-retest,” which is just what it sounds like. People in sample groups complete the MBTI Step I or Step II assessment at two different times. Results from the two administrations are compared to each other. As with any reliability check, we want the results to be very similar.

One way to report test-retest results is to use correlations. Global Step I data are shown in tables 8.9 and 8.10 (p. 171) in the *MBTI® Manual*. In general, test-retest correlations are above .80 for each MBTI preference scale.

The other way to report test-retest results is to give percentages—the percentage of people who obtained the same result (e.g., reported the same preference on a pair of opposites) in each category when they took an assessment a second time. Table 8.11 (p. 172) shows that for the Global Step I assessment agreement rates on all four preference pairs are over 80% for periods of 7 to 15 weeks apart. Each of the four preference scales is generally stable over time. The equivalent data for the Global Step II assessment are based on analysis of interpretive category (left pole, right pole, midzone) and are shown in table 8.16 (p. 178).

Test-retest agreement rates can also be calculated for whole type, which requires that four out of four preference categories match exactly. In general, retest studies show whole-type agreement rates from 50% to 70%. Although this seems somewhat low, and critics sometimes cite these figures, remember that chance agreement rate is 6.25% (1 in 16). Even a 50% agreement rate is eight times better than chance.

In addition, we know that the people who are most likely to change are those who scored close to the cutoff points on certain preferences. In other words, not all individuals are equally likely to switch; the probability index can be used to predict for whom and on which preferences changes are most likely to occur over time.

A number of outside factors can affect the consistency with which people report on a test. These include the kinds of directions people are given, their mind-set and motivation when they are responding to the items, concerns about who will know their results and how they think the results will be used, and many individual circumstances.

SUMMARY OF THE DATA: TEST-RETEST RELIABILITY

Data indicate that the MBTI preference scales are generally stable over time, with each scale showing a .80 correlation (when using continuous scores) or 80% agreement rates (when using preference categories). Chapter 8 in the *MBTI® Manual* provides extensive data on the test-retest properties of the Global Step I and Step II assessments.

Validity

READING ASSIGNMENT

- *MBTI® Manual*, pp. 183–184

THINGS TO KNOW

- Validity definition
- Types of validity
 - Content validity
 - Construct validity
- Processes used to check validity
 - Correlations with other assessments
 - Direction of the correlation
 - Effect sizes
 - R-squared
 - Cohen's *d*
- Statistical significance

DEFINING VALIDITY

The definition of validity as it applies to tests is similar to the definition in everyday life: *When we explore the validity of a test, we ask, are the results true? Can we use the results for the purposes the test says we can?*

Remember that reliability, discussed in the previous section, is about consistency and repeatability: When I weigh myself on my scale two times, do I get similar results? Validity asks a different question: When I weigh myself on my scale, am I getting an accurate indication of my actual weight? To test the validity of my scale, I would need to weigh myself at home and then, soon after, at the doctor's office. Are the results from the two different assessments similar enough that I can be confident in the "truthfulness" of my scale?

It is important to distinguish between reliability and validity. Reliability is about consistency within the test, while validity is about the test being appropriate for our purposes. The scale you weigh yourself on might be a reliable assessment, but it would not be valid for telling you your height. That would require a different kind of device. Similarly, a test of math skills could be reliable, but it would not be valid for indicating your reading ability.

Likewise, we have seen data demonstrating that the MBTI assessment has excellent reliability: We can feel confident about its consistency over time. However, this does not tell us whether the assessment is valid: Do people's MBTI results give them a good indication of their personality type? Is the assessment a valid way to assess personality differences? To use the MBTI assessment with confidence, we need evidence of both its reliability and its validity.

TYPES OF VALIDITY

Tests and measurements experts define several different types of validity. This section describes two of these:

- Content validity
- Construct validity

Content validity: If a scale covers the entire field of knowledge it claims to test, it is said to have good content validity. A scale used for advanced placement into a high-level math course needs to contain questions that test more than simple addition and subtraction skills in order to identify students who can perform well in a high-level course.

Content validity is important for all scales, including those on the MBTI assessments. Content validity is assessed by experts in the field—in this case, experts in the Jung-Myers theory of personality type evaluate the assessment to determine whether it is covering the whole of the theory. The MBTI assessment assesses the separate factors Jung explained: extraversion and introversion, sensing and intuitive perception, and thinking and feeling judgment. The addition of the J–P scale by Isabel Myers brings in the dynamics of type, central to the Jung-Myers theory. So we can say that the MBTI assessment has good content validity.

Construct validity: If a test has good construct validity, empirical evidence supports the theory behind the test. This is the most important kind of validity for psychological assessments, which typically are designed to fit people into a model of personality.

The *MBTI® Manual* discusses many studies of construct validity. Here we will look at two ways in which the manual presents construct validity of the MBTI assessment: (1) correlating MBTI results with results on other assessments and (2) examining differences (Cohen's *d*) between different groups of respondents to evaluate whether the differences are consistent with type theory predictions. The manual relies largely on correlation coefficients (which can be converted to R-squared values) and Cohen's *d* rather than on null hypothesis testing to demonstrate validity evidence of the MBTI assessment. Variance accounted for is a way of explaining the impact or overall importance of a statistical relationship. Measures of variance accounted for, or *effect sizes*, can be computed for most statistical techniques.

1. Correlating with other assessments

Using correlations for assessing validity requires four steps:

- Administering two different assessments to a sample group
- Predicting how MBTI results should correlate with the results from the other assessment based on type theory
- Correlating the results from the two assessments
- Applying statistical significance testing to see if the results can be generalized

Step 1: There are two samples in the example shown in table 1—1,550 people from the global sample and another 1,662 people aggregated across studies of the NEO assessment and MBTI Form G. For both samples, scores on two different assessments were computed; the correlations are presented in the table.

Step 2: The researchers predicted which MBTI preference pairs should correlate with the Big Five scales—if the MBTI assessment is accurately sorting people into their Myers-Briggs type. To make these predictions, researchers needed to use their knowledge of the Jung-Myers theory and of what the Five Factor Model (FFM) measures. For this example, a prediction was made that individuals with a preference for Extraversion will have a higher score on the FFM measure of extroversion and individuals with a preference for Introversion will have a lower score on the FFM measure of extroversion.

Step 3: The researchers correlated people's results on each of the MBTI preference pairs with their results on each of the FFM measures. As shown in table 1, the correlations for the hypothesis in Step 2 range from $-.47$ in Study 1 to $-.69$ for study 2 (note that the negative sign

occurs because for the MBTI assessment, Extraversion is on the left and Introversion on the right, and for the FFM, higher scores indicate more extroversion and lower scores indicate less extroversion). When MBTI preference pair results are turned into continuous scales, as required by the correlation formula, the lower end of the continuous scale is the E, S, T, or J end; higher numbers of the continuous scale are at the I, N, F, or P end. Thus, a positive correlation tells us that higher scores on the other instrument's scale correlate with higher scores on the MBTI preference pair continuous scale. A negative correlation tells us that higher scores on the other instrument's scale correlate with lower scores on the MBTI preference pair continuous scale.

Step 4: The correlation is there, as predicted; but is the relationship a real one—one that would be similar if we did another study like this, one that we can generalize from?

In the current example, the correlation between the extroversion measure from the ACL and the MBTI measure of Introversion and Extraversion is $-.49$. Squaring it indicates a variance accounted for of $.24$, which can be interpreted as the two measures sharing about 24% of the variance in responding. This would be a medium effect, according to Cohen's guidelines.

2. Cohen's d : Another measure of variance accounted for

Cohen's d is the difference between the means of the two groups divided by the pooled or common standard deviation. In other words, it expresses the difference between the means of the two groups in standard deviation units. In type terms, the larger the absolute value of d , the more separation or difference there is between people at the two poles on the dependent variable. Positive values of d are associated with higher means by those with I, N, F, or P preferences, while negative values indicate that those with E, S, T, or J preferences have higher means. (Note that the sign of d used here is in the same direction as the sign of correlation coefficients used in other tables in the *MBTI® Manual*, as well as in earlier MBTI manuals and most research articles on the MBTI assessment.) For example, the difference between Extraverts' and Introverts' scores on the CPI 260® Sociability scale in the sample shown in

Table 1 | Correlations of MBTI® Step I™ continuous scores with Big Five scales scored from the ACL and the NEO™ assessment

Big Five scale	Global Step I™ continuous scores			
	E-I	S-N	T-F	J-P
ACL				
Neuroticism	.07	.03	.14	.06
Extraversion	-.47	.14	-.01	.08
Openness	-.15	.30	-.07	.08
Agreeableness	-.13	.18	.29	.06
Conscientiousness	-.01	.00	-.06	-.16
Big Five scale	Form G Step I™ continuous scores			
	E-I	S-N	T-F	J-P
NEO™ assessment				
Neuroticism	.22	.05	.12	.13
Extraversion	-.69	.03	.06	.06
Openness	-.09	.53	.05	.18
Agreeableness	-.04	-.03	.31	-.02
Conscientiousness	-.07	-.18	-.22	-.40

Note: Top half of table from a portion of the global sample that took the ACL, $n = 1,550$. Bottom half of table from a meta-analysis of NEO and MBTI Form G studies (Arneson, J. J., & Landowski, N., 2015, Meta-analysis of relationships between the MBTI® and NEO™, unpublished internal document, CPP, Inc.), $N = 1,662$.

Source: In Myers, I. B., McCaulley, M. H., Quenk, N. L., & Hammer, A. L. (2018). *MBTI® manual for the Global Step I™ and Step II™ assessments* (p. 196). Sunnyvale, CA: The Myers-Briggs Company.

table 9.4 in the *MBTI® Manual* (see extract shown in table 2, below) is $d = -1.34$, indicating that the scores of Extraverts and Introverts on this particular dependent variable are separated by one and one-third standard deviation units.

As with other validity correlation information, there is no hard-and-fast standard for saying “That’s a lot” or “That’s a little.” Instead, we can use variance accounted for to get a sense of how important a relationship is—how much attention we might want to give it if we’re using the two instruments. Cohen provides the following values as interpretive guidance for effect sizes of Pearson product-moment correlations: small = .10, medium = .30, and large = .50.

More commonly used in the manual are Cohen’s d effect size estimates. We can explore this concept using the data provided in table 2.

Again, following the steps listed above, scores were obtained for the same people on the two assessments. The researchers hypothesized, based on their knowledge of both assessments, that respondents who are classified as Extraverts would likely have higher scores on the measures from the CPI 260 classified as measures of “Dealing With Others.” The researchers computed mean (average) CPI 260 scores for each of the two groups (MBTI Extraverts and MBTI Introverts) and compared the means and computed Cohen’s d statistics. The results are consistent with the hypotheses and can be interpreted based on the d statistics as generally medium (Independence) to large (Sociability) effects. The results show that MBTI results are consistent with the expected results on a second, independent assessment.

Table 2 | **MBTI® global sample opposite-preference differences on CPI 260® scales**

CPI 260® scale	Extraversion ($n = 715$)		Introversion ($n = 1,013$)		Cohen’s d	Summary
	M	SD	M	SD		
Dominance (Do)	21.59	5.71	14.76	6.23	–1.14	E
Capacity for Status (Cs)	14.74	3.86	10.74	3.95	–1.02	E
Sociability (Sy)	16.05	3.41	10.80	4.22	–1.34	E
Social Presence (Sp)	18.44	3.76	14.66	3.96	–0.98	E
Self-acceptance (Sa)	14.65	3.20	11.04	3.93	–0.99	E
Independence (In)	14.44	3.80	11.62	4.20	–0.70	E
Empathy (Em)	14.41	3.24	11.39	3.23	–0.93	E

Note: Portion of the global sample that completed the CPI 260 assessment, $n = 1,728$.

Source: In Myers, I. B., McCaulley, M. H., Quenk, N. L., & Hammer, A. L. (2018). *MBTI® manual for the Global Step I® and Step II® assessments* (p. 190). Sunnyvale, CA: The Myers-Briggs Company.

Online Reports

This appendix contains a list of Step I™ and Step II™ reports available for a variety of MBTI® assessment formats at www.themyersbriggs.com/elevate, an introduction to the Elevate® online assessment delivery platform, and a sample of the MBTI® Global Step II™ Interpretive Report.

Online Reports

MBTI® GLOBAL STEP I™

Primary Purpose

Provides basic four-letter type and serves as a starting point for personality type discussions. Should be used in settings where the assessment can be administered in advance.

Available Reports

Profile: Basic preference information in a three-page report

Interpretive Report: Profile and interpretive description of reported type

Interpretive Report for Organizations: Profile and interpretive report that focuses on the individual's type as it is expressed in business and organizational settings

Personal Impact Report: All-in-one report offering comprehensive interpretation guidance on a wide range of applications, as well as descriptions of personal style, specific development action items, and optional exercises for verifying type

Number of items: 92

Approximate administration time:
15–25 minutes

Scoring method four-letter type:
Latent class analysis (LCA) via The Myers-Briggs Company's assessment site at www.themyersbriggs.com/elevate

MBTI® GLOBAL STEP II™

Primary Purpose

Provides basic four-letter type plus information about the 20 facets that underlie type preference for a deeper exploration of personality type. Should be used in a setting where the assessment can be administered in advance.

Available Reports

Step II™ Profile: Five-page profile of results on Step II facets; includes four-letter type

Step II™ Interpretive Report: Seventeen-page narrative covering four-letter type, Step II results and meaning of specific facet scores, and individualized applications information

Number of items: 143

Approximate administration time:
25–30 minutes

Scoring method four-letter type:
Latent class analysis (LCA) via The Myers-Briggs Company's assessment site at www.themyersbriggs.com/elevate

Scoring method facet results: Item response theory (IRT) via The Myers-Briggs Company's assessment site at www.themyersbriggs.com/elevate

MBTI® COMPLETE (GLOBAL STEP I™ OR GLOBAL STEP II™)

Primary Purpose

Practitioner chooses to administer Step I or Step II items. Provides basic four-letter type plus online interpretation/verification of Step I results via an Interactive Learning Session. Can also provide information about the 20 Step II facets. For use in settings where best-fit type is needed without providing in-person interpretation.

Available Reports

Profile plus best-fit type description: Basic preference information and a three-page description of the individual's best-fit type; practitioners can also order any available Global Step I or Step II reports for clients or workshop participants

Number of items: 92 (Step I);
143 (Step II)

Approximate administration time:
60–90 minutes

Scoring method four-letter type:
Latent class analysis (LCA) via The Myers-Briggs Company's assessment site at www.themyersbriggs.com/elevate

Scoring method facet results: Item response theory (IRT) via The Myers-Briggs Company's assessment site at www.themyersbriggs.com/elevate

MBTI® STEP I™ (FORM M)

Primary Purpose

Provides basic four-letter type and serves as a starting point for personality type discussions. Should be used in settings where the assessment can be administered in advance.

Available Reports

Number of items: 93

Approximate administration time:
15–25 minutes

Scoring method: IRT scoring via The Myers-Briggs Company's assessment site at www.themyersbriggs.com/elevate

Profile: Basic preference information in a three-page report

Interpretive Report: Profile and interpretive description of reported type

Interpretive Report for Organizations: Profile and interpretive report that focuses on the individual's type as it is expressed in business and organizational settings

Communication Style Report: Report that describes the client's communication style, highlights strengths, and offers tips for communicating effectively

Decision-Making Style Report: Report that describes the client's decision-making style, highlights strengths, and offers tips for making effective decisions

Stress Management Style Report: Report that describes the client's stress management style, highlights strengths, and offers tips for handling stress effectively

Conflict Style Report: Report that describes the client's conflict style, highlights strengths, and offers tips for managing conflict effectively

Team Report: Team type profile that describes the functioning of a team with that array of types; includes information about the team as a whole and the individual team member, plus a facilitator report to aid team facilitator

Comparison Report: Work Styles: Report that helps two people identify, address, and resolve sources of workplace conflict

Career Report: Report linking client type with career information and strategies for improving job satisfaction

Strong & MBTI® Career Report: *Strong Interest Inventory*® and MBTI results integrated for the client to identify occupations in a comprehensive career development system

Leadership Report Using the FIRO-B® & MBTI® Instruments: FIRO-B and MBTI results integrated to help clients understand their preferred leadership style, strengths, and areas to develop as a leader

Profile, College Edition: Basic preference information in a two-page report for the student

Interpretive Report, College Edition: Profile and interpretive description of reported type for the student

MBTI® STEP II™ (FORM Q)

Primary Purpose

Provides reported or verified four-letter type plus results on 20 facets of the MBTI preference pairs for a deeper exploration of personality type. Should be used in settings where the assessment can be administered in advance.

Number of items: 144

Approximate administration time:
25–30 minutes

Scoring method: IRT scoring via The Myers-Briggs Company's assessment site at www.themyersbriggs.com/elevate

Available Reports

Step II™ Profile: Five-page profile of results on Step II facets; includes client's reported or verified four-letter type

Step II™ Interpretive Report: Seventeen-page narrative report covering reported or verified four-letter type, Step II results and meaning of specific facet scores, and individualized applications information

Also Available

MBTI® STEP I™ (FORM M) SELF-SCORABLE

Primary Purpose

Provides basic reported four-letter type. Designed for use in a group, classroom, or workshop setting when participants are unable to take the Step I assessment online or when administration and feedback must be completed during the same in-person session.

Number of items: 93

Approximate administration time:
15–20 minutes

Approximate scoring time:
15–20 minutes

Scoring method: Self-scoring booklet with built-in scoring key

Available Reports

Self-Scorable: Compact booklet containing 93 items, an answer sheet, and easy-to-understand interpretive information

Self-Scorable, College Edition: Compact booklet containing 93 items, an answer sheet, and easy-to-understand interpretive information for the student

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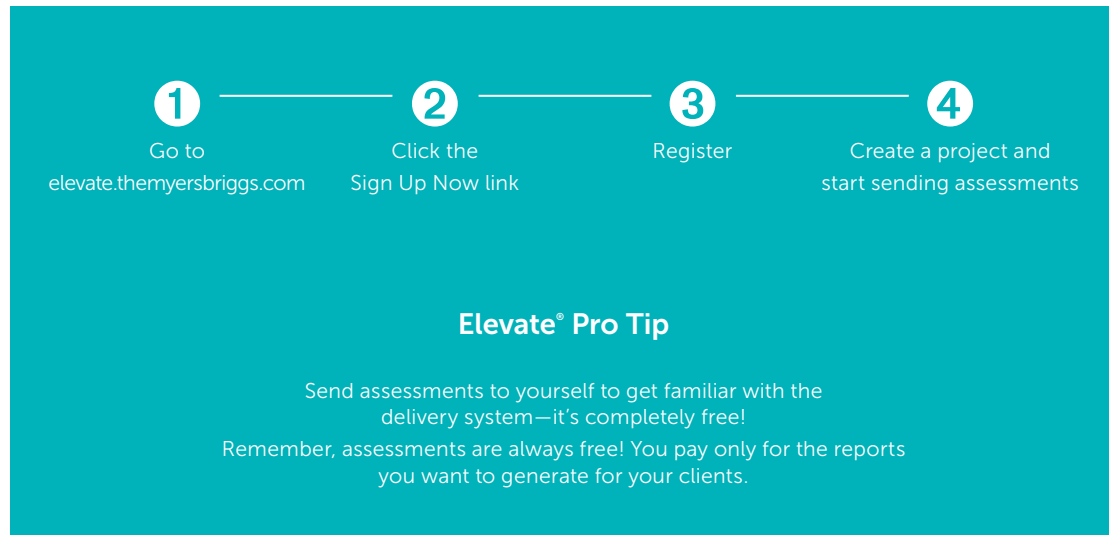
Monday–Friday
6:00am–4:30pm PT

elevate.themyersbriggs.com



Elevate®

To Get Your Practice Started



How the Elevate® Platform Works

As you start using the Elevate platform more, remember these three key steps:



CREATE A PROJECT

To send assessments to your clients, you'll first create a project. Your clients will receive an email with a project link that allows them to take the assessments.



PURCHASE INVENTORY

Once your clients complete their assessments, you'll need to purchase inventory to download reports. You can purchase reports directly from your project.



DOWNLOAD REPORTS

Once you have inventory, you can download your clients' reports. Reports are taken from your inventory the first time you download them. Re-downloads are always free.

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MYERS-BRIGGS TYPE INDICATOR® | GLOBAL STEP II™
INTERPRETIVE REPORT

Prepared for
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October 31, 2018

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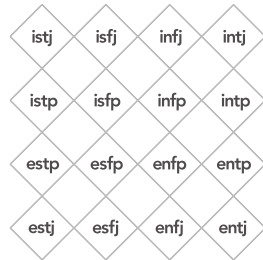


INTERPRETIVE REPORT

MYERS-BRIGGS TYPE INDICATOR® | GLOBAL STEP II™

JANE SAMPLE

2



About Your Report

Your Myers-Briggs® Step II™ Interpretive Report is an in-depth, personalized description of your personality preferences, derived from your answers to the MBTI® assessment. It includes your Step I™ results and your four-letter type, along with your Step II results, which show some of the unique ways you express your Step I type.

The MBTI assessment was developed by Isabel Myers and Katharine Briggs as an application of Carl Jung's theory of personality types. This theory suggests that we have opposite ways of directing and receiving energy (Extraversion or Introversion), taking in information (Sensing or Intuition), deciding or coming to conclusions about that information (Thinking or Feeling), and approaching the outside world (Judging or Perceiving).

Everyone can and does use each of these eight parts of personality at least some of the time but prefers one in each pair over the other, just as most people have a natural preference for using one hand rather than the other. No preference in a pair is better or more desirable than its opposite.

The MBTI assessment does not measure your skills or abilities in any area. Rather, it is a tool to help you become aware of your particular style and to better understand and appreciate the helpful ways that people differ from one another.

YOUR REPORT CONTAINS

- Your Step I™ Results
- Your Step II™ Facet Results
- Applying Step II™ Results to Communicating
- Applying Step II™ Results to Managing Conflict
- Applying Step II™ Results to Dealing with Change
- Applying Step II™ Results to Making Decisions
- How the Parts of Your Personality Work Together
- Integrating Step I™ and Step II™ Information
- Using Type to Gain Understanding
- Overview of Your Results

Extraversion

You focus on the outside world and direct and receive energy by interacting with people, objects, and activities.



Introversion

You focus on the inner world and direct and receive energy by reflecting on ideas, memories, and experiences.



Sensing

You notice and trust facts, details, and present realities.



Intuition

You attend to and trust interrelationships, theories, and future possibilities.



Thinking

You make decisions using logical analysis to achieve objectivity.



Feeling

You make decisions using person-centered values to achieve harmony.



Judging

You tend to be organized and orderly and to make decisions quickly.



Perceiving

You tend to be flexible and adaptable and to keep your options open as long as possible.





INTERPRETIVE REPORT

MYERS-BRIGGS TYPE INDICATOR® | GLOBAL STEP II™

JANE SAMPLE

ISTJ | 3



Your Step I™ Results

Your reported Myers-Briggs personality type
ISTJ

Your preferences
Introversion | Sensing | Thinking | Judging

ISTJs are typically dependable, realistic, and practical. They remember and use facts and want things clearly and logically stated. They are thorough, systematic, hard working, and careful with particulars and procedures. When they see something that needs to be done, ISTJs accept the responsibility. They do not enter into activities impulsively, but once committed, they are hard to distract or discourage. They lend stability to projects and persevere in the face of adversity.

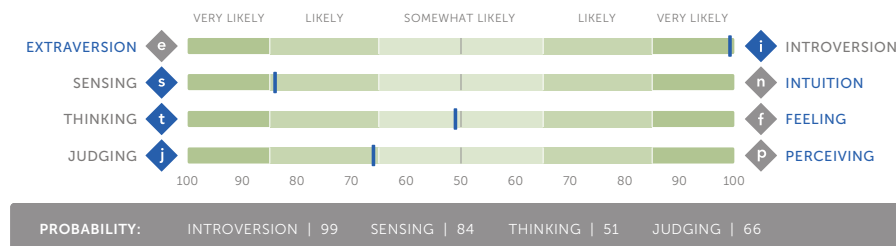
ISTJs appear sound and sensible and seem calm and composed. Even in a crisis they seldom show their highly individual and intense inner reactions. ISTJs' practical judgment and respect for procedures make them come across as consistent and moderate. They assemble facts to support their evaluations and communicate the facts in an objective way. They seek solutions to current problems from their past experience and that of others.

ISTJs are likely to be most satisfied working in an environment that values organization and accuracy. People can count on them to notice what needs to be done and follow through in a careful, methodical, and timely manner.

Does This Type Fit You?

Note the parts of the previous description that fit you and any that don't. Your Step II results on the next pages may help clarify any areas that don't describe you well. If the Step I type you reported doesn't fit, your Step II results may help suggest a different type that is more accurate for you.

PROBABILITY INDEX FOR EACH OF YOUR MBTI® PREFERENCES



The graph shows how likely it is that your reported preferences really do fit you, indicated by the probability index shown for each of your preferences. The closer the blue marker is to a preference, the greater the probability that the preference describes you well. The probability index does not measure how much of a preference you have or how well you use that preference. It simply shows how likely it is that the preference you reported is accurate for you.



INTERPRETIVE REPORT

MYERS-BRIGGS TYPE INDICATOR® | GLOBAL STEP II™

JANE SAMPLE

ISTJ | 4

STEP II™ FACETS



Extraversion

Initiating
Expressive
Gregarious
Active
Enthusiastic



Introversion

Receiving
Contained
Intimate
Reflective
Quiet



Sensing

Concrete
Realistic
Practical
Experiential
Traditional



Intuition

Abstract
Imaginative
Conceptual
Theoretical
Original



Thinking

Logical
Reasonable
Questioning
Critical
Tough



Feeling

Empathetic
Compassionate
Accommodating
Accepting
Tender



Judging

Systematic
Planful
Early Starting
Scheduled
Methodical



Perceiving

Casual
Open-Ended
Pressure-Prompted
Spontaneous
Emergent

Your Step II™ Facet Results

The MBTI Step II assessment indicates some of the complexity of your personality by showing your results on five different parts, called facets, for each of the Step I preference pairs, as shown on the left. Knowing your results on these 20 facets can help you better understand your unique way of experiencing and expressing your type.

Facts About the Facets

- The five facets within a preference do not cover or explain the full meaning of the preference.
- Each facet has a theme, such as "Ways to connect with others."
- Each facet has two opposite poles (e.g., Initiating and Receiving).
- The facets are scored differently than are the preferences, so your five facet scores don't add up to your Step I preference score.

How to Read Your Step II™ Results

The next few pages show graphs of your facet results. Each graph includes

- Brief descriptions of two opposite MBTI Step I preferences.
- The names of the five facet poles associated with each Step I preference and three descriptive words or phrases for each pole.
- Five vertical markers, one per facet.
 - A vertical marker on a blue background that shows a score of 2–5 is an *in-preference* result, meaning you favor the facet pole on the same side as your Step I preference. On the first facet, for example, if you prefer Extraversion, you are likely to favor the Initiating pole, and if you prefer Introversion, you are likely to favor the Receiving pole.
 - A vertical marker on a dark green background that shows a score of 2–5 is an *out-of-preference* result, meaning you favor the facet pole that is opposite to your Step I preference.
 - A vertical marker on a light green background that shows a score of 0 or 1 is a *midzone* result, meaning you show no clear preference for either facet pole.

Below each graph is a chart describing your facet results. The left column lists the facet theme (e.g., "Ways to connect with others"), your facet result, and its category (in-preference, out-of-preference, or midzone). The middle and right columns list ways people with your facet results are typically described. If a set of statements in the chart doesn't seem to fit, perhaps you would be better described by the opposite pole or the midzone.



INTERPRETIVE REPORT

MYERS-BRIGGS TYPE INDICATOR® | GLOBAL STEP II™

JANE SAMPLE

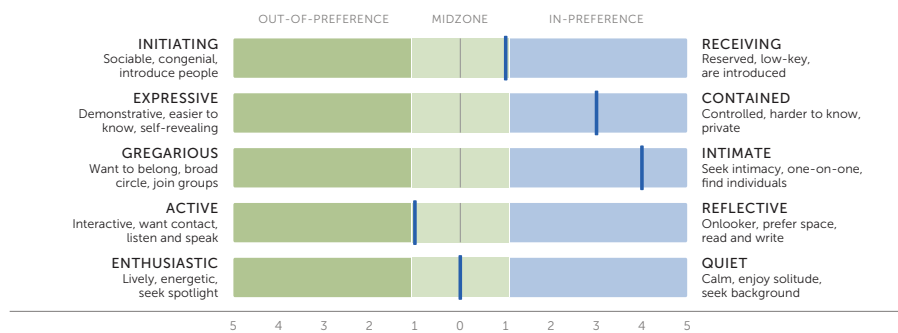
ISTJ | 5

EXTRAVERSION

Directing energy toward the outer world
of people, objects, and activities

INTROVERSION

Directing energy toward the inner world
ideas, memories, and experiences



Ways to connect with others INITIATING–RECEIVING midzone	Are at ease socially in familiar situations, much less so in large social gatherings. Find that your comfort with introductions increases with practice. Are somewhat uncomfortable interacting with strangers.	Will initiate conversations in social situations with people you already know or if your role calls for this. Are willing to introduce people to each other if no one else does so, but would prefer not to.
Communicating feelings, thoughts, interests CONTAINED in-preference	Keep your feelings and interests to yourself; when you do open up, others take notice. Assume others are uninterested in your inner thoughts and feelings, which may be too difficult to describe anyway. After you've come to your own conclusion, may ask for others' input in case you've missed something.	Are seen by others as quiet and hard to get to know. Feel capable of solving problems on your own and prefer doing so. Find it very hard to find the words to communicate what is upsetting you, especially when you are quite distressed.
Breadth and depth of relationships INTIMATE in-preference	Would rather relate to a few significant others than be in a large group. Draw sharp distinctions between friends and acquaintances. Seek in-depth involvement with individuals.	Need to trust people before sharing much about yourself. Form friendships mostly with people who are similar to you. Unlikely to take the lead in group situations and have little desire to do so.
Ways to communicate, socialize, learn ACTIVE–REFLECTIVE midzone	Talk in person about personal information and communicate technical information in writing. Prefer to learn new subject matter through face-to-face contact.	Can be at ease actively participating in events or quietly observing them. If familiar with the subject, prefer to learn more by reading about it. Need a little extra time to become comfortable with new techniques and procedures.
Level and kind of energy ENTHUSIASTIC–QUIET midzone	Will show enthusiasm when you know the people or the topic well; otherwise, you stay in the background. Find that the amount of your enthusiasm depends on the amount of interest you have in the topic.	Realize that your desire for quiet or action depends on how full or quiet your day has been. Are seen quite differently by the people who regularly see your quiet side and the people who regularly see your enthusiastic side.

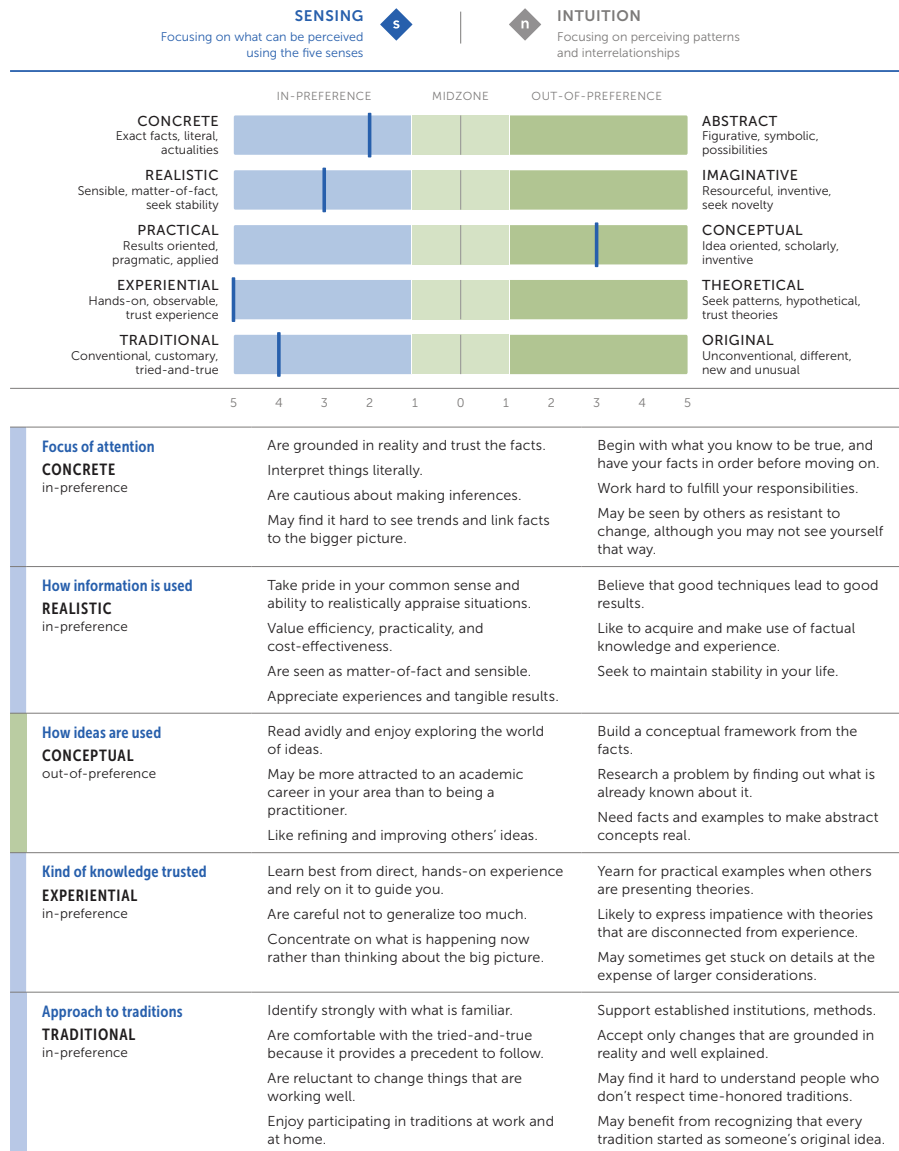


INTERPRETIVE REPORT

MYERS-BRIGGS TYPE INDICATOR® | GLOBAL STEP II®

JANE SAMPLE

ISTJ | 6



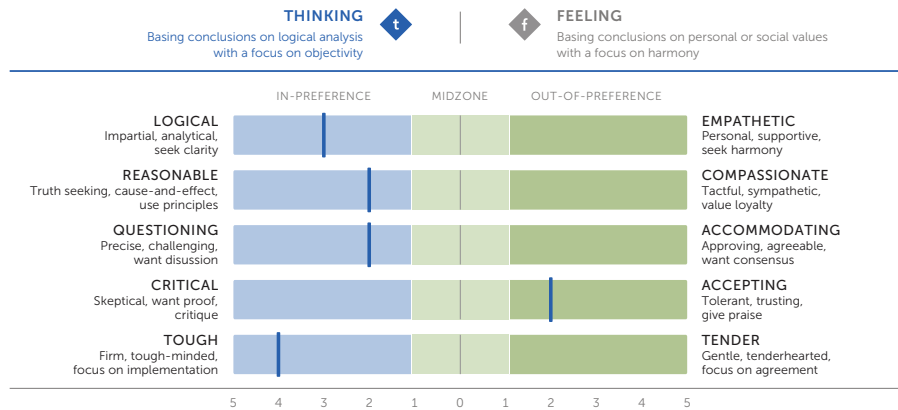


INTERPRETIVE REPORT

MYERS-BRIGGS TYPE INDICATOR® | GLOBAL STEP II®

JANE SAMPLE

ISTJ | 7



Criteria for decisions LOGICAL in-preference	Believe that logical analysis is best for decision making. Use sequential reasoning, with premises and criteria, to reach consistent conclusions. Use hard data to make your decisions, often minimizing the impact on people.	Focus on cause and effect. Strive to maintain clear boundaries between issues. Can easily identify the pros and cons of an issue.
Impact of decisions REASONABLE in-preference	Are confident and clear about your objectives. Live your life logically, with premises leading to conclusions. Use reasoning to explain your decisions in a logical, linear way.	Believe that consistency, impartiality, and fairness will lead to the best outcome. Likely to be firm and outspoken when communicating your decisions.
Ways to handle differences QUESTIONING in-preference	Use questions to clarify ideas and identify relevant facts. Are precise in your questions, liking to zero in on discrepancies. Are tenacious in getting the answers you need.	Are intellectually independent. May need to have all your questions answered before you can trust any conclusions. Feel questioning is appropriate, even if something is already right.
Communicating about disagreements ACCEPTING out-of-preference	Welcome a variety of ideas and approaches. Appear to accept all ideas equally, regardless of who proposes them, not imposing your thoughts on others. Solicit others' opinions before deciding.	Are modest about your own work and may be reluctant to promote it over others' ideas. Are seen as open and fair, though some people may be confused about what you really think.
How to carry out decisions TOUGH in-preference	Use intellectual and interpersonal pressure when following through on decisions, which some may see as pushy and aggressive. Focus firmly on reaching your objective. Are results oriented and comfortable focusing on the bottom line.	Pay little attention to acknowledging people's emotions so may be seen as cold and unfeeling. Once a decision has been made, believe it is unnecessary to look at more alternatives.



INTERPRETIVE REPORT

MYERS-BRIGGS TYPE INDICATOR® | GLOBAL STEP II®

JANE SAMPLE

ISTJ | 8

JUDGING

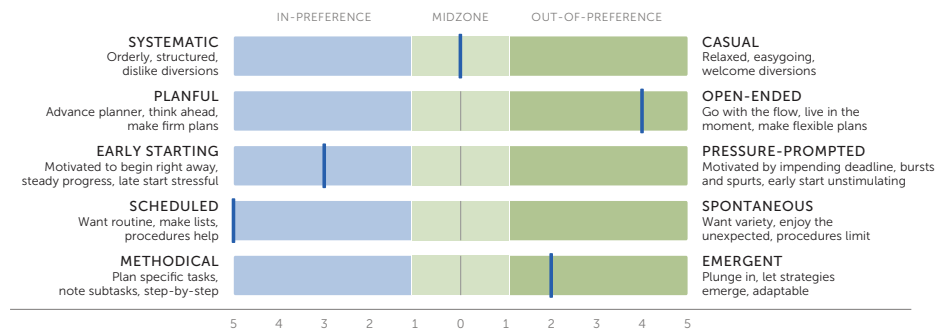


Preferring decisiveness and closure



PERCEIVING

Preferring flexibility and spontaneity



General organizational style SYSTEMATIC-CASUAL midzone	Like a general plan with some contingencies. Find too much detail in a plan inhibiting. Don't mind interruptions if no agenda is in place. Dislike distractions when involved in a project.	Find that an advance plan permits comfortable deviation because you can always return to the plan. Likely to be successful in balancing your work and home life.
Approach to planning OPEN-ENDED out-of-preference	Are reluctant to be locked into a long-range plan, especially in your leisure activities. Try to avoid too much structure and advance social commitments.	Have a sense of adventure about the unexpected. Like to take advantage of chance events. May especially enjoy leisure activities that are best done in the moment.
Ways to manage time pressures EARLY STARTING in-preference	Prefer to have plenty of time to complete a task. Dislike feeling overwhelmed with too much to do. Try to arrange your world so you don't have to deal with last-minute rushes.	Work on multiple tasks by starting ahead of time and working on each task for short, concentrated periods of time. Can't forget incomplete tasks; feel relieved and satisfied when you complete something. Especially like finishing a task in advance of a deadline.
Use of schedules and routines SCHEDULED in-preference	Are comfortable with routines and don't like them upset. Like established methods and procedures. Fall into routines naturally. Prefer to control how you spend your time.	Enjoy scheduling both work and fun activities. Find that others may be more aware of your routines than you are. Appear rather predictable but like it that way.
Approach to completing large tasks EMERGENT out-of-preference	Focus on the overall goal rather than specifics. Wait to see what's right at the time and move forward with seeming confidence.	Communicate your thinking in an organized manner so people assume you prepared thoroughly. Will know what to do when the time arrives.



INTERPRETIVE REPORT

MYERS-BRIGGS TYPE INDICATOR® | GLOBAL STEP II™

JANE SAMPLE

ISTJ | 9

Applying Step II™ Results to Communicating

All aspects of your type influence how you communicate, especially as part of a team. Eleven of the facets are particularly relevant to communication. Your preferences for these facets along with tips for better communication appear below.

In addition to the tips in the table, keep in mind that communication for every type includes

- Telling others what kind of information you need.
- Asking others what they need.
- Monitoring your impatience when other styles dominate.
- Realizing that others likely are not trying to annoy you when they use their own communication styles.

YOUR FACET RESULT	COMMUNICATION STYLE	ENHANCING YOUR STYLE
Initiating–Receiving midzone	Are willing to introduce people to one another if no one else is doing so.	Be sensitive to the situation in deciding whether to make those introductions or not.
Contained	Keep your thoughts and emotional reactions to yourself.	Recognize when it's really important to let others know what you think or feel and then speak accordingly.
Intimate	Share what you know only with selected people.	Recognize that broadening your circle and letting others know your thoughts might help both you and others.
Active–Reflective midzone	Are comfortable interacting in person or quietly observing, depending on the circumstances.	Pay attention to the preferred style of those with whom you're interacting and try to match that style.
Enthusiastic–Quiet midzone	Show your enthusiasm or not, depending on your interest in the topic.	Recognize the circumstances when it's important to show enthusiasm or to keep quiet.
Concrete	Talk about the here-and-now detail.	Be open to the inferences that can arise from the details.
Logical	Present your conclusions in a straightforward, linear, structured manner.	Invite others to tell you alternative ways to look at the issue and take what they suggest seriously.
Questioning	Want to ask questions.	Be selective in choosing questions to ask so as not to intimidate people.
Accepting	Take a naturally inclusive stance toward a broad range of views.	Be aware that others may be frustrated by your refusal to favor one view over the others.
Tough	Embody the phrase, "Let's get on with it!"	Be aware that sometimes your way of moving ahead may be wrong for the situation.
Emergent	When working on a shared task, may neglect to let others know what you will work on next.	Try to communicate what you are doing to those who need more pieces and steps of the task up front.



INTERPRETIVE REPORT

MYERS-BRIGGS TYPE INDICATOR® | GLOBAL STEP II™

JANE SAMPLE

ISTJ | 10

Applying Step II™ Results to Managing Conflict

Conflicts are inevitable when working with others. People may differ in what they define as conflict, how they react to it, and how they reach resolution. Although sometimes unpleasant, conflicts often lead to improved work situations and enhanced relationships.

Part of conflict management for every type includes

- Taking care of getting the work done while maintaining your relationships with the people involved.
- Recognizing that all perspectives have something to add, but any perspective used exclusively will ultimately impede conflict resolution.

The table below explains how your results on eight Step II facets may affect your efforts to manage conflict.

YOUR FACET RESULT	CONFLICT MANAGEMENT STYLE	ENHANCING YOUR STYLE
Contained	Attempt to solve the issue yourself and keep your reactions inside.	Be aware that trying to solve this on your own may be successful but others may also really need your input.
Intimate	Rely on yourself or a few trusted others in resolving the conflict.	Widen your circle to include others affected; they may have something valuable to contribute.
Enthusiastic–Quiet <i>midzone</i>	Get overly excited or overly dismissive, depending on how much energy you have at the time.	Take a step back and consider if you have the energy to deal with the conflict immediately or need time to reenergize and then face it.
Reasonable	May spend too much time arguing that your solution is right, even though it may ignore the impact on people.	Stop, listen to others, and accept that a solution other than yours may be best.
Questioning	Ask many questions of others to reveal all the issues in the conflict.	Be aware that people may take your questions as challenging rather than helpful in resolving the issue; be clear about your intent.
Accepting	Look for points of agreement in others' arguments and ideas.	Recognize that some things are really worthy of criticism, so don't insist on agreement.
Tough	Push onto others your own convictions on how to resolve the conflict.	Recognize that your "take it or leave it" stance will further alienate people; force yourself to consider other viewpoints.
Early Starting	Believe some conflicts can be avoided by starting work on projects early.	Make allowances for people for whom starting early isn't comfortable or effective.



INTERPRETIVE REPORT

MYERS-BRIGGS TYPE INDICATOR® | GLOBAL STEP II™

JANE SAMPLE

ISTJ | 11

Applying Step II™ Results to Dealing with Change

Change seems to be inevitable and affects people in different ways. To help you deal with change,

- Be clear about what is changing and what is remaining the same.
- Identify what you need to know to understand the change and then seek out that information.

To help others deal with change,

- Encourage open discussion about the change; be aware that this is easier for some than others.
- Make sure that both logical reasons and personal or social values have been considered.

Your personality type also influences your style of managing change, particularly your results on the ten facets below.

Review the facets and tips for enhancing your response to change.

YOUR FACET RESULT	CHANGE MANAGEMENT STYLE	ENHANCING YOUR STYLE
Contained	Keep your feelings about the change to yourself and figure out how to handle it on your own.	As soon as you know your own views, first talk to someone you trust and get his or her input, and then contribute your key points to the larger group.
Intimate	Discuss the changes and their impact on you only with those closest to you.	Consider sharing your views with selected people outside your intimate circle.
Concrete	May get stuck on some aspects of change and ignore others.	Ask someone you respect to help you move from the facts and details to reasonable possibilities.
Realistic	Focus on the commonsense aspects of the change.	Realize that commonsense outcomes may not be immediately apparent.
Experiential	Want to see an example of how the change will work.	Accept that the impact of some changes can't be demonstrated in advance.
Traditional	Hope that many of the established ways of doing things will continue.	Accept that some changes are necessary and may promote continuity in the long run.
Tough	Will actively embrace or resist change, depending on whether you agree with it.	Step back and consider whether your stance will really get you what you want in the long run.
Systematic-Casual midzone	Anticipate some of the possible problems but also the positives that may outweigh them.	Help both sides recognize and respect the opposite perspectives.
Open-Ended	May not know until the moment which way you want to proceed.	Be aware that others may be uneasy with your approach; include at least a little advance planning whenever you can.
Emergent	Decide in the moment what's best to do next; resist planning.	Remember—planning some steps now may prevent problems in the future.



INTERPRETIVE REPORT

MYERS-BRIGGS TYPE INDICATOR® | GLOBAL STEP II™

JANE SAMPLE

ISTJ | 12

Applying Step II™ Results to Making Decisions

Effective decision making requires using all four Step I processes in a specific order: Sensing first to get the facts, Intuition next to identify possibilities, Thinking third to consider logical consequences, Feeling last to know what's important. The Step II facets give us specific ways to access these processes. Below are general questions associated with the relevant facets. The facet poles you prefer are in blue italic and thus are the ones you are more likely to consider. If you are in the midzone, neither pole is highlighted.

SENSING 	INTUITION 
Concrete: <i>What do we know? How do we know it?</i>	Abstract: What else could this mean?
Realistic: <i>What are the real costs?</i>	Imaginative: What else can we come up with?
Practical: Will it work?	Conceptual: <i>Are there other interesting ideas?</i>
Experiential: <i>Can you show me how it works?</i>	Theoretical: How is it all interconnected?
Traditional: <i>Does anything really need changing?</i>	Original: What's a different way to do this?
THINKING 	FEELING 
Logical: <i>What are the pros and cons?</i>	Empathetic: What's really important?
Reasonable: <i>What are the logical consequences?</i>	Compassionate: What impact will this have on people?
Questioning: <i>But what about . . . ?</i>	Accommodating: How can we get more people to agree?
Critical: What is wrong with this?	Accepting: <i>What's right with this?</i>
Tough: <i>Why aren't we following through now?</i>	Tender: What about the people who will be hurt?

Six different ways of evaluating information, called decision-making styles, have been identified based on two facets of the Thinking–Feeling preference pair: Logical–Empathetic and Reasonable–Compassionate.

Your style is **Logical and Reasonable**. This style means that you likely

- Trust your Thinking preference and readily make decisions based on logical analysis of data.
- Recognize the impact of your decisions on people and relationships but see that as secondary.
- Focus on accuracy to achieve a good decision.
- Are seen as precise, objective, and confident.
- Are sometimes seen as inflexible.
- See conflicts as “win-lose” situations and become competitive.

TIPS

In individual problem solving, start by asking *all* the questions (in S–N–T–F order) in the chart above.

- Pay careful attention to the answers. The questions that are not in blue italic may be key since they represent perspectives you are less likely to consider.
- Asking the questions associated with the less preferred parts of your personality may help to balance your decision-making style.

In group problem-solving, actively seek out people with different views. Ask for their concerns and perspectives.

- Do a final check to make sure that all the questions above have been asked and that different decision-making styles are included.
- If you are missing a perspective, make extra efforts to consider what it might add.



INTERPRETIVE REPORT

MYERS-BRIGGS TYPE INDICATOR® | GLOBAL STEP II™

JANE SAMPLE

ISTJ | 13

How the Parts of Your Personality Work Together

The way people take in information (Sensing or Intuition) and make decisions (Thinking or Feeling) is at the core of personality type. The middle letters of your ISTJ type, Sensing (S) and Thinking (T), show your favorite ways of doing these two things.

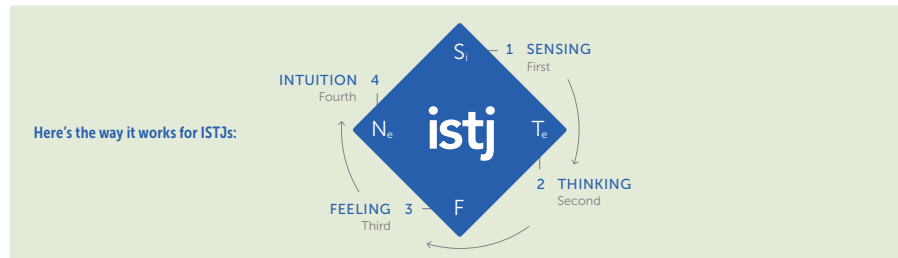
The first letter of your type, E or I, shows *where* you like to use your favorite processes—in the outer, extraverted world of people and things (e) or the inner, introverted world of ideas and impressions (i). Extraverts like to use their favorite (first) process mostly in the outer (e) world and for balance use their second process in their inner (i) world. Introverts use their favorite (first) process in their inner (i) world and for balance use their second process in their outer (e) world.

The Favorite Processes of an ISTJ

- Sensing (S) is your favorite process and is used mostly in the introverted (i) world to consider the facts and details you have stored in your head. This is shown in the graphic as S_i .
- Thinking (T) is your second process. To provide balance, it is used mostly in the extraverted (e) world to communicate your structured, logical decisions to others, shown in the graphic as T_e .

Your Less Favored Processes

Your fourth, least favored process, Intuition (N), is opposite to your favorite, Sensing, process and is used mostly in the opposite, extraverted (e) world, shown in the graphic as N_e . Your third process, Feeling (F), is used in either world, so no "e" or "i" is attached to it in the graphic. Particular situations may require you to use these less preferred processes, but doing so may make you feel awkward, tired, and frustrated.



Stress and Your Processes

Each type tends to experience and react to stress in predictable ways. As an ISTJ, you may first exaggerate your favorite process, Sensing, by becoming overly focused on details. Then as your stress continues or increases, negative versions of your least favored process, Intuition, may take over, so you worry a lot about unlikely, awful outcomes.

To bring back some balance and return to being yourself, try the following:

- Stop what you are doing and take a break from the activity or situation that is stressful.
- Try to recall past experiences that helped bring you back in balance.
- Consider what's important to you and others and look for a logical path forward.



INTERPRETIVE REPORT

MYERS-BRIGGS TYPE INDICATOR® | GLOBAL STEP II®

JANE SAMPLE

ISTJ | 14

Using Your Type Effectively

ISTJs' preference for Sensing and Thinking makes them mostly interested in

- Acquiring and using facts and experiences.
- Reaching logical conclusions about them.

They typically devote little energy to the less-preferred parts of their personality, Intuition and Feeling. These parts may remain inexperienced and be less available for use in situations where they might be helpful.

As an ISTJ,

- If you rely too much on your Sensing, you are likely to miss the big picture, other meanings of the information, and new possibilities.
- If you make judgments exclusively using Thinking, you may neglect to compliment people when you should and fail to notice the impact of your decisions on others.

Your personality type is likely to develop in a natural way over your lifetime. As you get older, you may become interested in using the less familiar parts of your personality. In midlife or later, you may find yourself devoting more time to things that were not very appealing when you were younger. For example, you may find greater pleasure in considering new ways of doing things and in personal relationships.

How the Facets Can Help You Be More Effective

Sometimes a particular situation calls for using a less preferred part of your personality. Your facet results can make it easier for you to temporarily adopt a less natural approach. Begin by identifying which facets are relevant and which poles are more appropriate to use.

- If you are *out-of-preference* on one or more of the relevant facets, make sure to focus on using approaches and behaviors related to those out-of-preference facets.
- If you are in the *midzone*, decide which pole is more appropriate for the situation at hand and make sure you use approaches and behaviors related to that pole.
- If you are *in-preference*, ask someone at the opposite facet pole for help in using that approach or read a description of that pole to get clues for modifying your behavior. Once you have a good approach, resist shifting back into your comfort zone.

Here are two examples of how to apply these suggestions.

- If you are in a situation where your natural way of taking in information (Sensing) may not be appropriate, try to modify your Concrete approach (an in-preference result) by considering the meanings and implications of your factual information (Abstract).
- If you are in a situation where you might need to adapt your way of getting things done (Judging), try to modify your Scheduled approach to accomplishing tasks (an in-preference result) by asking yourself if staying open to unexpected events (Spontaneous) might lead to better results in this particular situation.



INTERPRETIVE REPORT

MYERS-BRIGGS TYPE INDICATOR® | GLOBAL STEP II™

JANE SAMPLE

ISTJ | 15

YOUR STEP II™ INDIVIDUALIZED TYPE

Conceptual
Accepting
Open-Ended
Emergent

istj

Integrating Step I™ and Step II™ Information

Your Step II individualized type combines your four-letter Step I type and your Step II facet results as shown on the left. If you have one or more facet poles that are out-of-preference, their names will appear before your four-letter type. If you have no facets that are out-of-preference, you will be described as an "in-preference" type. Midzone results are not included in your individualized type name; however, they are helpful in identifying ways in which you are unique for your four-letter type.

If, after reading all the information in this report, you don't think you have been accurately described, perhaps a different four-letter type or some variation on the facets will fit you better.

To help you figure out your type,

- Focus on any type letters you thought were incorrect or any preference pairs on which you had some out-of-preference or midzone facet results.
- Read the type description for the type you would be if the letter or letters you question were the opposite preference.
- Consult your MBTI interpreter for suggestions.
- Observe yourself and ask others how they see you.

Using Type to Gain Understanding

Knowledge of type can enrich your life in several ways. It can help you

- *Better understand yourself.* Knowing your own type helps you understand the needs and challenges of your typical reactions.
- *Understand others.* Knowing about type helps you recognize that other people may be different. It can enable you to see those differences as useful and broadening, rather than annoying and restricting.
- *Gain perspective.* Seeing yourself and others in the context of type can help you appreciate the validity of other points of view. You can then avoid getting stuck in believing your way is the only way. No perspective is always right or always wrong.

Reading about type and observing yourself and others from the standpoint of type will enhance your understanding of personality differences and encourage constructive use of those differences.



INTERPRETIVE REPORT

MYERS-BRIGGS TYPE INDICATOR® | GLOBAL STEP II™

JANE SAMPLE

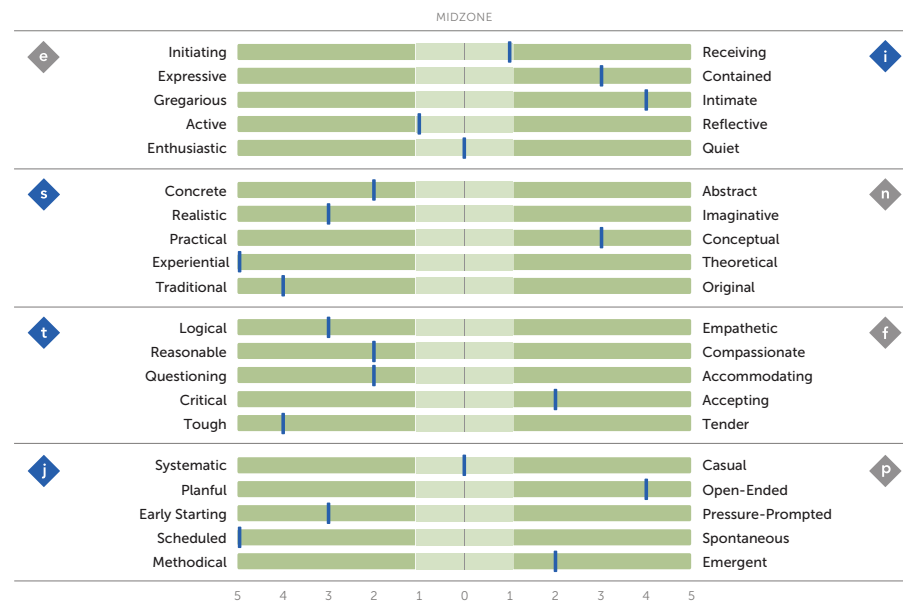
ISTJ | 16

Overview of Your Results

Your Four-Letter Type from the Step I™ Assessment: ISTJ

ISTJs tend to be serious, quiet, thorough, and dependable. They see to it that everything is well organized and accurate. They are practical, orderly, matter-of-fact, logical, and realistic. ISTJs take responsibility, notice what needs to be done, and follow through steadily, regardless of protests or distractions.

YOUR RESULTS ON THE 20 FACETS FROM THE STEP II™ ASSESSMENT



YOUR STEP II™ INDIVIDUALIZED TYPE

Conceptual, Accepting, Open-Ended, Emergent
ISTJ



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INTERPRETIVE REPORT

MYERS-BRIGGS TYPE INDICATOR® | GLOBAL STEP II®

JANE SAMPLE

ISTJ

Interpreter's Summary Based on Reported Type

REPORTED TYPE: ISTJ

PROBABILITY FOR EACH REPORTED PREFERENCE

Introversion: Very Likely (99)

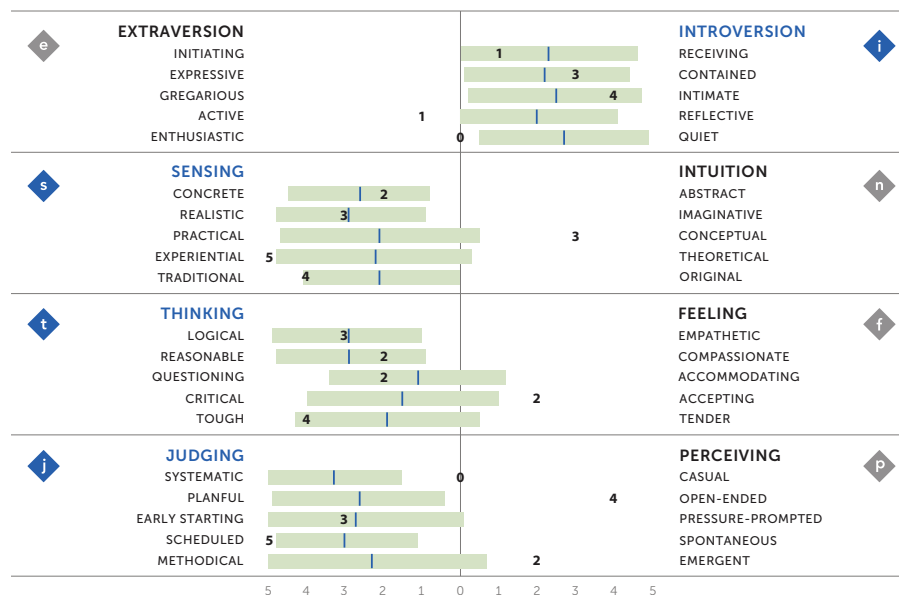
Sensing: Likely (84)

Thinking: Somewhat Likely (51)

Judging: Likely (66)

FACET SCORES AND THE AVERAGE RANGE OF SCORES FOR OTHER ISTJs

The bars on the graph below show the average range of scores that occurred for the ISTJs in the global sample. The bars show scores that are 1 standard deviation above and below the mean. The vertical line in each bar shows ISTJs' mean score. The bold numbers show the respondent's scores.



Polarity Index: 60

The polarity index, which ranges from 0 to 100, shows the consistency of a respondent's facet scores within a profile. Most adults score between 50 and 65, although higher indexes are common. An index that is below 45 means that the respondent has many scores in or near the midzone. This may be due to mature situational use of the facet, answering the questions randomly, lack of self-knowledge, or ambivalence about use of a facet. Some such profiles may be invalid.

Number of Omitted Responses: 4



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Activities and Case Studies

- Exploring a Team's MBTI® Type Table
- Interpretation Activity: Observer's Worksheet, two copies
- MBTI® Step II™ Team Activity
- MBTI® Step II™ Case Studies

Exploring a Team's MBTI® Type Table

An MBTI® type table is a basic tool for working with teams to help identify likely strengths and potential blind spots. In this group activity, you will use the type table for your certification program "team" to develop some hypotheses based on the team's type distribution.

Directions

Using the team type table for this certification program, work with the other members of your group to answer the following questions.

1. How might the type distribution presented in the table affect team interactions?

2. What are this team's strengths likely to be? Its challenges?

3. How might the leader's type affect the team?

Things to keep in mind as you explore a team's type table.

1. Note the distributions:

By preferences E-I, S-N, T-F, J-P

By columns ST, SF, NF, NT

By rows IJ, IP, EP, EJ

2. Where is the team balanced (evenly split)? How might this affect team interactions? Performance?

3. Where is the team imbalanced? How might this affect team interactions? Performance?

4. What is the team leader's type? How might this affect the team?

Interpretation Activity: Observer's Worksheet

Feedback for	From
Professional	Observer
Start time	End time

The professional . . .

- ☐ Establishes rapport with the client
- ☐ Sets the purpose of the session
- ☐ Clarifies confidentiality
- ☐ Provides supporting materials, such as the *Introduction to Myers-Briggs® Type* booklet
- ☐ Briefly explains the background of the theory and assessment
- ☐ States that everyone can use all eight preferences, but that everyone has a preference on each pair of opposites
- ☐ States that there are no right or wrong types or preferences
- ☐ Explains each preference pair, using nonbiased language
- ☐ Uses appropriate language, for example, "People who prefer Thinking usually . . ." rather than "Thinkers do . . ."
- ☐ Asks client to take a guess after each explanation of a preference pair
- ☐ Actively engages client in the process by providing examples—"Can you give me an example of how you use Extraversion? When do you use Introversion?"
- ☐ Summarizes client's hypotheses ("guesses"): "So you think you prefer _____?"
- ☐ Returns client's results and leads through verifying best-fit type

Notes and suggestions:

Give to the professional following their practice interpretation.

Interpretation Activity: Observer's Worksheet

Feedback for	From
Professional	Observer
Start time	End time

The professional . . .

- ☐ Establishes rapport with the client
- ☐ Sets the purpose of the session
- ☐ Clarifies confidentiality
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- ☐ Uses appropriate language, for example, "People who prefer Thinking usually . . ." rather than "Thinkers do . . ."
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- ☐ Summarizes client's hypotheses ("guesses"): "So you think you prefer _____?"
- ☐ Returns client's results and leads through verifying best-fit type

Notes and suggestions:

Give to the professional following their practice interpretation.

MBTI® Step II™ Team Activity

Team Members

T	Thad	CEO and co-owner (red)	INTJ
C	Chris	Chief architect and co-owner (purple)	ENTP
B	Bob	VP finance (black)	ENTJ
P	Pete	VP construction (blue)	ESTP
S	Sharon	VP community liaison (orange)	ENTJ
A	Andrea	VP human resources (green)	ENFP

ISTJ	ISFJ	INFJ	INTJ Thad
ISTP	ISFP	INFP	INTP
ESTP Pete	ESFP	ENFP Andrea	ENTP Chris
ESTJ	ESFJ	ENFJ	ENTJ Bob Sharon



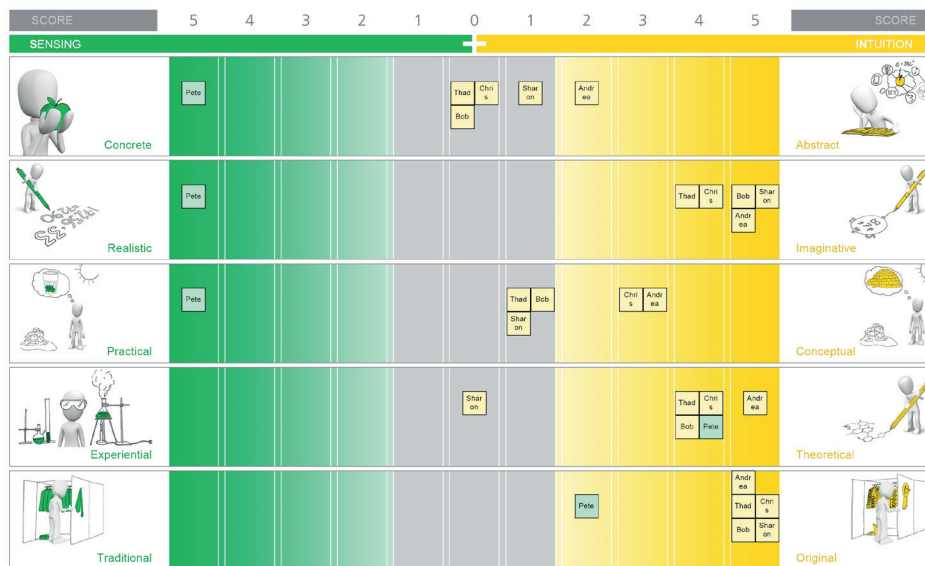
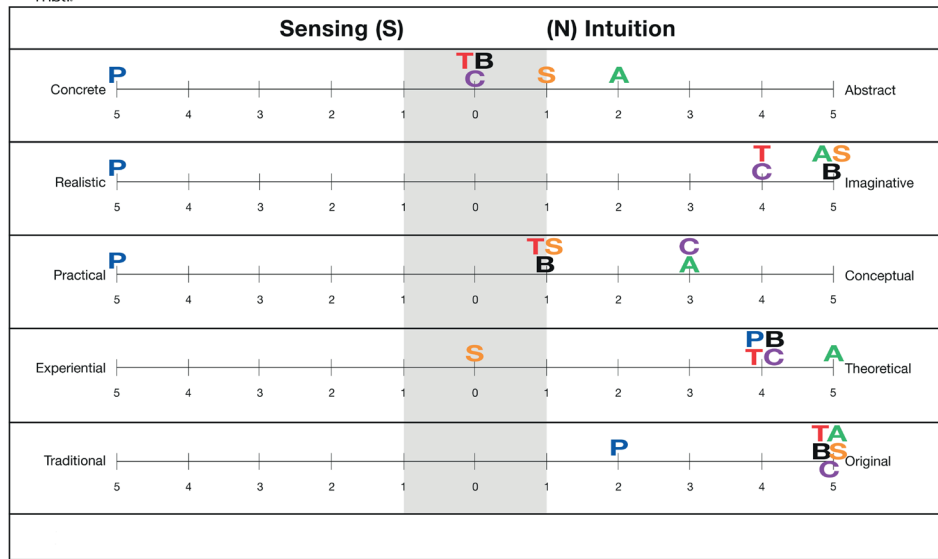
MBTI® Step II™ E-I Facets

Extraversion (E)					(I) Introversion						
Initiating	CP A		S B					T		Receiving	
	5	4	3	2	1	0	1	2	3	4	5
Expressive	CP S		A B								T Contained
	5	4	3	2	1	0	1	2	3	4	5
Gregarious	P C			S		B		T A			Intimate
	5	4	3	2	1	0	1	2	3	4	5
Active	P			B		A	T S		C		Reflective
	5	4	3	2	1	0	1	2	3	4	5
Enthusiastic	S C	B			P A						T Quiet
	5	4	3	2	1	0	1	2	3	4	5

SCORE	5	4	3	2	1	0	1	2	3	4	5	SCORE
EXTRAVERSION							INTROVERSION					
Initiating	Chris Andrea	Pete		Bob Sharon					Thad			Receiving
Expressive	Chris Sharon	Pete		Bob Andrea						Thad		Contained
Gregarious	Chris Pete			Sharon		Bob		Thad Andrea				Intimate
Active		Pete			Bob		Andrea Thad Sharon		Chris			Reflective
Enthusiastic	Sharon	Bob	Chris		Pete Andrea						Thad	Quiet



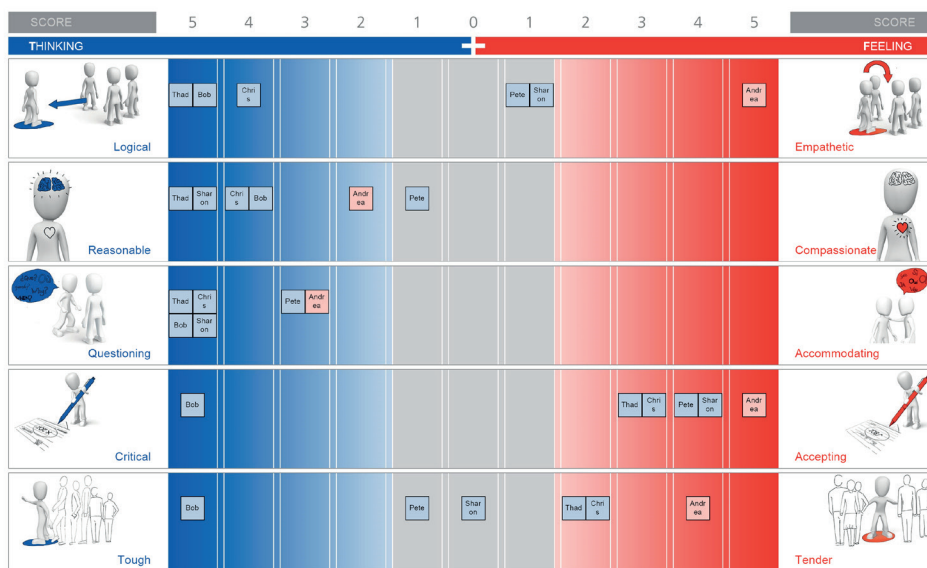
MBTI® Step II™ S-N Facets





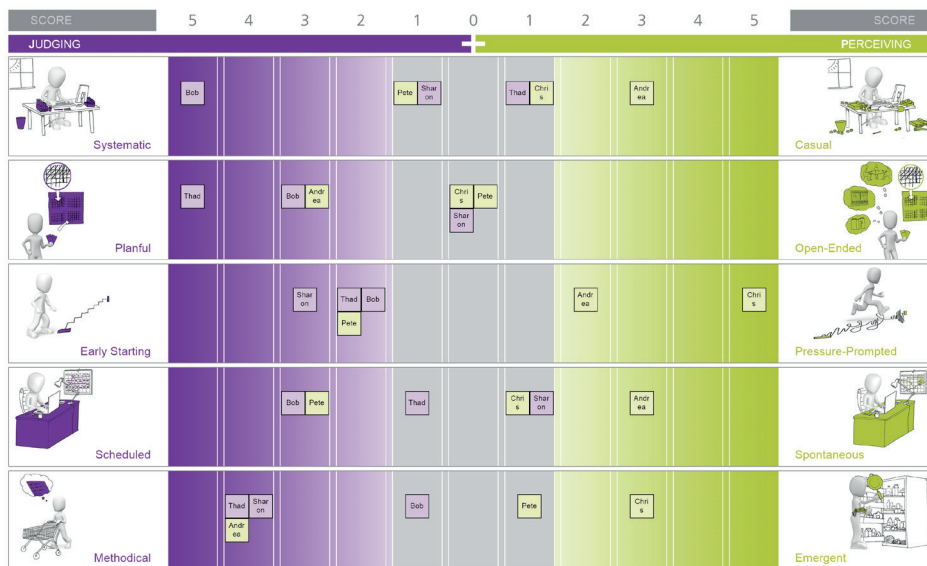
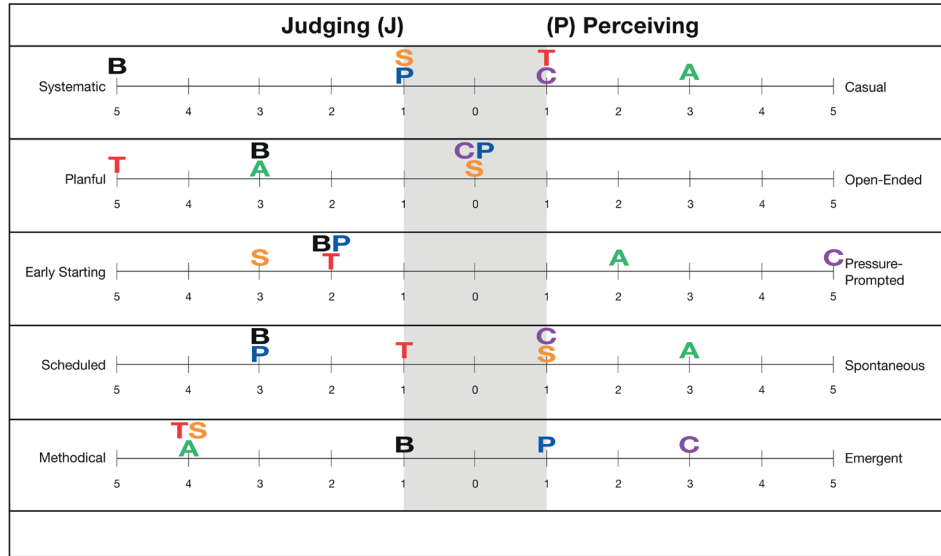
MBTI® Step II™ T-F Facets

Thinking (T)					(F) Feeling				
Logical	T B	C				P S			A Empathetic
Reasonable	T S	C B	A	P					Compassionate
Questioning	T B S		A P						Accommodating
Critical	B						T C	S P	A Accepting
Tough	B			P	S		T C	A	Tender





MBTI® Step II™ J-P Facets



MBTI® Step II™ Case Studies

Discuss the following questions using your leader's Interpreter's Summary page:

- Identify and list this leader's out-of-preference and midzone results. How will you ask your leader questions about these?
- What kinds of feedback do you think this leader may have received? Why? What facet results led you to this hypothesis?
- What questions would you ask of your leader to check your hypothesis?

Prepare to present highlights of your discussion to the group.

THE LEADERS

1. Male, 50s, director of global leadership development program for a large nonprofit organization operating in almost every country
2. Male, late 30s, medical doctor, general practitioner in a small group practice
3. Male, early 60s, president and co-owner of a regional home-building company
4. Female, mid-40s, partner in a small financial management and investment company
5. Female, mid-30s, Communications Department director in a large international technical company
6. Female, mid-40s, Staff Relations Department director in a regional government agency

LEADER 1



INTERPRETIVE REPORT

MYERS-BRIGGS TYPE INDICATOR® | GLOBAL STEP II™

Interpreter's Summary Based on Reported Type

REPORTED TYPE: ENTJ

PROBABILITY FOR EACH REPORTED PREFERENCE

Extraversion: Very Likely (99)

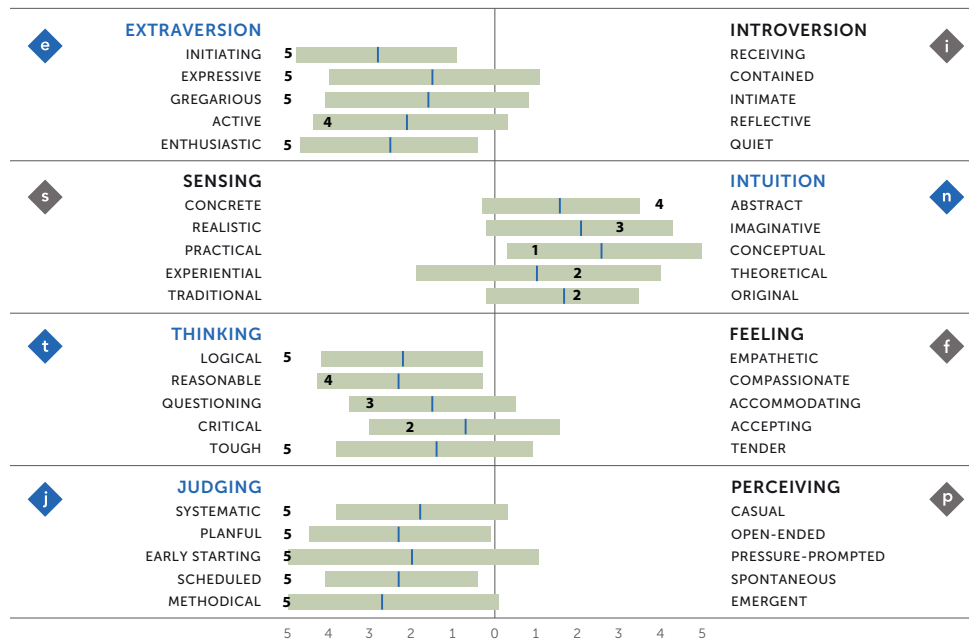
Intuition: Likely (74)

Thinking: Likely (84)

Judging: Very Likely (93)

FACET SCORES AND THE AVERAGE RANGE OF SCORES FOR OTHER ENTJs

The bars on the graph below show the average range of scores that occurred for the ENTJs in the global sample. The bars show scores that are 1 standard deviation above and below the mean. The vertical line in each bar shows the mean score for ENTJs. The bold numbers show the respondent's scores.



Polarity Index: 84

The polarity index, which ranges from 0 to 100, shows the consistency with which a respondent scores toward the poles of the 20 facets, regardless of which pole it is. Most adults score between 50 and 65, although higher indexes are common. An index below 45 means that the respondent has many scores in or near the midzone. This may be due to mature situational use, answering the questions randomly, or lack of self-knowledge. Some such profiles may be invalid.

Number of Omitted Responses: 0



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LEADER 2



INTERPRETIVE REPORT

MYERS-BRIGGS TYPE INDICATOR® | GLOBAL STEP II™

Interpreter's Summary Based on Reported Type

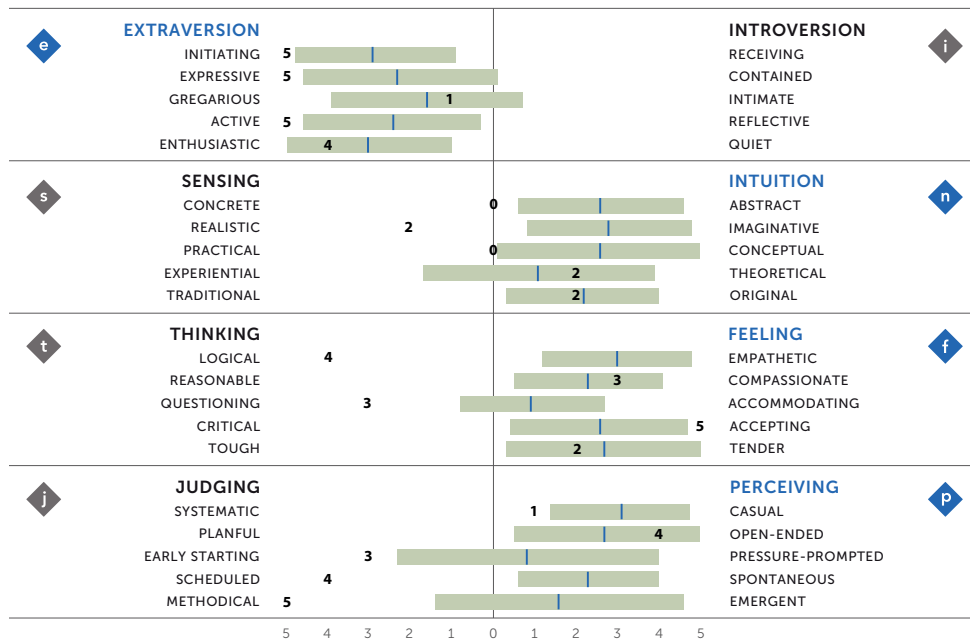
REPORTED TYPE: ENFP

PROBABILITY FOR EACH REPORTED PREFERENCE

Extraversion: Very Likely (89) Intuition: Somewhat Likely (59) Feeling: Somewhat Likely (51) Perceiving: Somewhat Likely (52)

FACET SCORES AND THE AVERAGE RANGE OF SCORES FOR OTHER ENFPs

The bars on the graph below show the average range of scores that occurred for the ENFPs in the global sample. The bars show scores that are 1 standard deviation above and below the mean. The vertical line in each bar shows the mean score for ENFPs. The bold numbers show the respondent's scores.



Polarity Index: 68

The polarity index, which ranges from 0 to 100, shows the consistency with which a respondent scores toward the poles of the 20 facets, regardless of which pole it is. Most adults score between 50 and 65, although higher indexes are common. An index below 45 means that the respondent has many scores in or near the midzone. This may be due to mature situational use, answering the questions randomly, or lack of self-knowledge. Some such profiles may be invalid.

Number of Omitted Responses: 0



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LEADER 3



INTERPRETIVE REPORT

MYERS-BRIGGS TYPE INDICATOR® | GLOBAL STEP II™

Interpreter's Summary Based on Reported Type

REPORTED TYPE: INTJ

PROBABILITY FOR EACH REPORTED PREFERENCE

Introversion: Likely (65)

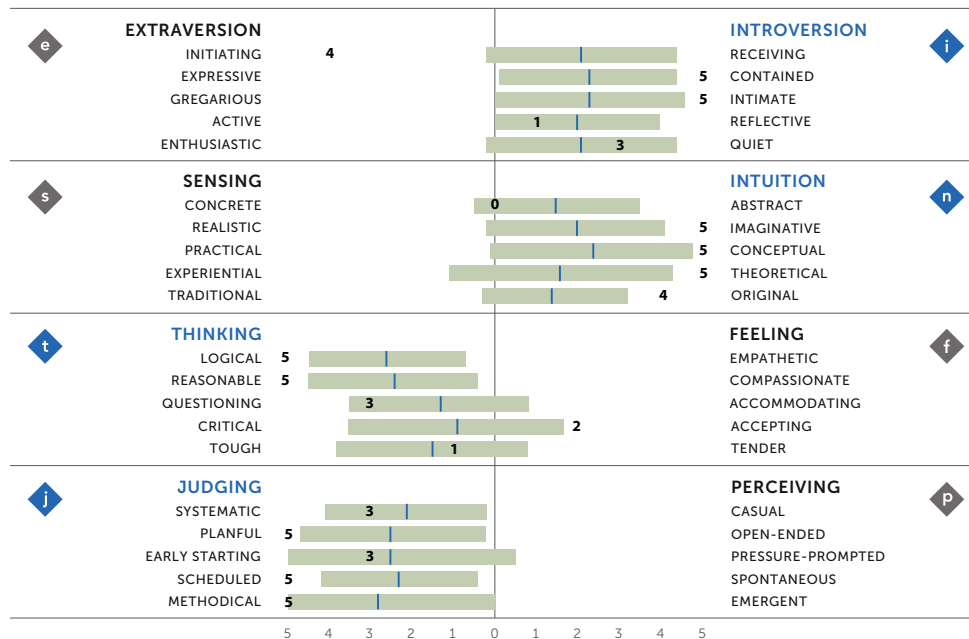
Intuition: Likely (73)

Thinking: Likely (67)

Judging: Very Likely (95)

FACET SCORES AND THE AVERAGE RANGE OF SCORES FOR OTHER INTJs

The bars on the graph below show the average range of scores that occurred for the INTJs in the global sample. The bars show scores that are 1 standard deviation above and below the mean. The vertical line in each bar shows the mean score for INTJs. The bold numbers show the respondent's scores.



Polarity Index: 80

The polarity index, which ranges from 0 to 100, shows the consistency with which a respondent scores toward the poles of the 20 facets, regardless of which pole it is. Most adults score between 50 and 65, although higher indexes are common. An index below 45 means that the respondent has many scores in or near the midzone. This may be due to mature situational use, answering the questions randomly, or lack of self-knowledge. Some such profiles may be invalid.

Number of Omitted Responses: 1



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LEADER 4



INTERPRETIVE REPORT

MYERS-BRIGGS TYPE INDICATOR® | GLOBAL STEP II®

Interpreter's Summary Based on Reported Type

REPORTED TYPE: ISTJ

PROBABILITY FOR EACH REPORTED PREFERENCE

Introversion: Likely (71)

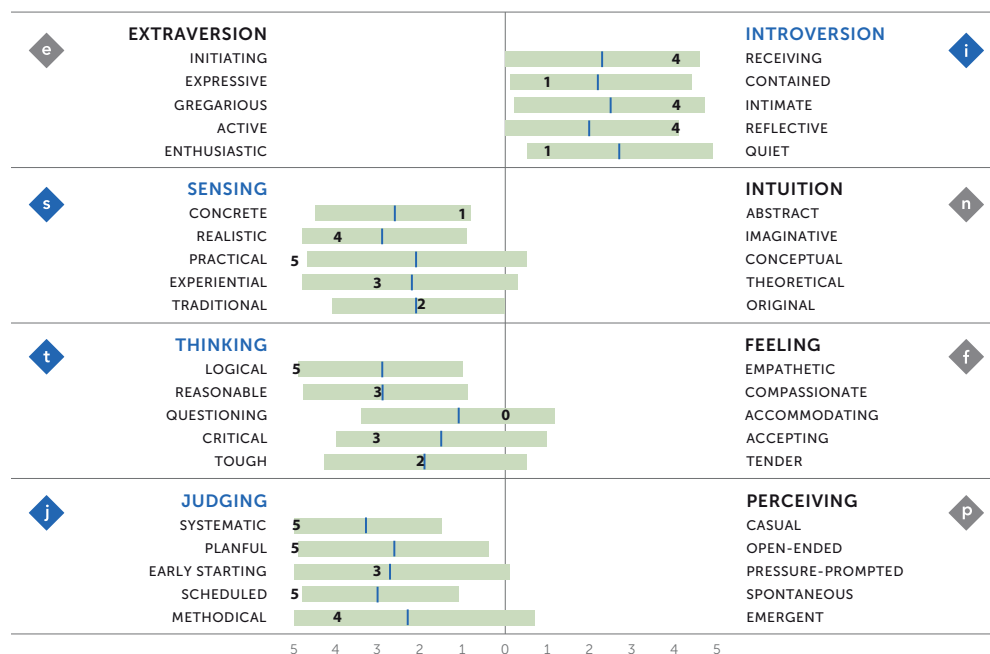
Sensing: Likely (67)

Thinking: Likely (73)

Judging: Very Likely (86)

FACET SCORES AND THE AVERAGE RANGE OF SCORES FOR OTHER ISTJs

The bars on the graph below show the average range of scores that occurred for the ISTJs in the global sample. The bars show scores that are 1 standard deviation above and below the mean. The vertical line in each bar shows ISTJs' mean score. The bold numbers show the respondent's scores.



Polarity Index: 71

The polarity index, which ranges from 0 to 100, shows the consistency of a respondent's facet scores within a profile. Most adults score between 50 and 65, although higher indexes are common. An index that is below 45 means that the respondent has many scores in or near the midzone. This may be due to mature situational use of the facet, answering the questions randomly, lack of self-knowledge, or ambivalence about use of a facet. Some such profiles may be invalid.

Number of Omitted Responses: 1

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LEADER 5



INTERPRETIVE REPORT

MYERS-BRIGGS TYPE INDICATOR® | GLOBAL STEP II™

Interpreter's Summary Based on Reported Type

REPORTED TYPE: ISTJ

PROBABILITY FOR EACH REPORTED PREFERENCE

Introversion: Somewhat Likely (54)

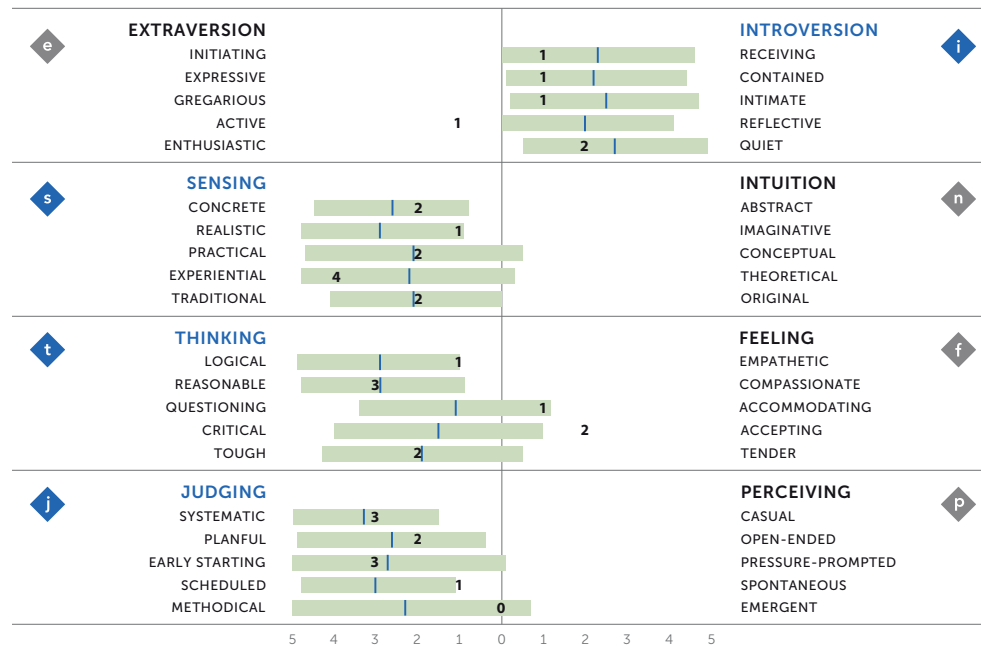
Sensing: Likely (73)

Thinking: Likely (73)

Judging: Somewhat Likely (59)

FACET SCORES AND THE AVERAGE RANGE OF SCORES FOR OTHER ISTJs

The bars on the graph below show the average range of scores that occurred for the ISTJs in the global sample. The bars show scores that are 1 standard deviation above and below the mean. The vertical line in each bar shows ISTJs' mean score. The bold numbers show the respondent's scores.



Polarity Index: 40

The polarity index, which ranges from 0 to 100, shows the consistency of a respondent's facet scores within a profile. Most adults score between 50 and 65, although higher indexes are common. An index that is below 45 means that the respondent has many scores in or near the midzone. This may be due to mature situational use of the facet, answering the questions randomly, lack of self-knowledge, or ambivalence about use of a facet. Some such profiles may be invalid.

Number of Omitted Responses: 0



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LEADER 6



INTERPRETIVE REPORT

MYERS-BRIGGS TYPE INDICATOR® | GLOBAL STEP II®

Interpreter's Summary Based on Reported Type

REPORTED TYPE: INFJ

PROBABILITY FOR EACH REPORTED PREFERENCE

Introversion: Very Likely (86)

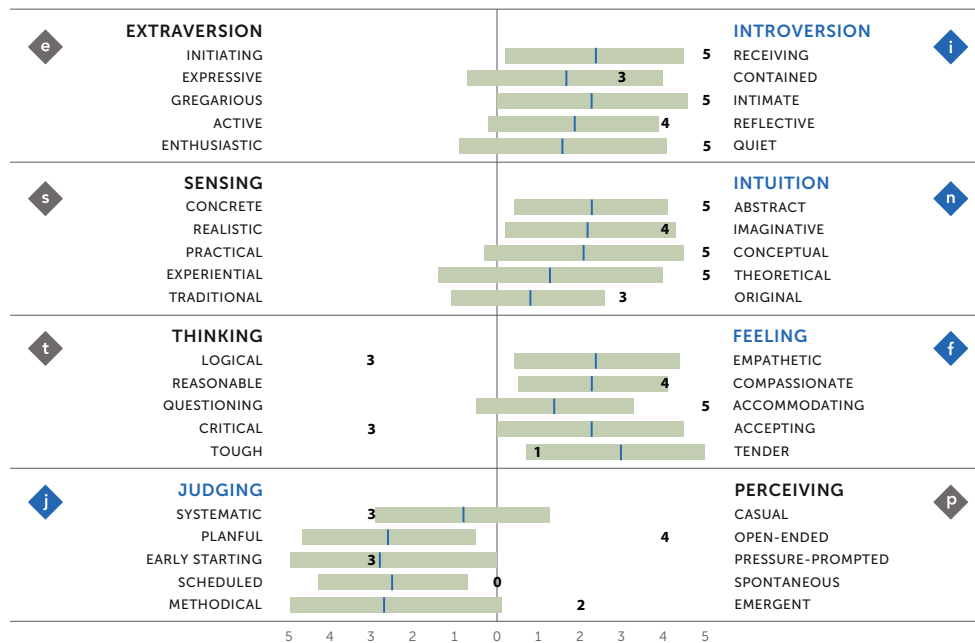
Intuition: Likely (80)

Feeling: Somewhat Likely (51)

Judging: Somewhat Likely (52)

FACET SCORES AND THE AVERAGE RANGE OF SCORES FOR OTHER INFJs

The bars on the graph below show the average range of scores that occurred for the INFJs in the global sample. The bars show scores that are 1 standard deviation above and below the mean. The vertical line in each bar shows the mean score for INFJs. The bold numbers show the respondent's scores.



Polarity Index: 77

The polarity index, which ranges from 0 to 100, shows the consistency with which a respondent scores toward the poles of the 20 facets, regardless of which pole it is. Most adults score between 50 and 65, although higher indexes are common. An index below 45 means that the respondent has many scores in or near the midzone. This may be due to mature situational use, answering the questions randomly, or lack of self-knowledge. Some such profiles may be invalid.

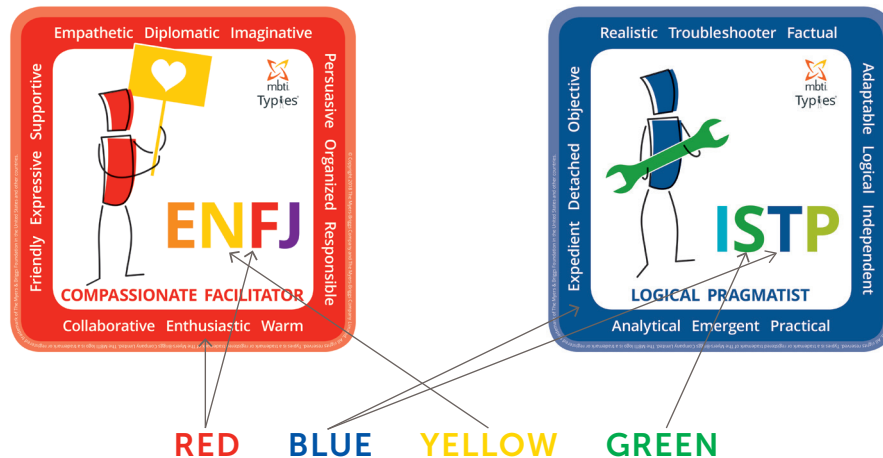
Number of Omitted Responses: 0



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Introduction to MBTI® Colors and Typies®



The Colorful World of Personality Type

A short guide to MBTI® colors and what they mean

The Myers-Briggs Company's MBTI® type resources use color to represent specific elements of personality type. Understand the colors and you'll understand type concepts more quickly—and you'll remember them better, too.

This short guide looks at the following areas to explain the MBTI colors:

- The mental processes
- Judging and Perceiving
- Extraversion and Introversion

Let's get started.

Here are the eight MBTI preferences and their colors.

E	S	T	J
I	N	F	P

To find out what they mean, we'll start with the *mental processes*—the two middle letters of a four-letter type.

The Mental Processes

The two middle letters of an individual's type (S or N and T or F) represent the *mental processes*.



- Isabel Briggs Myers and Katharine Briggs developed and expanded on Carl Jung's theory of psychological type and created the MBTI assessment. In his writings, Jung associated green, yellow, blue, and red with Sensing, Intuition, Thinking, and Feeling, respectively.

Sensing and **Intuition** are the **perceiving** processes. They are used in *perceiving*, or taking in information.

- People who prefer **Sensing (S)** like to take in information through their five senses, focusing on what is real and tangible.
- People who prefer **Intuition (N)** like to take in information by seeing the big picture, focusing on the relationships and connections between things.

Thinking and **Feeling** are the **judging** processes. They are used in *judging*, which in MBTI terms means making decisions and coming to conclusions.

- People who prefer **Thinking (T)** like to decide things based on logical analysis.
- People who prefer **Feeling (F)** like to decide things based on how people and values will be affected.

Judging and Perceiving

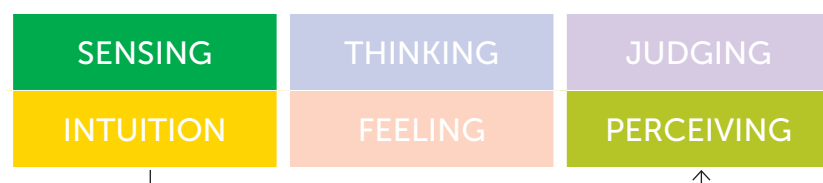
The last letter of an individual's four-letter type is J or P. It tells us which of the mental processes is extraverted by that person.



- People who prefer **Perceiving (P)** extravert their perceiving process, Sensing (S) or Intuition (N).
- People who prefer **Judging (J)** extravert their judging process, Thinking (T) or Feeling (F).

PERCEIVING PREFERENCE

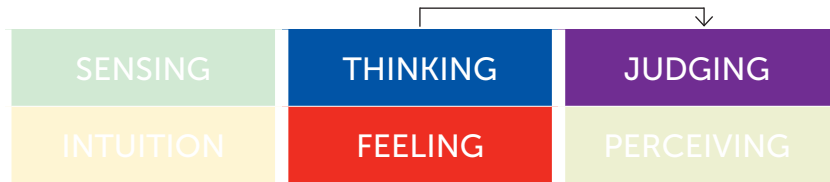
If we combine the Sensing and Intuition colors, we create a color for the Perceiving preference:
green + yellow = Perceiving = **lime green**



JUDGING PREFERENCE

The same thing happens with Judging—we combine the Thinking and Feeling colors to create a color for the Judging preference:

blue + red = Judging = purple



Extraversion and Introversion

The first letter of an individual's four-letter type is E or I. It tells us where people focus their energy and how they get energized.

Extraversion (E) = Focus energy on and get energized by people and the outer world

We gave it the color orange.

EXTRAVERSION

Why orange?

Lively and visibly energetic

Introversion (I) = Focus energy on and get energized by thoughts and reflection in the inner world

We gave it the color turquoise.

INTROVERSION

Why turquoise?

For depth and reflection, like a lake

Putting It All Together



Examples of MBTI® Type Colors in Resources

You will find these colors in the MBTI® Step I™ and Step II™ Feedback Cards and in the MBTI® Flip a Type Tip, where they make these resources easier to use.



Typies®

An easy way to introduce and remember type dynamics

The Typies® use the colors in a way that makes the favorite process of each type obvious.

Each MBTI type uses the four mental processes (S, N, T, and F) in a specific order. The process each type uses most comfortably and relies on the most is referred to as its *favorite*, or *first*, process. The color of that process represents the type.

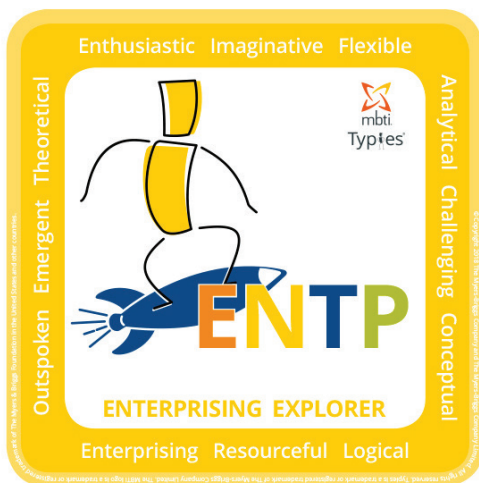


ISTJ, ISFJ, ESTP, and ESFP all have **Sensing (S)** as their favorite process, so these Typies are predominantly green.

INFJ, INTJ, ENFP, and ENTP all have **Intuition (N)** as their favorite process, so these Typies are predominantly yellow.

ISFP, INFP, ESFJ, and ENFJ all have **Feeling (F)** as their favorite process, so these Typies are predominantly red.

ISTP, INTP, ESTJ, and ENTJ all have **Thinking (T)** as their favorite process, so these Typies are predominantly blue.



ENTP's favorite process is Intuition. So the Type character is yellow and the border is yellow. Each individual letter (ENTP) correlates with the colors described on previous pages.

Each type's Type character is also associated with an object that is the color of that type's second process. The rocket is the color of ENTP's second process—blue, for Thinking.

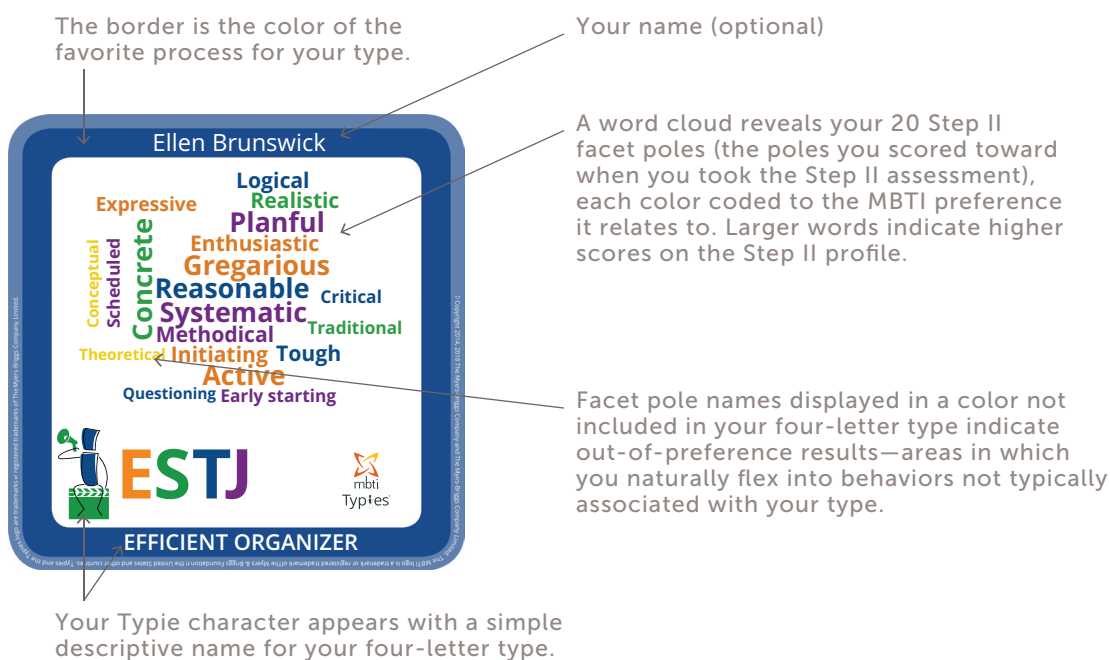
Personal Typies®

Share your rich and unique expression of type with a Personal Typie

The MBTI® Step II™ assessment takes personal development to the next level. Personal Typies® are a way to share your rich and unique expression of your MBTI type in an easy-to-read and fun format. If you already have your MBTI Step II results, you can create your Personal Typie right away.

WHAT IS A PERSONAL TYPE?

Your Personal Typie builds on your Typies pictogram to reveal the additional insights of your MBTI Step II profile.



Create your Personal Typie for free by visiting www.themyersbriggs.com. You can customize your Personal Typie by choosing the font and orientation of the Step II word cloud—making it as individual as you are!

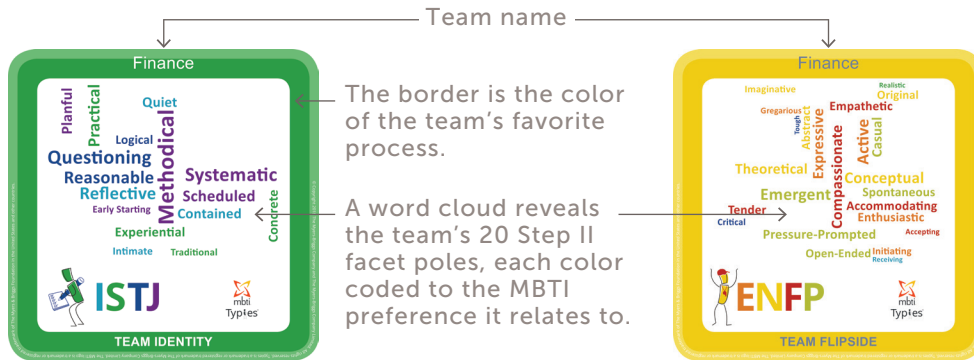
Team Typies®

Reveal your team's personality with Team Typies®

The Team Typies® application provides a set of powerful practitioner resources that support team building with the MBTI Step II assessment.

WHAT IS A TEAM TYPE?

The Team Typies application uses team members' Step I and Step II results to identify key information about a team. The resulting Team Type displays a Team Identity (the team's most frequently occurring Step I preferences and the team's predominant Step II facet poles) and a Team Flipside (the opposite of the Team Identity) as colorful pictograms.



Team Identity

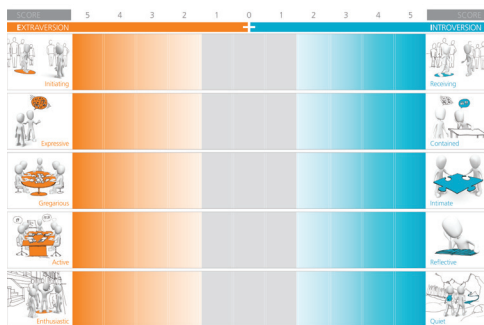
Displays the team's Step II personality, with larger words indicating predominant facet poles. It also shows the team's overall team type and associated Type character.

Team Flipside

Shows the opposite of the team's Step II personality and Step I team type, revealing the facet poles and Step I preferences that the team uses and relies on least. Larger words denote the greatest potential blind spots.

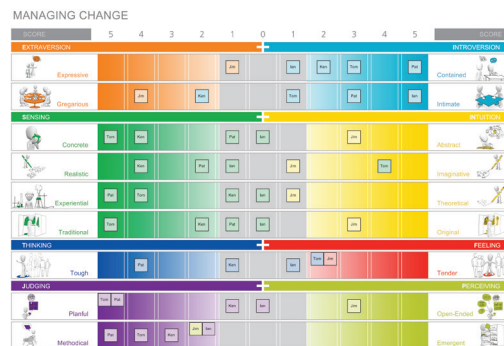
TEAM PROFILES

The Team Types application also generates Team Profiles, which plot team members' scores on the Step II facets.



Facet Profiles

Show the spread of team members' scores across the five facets of each Step I™ preference pair. Great for use in designing activities that explore the different preferences.



Application Profiles

Allow you to see at a glance team members' scores on the Step II facets that most affect four common business applications: communication, decision making, managing change, and managing conflict. Great for use in designing team development activities.

Create your Team Type and Profiles for free by visiting www.themyersbriggs.com. You will need to have a Personal Type for each team member before you can create a Team Type and Profiles.

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